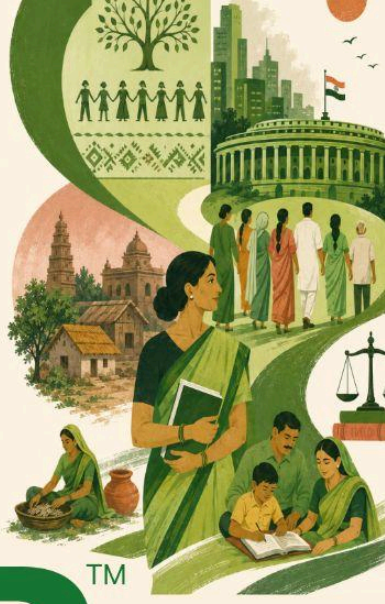
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Indian Society

General Studies Paper - I

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Chapter 1

Salient Features Of Indian Society

PYQs

[2026] Unity in diversity remains the defining feature of Indian society despite the challenges from communalism and regionalism. Comment. (10)

[2024] Critically analyse the proposition that there is a high correlation between India's cultural diversities and socio-economic marginalities. (15)

[2023] Do you think marriage as a sacrament is losing its value in Modern India? (10)

[2021] How does Indian society maintain continuity in traditional social values? Enumerate the changes taking place in it. (15)

[2020] Customs and traditions suppress reason, leading to obscurantism. Do you agree? (15)

[2019] What makes Indian society unique in sustaining its culture? Discuss. (10)

[2019] Do we have cultural pockets of small India all over the nation? Elaborate with examples. (15)

Indian Society-

1. According to **J.H. Fichter**, "A society may be defined as a network of interconnected major groups viewed as a unit and sharing a common culture."
2. **Anthony Giddens** defines **globalization** as "the intensification of worldwide social relations which link distant localities in such a way that local happenings are shaped by events occurring many miles away and vice versa."
3. **Patrilineal society:** A society in which descent/ancestry is determined through the father's line and continued through the father is termed a patrilineal society.

Quotes

"Our ability to reach unity in diversity will be our civilization's beauty and test." — Mahatma Gandhi.

"India is the cradle of the human race, birthplace of human speech, mother of history, the grandmother of legend, & great grandmother of tradition." — Mark Twain

"India will teach us the tolerance and gentleness of a mature mind, understanding spirit and a unifying, pacifying love for all human beings." — Will Durant

Important phrases

1. Nehru: Inherent Cosmopolitanism
2. Mosaic of Cultures: Rabindranath Tagore
3. Iravati Karve: Epitome of the World.
4. Will Durant: India was the motherland of our race

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Data

Linguistic	Austric, Dravidian, Sino-Tibetan, Indo-European. People's Linguistic Survey of India-G.N. Devy- 780 major languages, 66 different scripts
Religious	All India Religion Census Data 2011- Hindu -79.80% Muslim 14.23% Christian 2.30% Sikh 1.72% Buddhist 0.70% Jain 0.37% Other Religion 0.66% Not stated 0.24%
Racial Diversity	B.S. Guha identified- Negrito Proto-Australoid, Mongoloid Mediterranean, Western Brachycephals, Nordic
Tribes	The total population of **Scheduled Tribes** is 10.43 crore as per the Census 2011, which accounts for **8.6 per cent** of the country's total population.

Salient features of society -

1. **Civilizational Continuity**: Eg. The Tribhanga posture, central to Indian dance forms, is depicted in the Mohenjodaro bronze sculpture.
2. **Inherent Pluralism** due to interaction with various cultures, including Greeks, Mughals, and Europeans.
3. **Philosophical and Spiritual Foundations**: Rooted in a diverse array of traditions such as Hinduism, Buddhism, Jainism, and Sikhism. Eg. the practice of Ahimsa

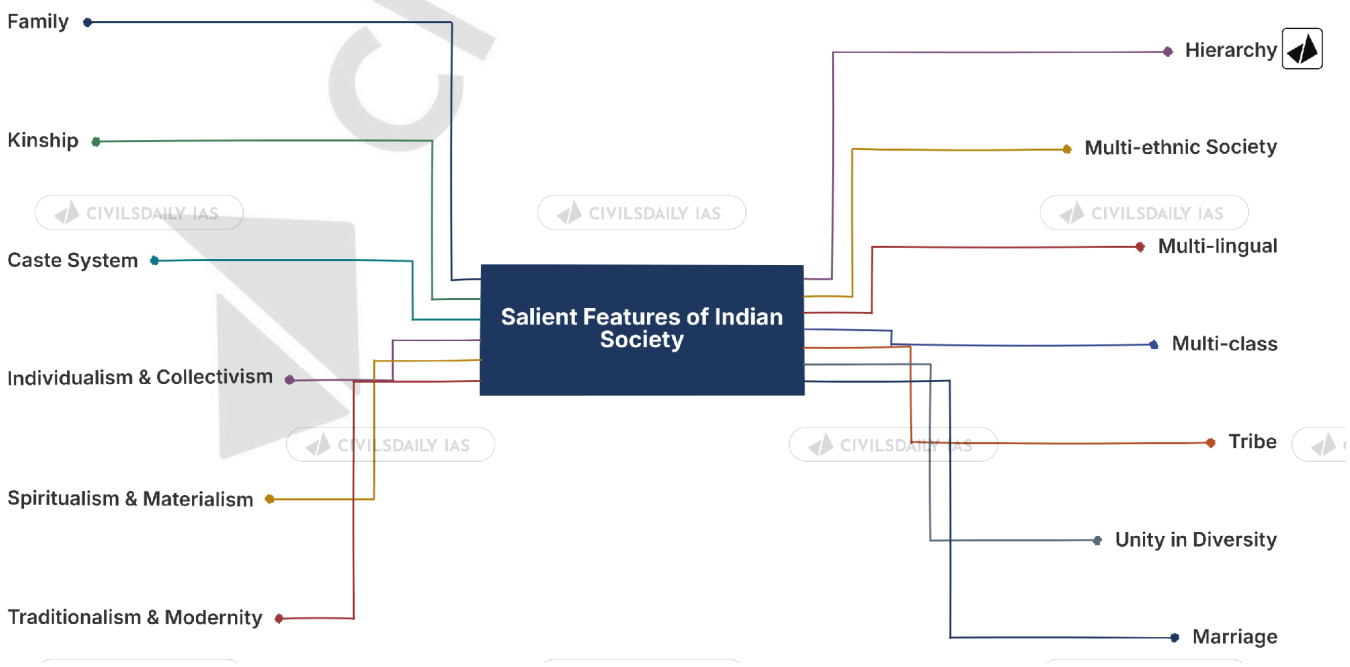


Fig. Salient Features of Indian Society

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4. **Unity in Diversity:** "unity without uniformity and diversity without fragmentation" due to historical fusion and accommodation.
5. **Dynamic and syncretic**:
   a. The language of Urdu has developed out of Arabic and Hindavi,
   b. The Bhakti movement and the Sufi movements inspired each other.
   c. The Rashtrapati Bhawan is an architectural splendor created from the fusion of European, Rajput, and Mughal design.
6. **Caste System** : A unique system of social stratification influencing occupation, marriage, and social relations. Eg. endogamy.
7. **Regionalism and Local Identities** : Strong attachment to region, language, and culture. Eg. Dravidian culture.
8. **Strong Family and Kinship System** : Dominance of **joint family**, kinship ties, and community networks.
9. **Religious Centrality** : Religion plays a significant role in social norms, festivals, and daily life.
10. **Traditionalism with modernity**: Eg. Indo-western fusion in the performing arts.
11. **Scientific Heritage**: Eg. the concept of zero and advancements in astronomy by scholars like Aryabhata.
12. **Co-existence with Nature** in the spirit of Prithvi Sukta, which offers a salutation to Mother Earth. Eg. Bugun tribe of Arunachal Pradesh, Bishnois of Rajasthan.
13. **Patriarchy** grants greater authority and privilege to men in both public and private spheres. Eg. Sarpanch Pati Raj.
14. **Tolerance and Mutual Respect**: The concept of "sarva dharma-sam-bhava" is the foundation of the Indian Model of secularism (Articles 25-30).

Continuity and change in social features-

Continuity-

1. **Cultural Practices**: Eg. Onam in Kerala, Pongal in TN, Durga Puja in Eastern India
2. **Life-cycle rituals**, such as marriage (Saptapadi) and funeral rites, continue to follow ancient traditions. **M.N. Srinivas** noted the **"Sanskritization"** process, where lower castes adopt rituals of upper castes, showing continuity in ritual practices.
3. **Religious Traditions**: Practices like pilgrimage and religious festivals uphold spiritual beliefs and customs. Ex- Kumbhmela.
4. **Family Structure-**
   a. **Joint family** systems persist in many parts of India, emphasizing familial bonds and collective responsibility.
   b. **Respect for elders** and adherence to hierarchical family roles remain prevalent.
   c. **Marriage Customs**: Traditional practices like arranged marriages are still prevalent.
5. **Education and Learning**
   a. **Gurukul System: E**lements of the ancient Gurukul system of learning can still be seen in modern educational practices. Eg. Rishi Valley School in Andhra Pradesh.
   b. **Traditional Knowledge: A**yurveda, Yoga, and other traditional sciences continue to be practiced and respected globally.
6. **Philosophical and Ethical Systems : T**he concepts of Dharma (duty) and Karma (action) continue to guide ethical and moral decisions in Indian society.
7. **Caste System**: I**dentity politics**
   a. Despite efforts towards social reform, caste-based identities continue to influence **social interactions and occupations**. Eg. Manual Scavenging.

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b. **Endogamous marriage practices** reinforce caste boundaries and social hierarchies. Eg. Honor Killings.
c. **Louis Dumont's** book **"Homo Hierarchicus"** outlines the enduring nature of caste as a social institution.

8. **Constitutional provisions** : Concerning the right to religion (Article 25) and the Indian model of secularism based on 'Sarva Dharma Samabhav'.

Changes in Indian Society-

1. **Political** -
   a. Breaking the **caste hierarchy** because of reservation and electoral politics. Eg. President Murmu.
   b. **Women's Empowerment**: Eg. 46% women's representation in Panchayats.
2. **Economic**-
   a. **Economic Diversification due to LPG reforms**: Rise of a **middle class** driven by service-sector growth.
3. **Social : Impact of Globalization**
   a. S**hift towards consumerism and materialism** as against traditional values of minimalism and non-ostentation.
   b. **Education and Urbanization** offer **upward social mobility** and alter traditional social hierarchies.
4. **Technological** : T**he influence of social media** platforms facilitates cross-cultural interactions and challenges traditional norms. Eg. the MeToo Movement.
5. **Legal Reforms-**
   a. According to **Nivedita Menon**, the struggle for gender and sexual rights is reshaping societal norms and challenging traditional boundaries. Eg. Triple Talaq Act.
   b. **LGBTQ+ Rights:** Decriminalization of homosexuality (Section 377) and increasing social acceptance of LGBTQ+ individuals.
6. **Impact of Globalisation** - Western clothing, food habits, and work culture.
7. **Modernization theory of Yogendra Singh -**
   a. **Cultural Hybridization -** Modernization in India leads to a blend of traditional and modern values, creating a unique cultural hybrid. Eg. online Poojas.
8. **Changing Family Dynamics-**
   a. A **decline in the prevalence of joint families** and **increasing divorce rates** in urban areas.
   b. **Marriage Customs**: increased acceptance of love and inter-caste marriages.
   c. **Changing Roles-** more women participating in the workforce. Female literacy rate increased from 53.67% in 2001 to 64.63% in 2011.

Customs and Traditions -

As a source of continuity

1. **Durkheim's Concept of Social Solidarity** : Traditions maintain **mechanical solidarity** by binding communities through **rituals, beliefs, and shared norms**. Eg. **joint family system**.
2. **Marriage and Kinship Structures** : Customs governing **marriage alliances, gotra rules, rituals like Saptapadi**, etc., maintain **lineage continuity and social order**.
3. **Festivals** - According to **M.N. Srinivas**, festivals act as a **'social glue'**and reinforce **collective memory**. Eg. **Dussehra** (triumph of good over evil).
4. **Social Cohesion**: Community feasts and village festivals promote unity and bring people together.
5. **Language, Dress, and Cuisine -** maintain regional and ethnic identity. Eg. **Tamil cuisine, Bhangra in Punjab.**

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6. Rituals of **purity and pollution rules** followed by different caste groups maintain social structure and order.
7. **Life-Cycle Rituals (Samskaras)** : Customs regulating birth, marriage, and death continue across generations. Eg. **Namkaran, Vivaha, Antyeshti**.
8. **Language and Oral Traditions** : Folklore, proverbs, and songs transmit values.
9. **Traditional Indian arts and crafts,** like Madhubani painting, Kalamkari, etc are cultural expressions passed down through generations.

As an Impediment to Modernity-

1. **Modernity vs. Traditionalism** is visible in clashes between **constitutional morality** and **cultural orthodoxy**. Eg. opposition to the Sabarimala Verdict.
2. **Rigid caste customs** hinder **equality, mobility, and meritocracy** - key pillars of modernity. Eg. **Manual scavenging**, **Dalit boy beaten for drinking water from an upper-caste pot.**
3. **Gender Oppression Through Traditions**
   a. Sociologist **Sylvia Walby - "Patriarchy is institutionalized through cultural practices".**
   b. Customs like **purdah**, **dowry**, **child marriage**, and **honor killings** restrict **women's agency and access to education and work**.
   c. **Proxy representation** in Panchayats. Eg. Sarpanch Pati.
4. **Superstitions**, religious orthodoxy, and blind ritualism resist **rational thinking**. Eg. witch **hunting in tribal regions**, opposition to **interfaith marriages under the "Love Jihad" narrative**.
5. **Resistance to Legal and Social Reform : Customs preserve power hierarchies** under the guise of continuity. Eg. **Khap Panchayats.**
6. **Cultural Reluctance to Individualism** : Eg. LGBTQ+ identities still face backlash in many communities despite SC decriminalization (Navtej Johar case, 2018).
7. Traditional **linkage of caste with occupation** restricts mobility. Eg. manual scavenging.

Diversity -

The unity of India has been and shall always be a unity in diversity : R**abindranath Tagore.**

Our ability to reach Unity in Diversity will be the beauty and test of our civilization -**Mahatma Gandhi.**

Types

1. **Cultural**: India's cultural diversity is vividly manifested in its festivals, cuisine, clothing, music, dance, art, and literature.
   a. **Festivals** such as Diwali and Eid, each marked by distinctive traditions.
   b. **Culinary styles** vary from region to region, offering a spectrum of flavors from the biryanis of Hyderabad to the seafood of Kerala.
   c. **Traditional attire** like sarees and dhotis changes style across different states, reflecting local customs.
   d. **Music and dance forms** range from classical styles like Bharatanatyam to folk traditions like Bhangra.
   e. **Art and architecture** showcase a diversity from Mughal designs in the north to Dravidian temples in the south.
   f. **Literature** too is rich, spanning from ancient Sanskrit epics to modern Indian and English writings, illustrating the depth of India's cultural narrative.
2. **Regional -**
   a. **State Divisio**n: India has 28 states and 8 Union Territories, each with distinct cultural identities.

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   b. **Intra-State Diversity**: States like Maharashtra exhibit sub-regional identities such as Vidarbha, Konkan, Marathwada, and West Maharashtra.
3. **Geographical** : Himalayas, coasts, desert, etc.
4. **Religious** (data given above)
5. **Ethnic**

Ethnic groups in India	Features	Area located in
Indo-Aryans	Largest ethnic group (approx 72% of the population)	Northern, central, and western regions of India.
Dravidians	Second-largest ethnic group (around 25% of the population)	Southern parts of India.
Mongoloids	Small ethnic group (about 3% of the population)	Northeastern regions.
Other ethnic groups	Tibeto-Burmans, Austro-Asiatics, and the Andamanese.	

1. **Caste : A**ccording to **Sujatha Gidla** (Ants among elephants), Caste is the invisible arm that turns every gear in nearly every system of the country.
   a. According to the 2011 Census, Scheduled Castes constitute about 16.6% of the population, and Scheduled Tribes make up 8.6%.
   b. **Other Backward Classes (OBC): E**stimates suggest OBCs form about 41% of the population.
2. **Tribal**-
   a. As per the Census 2011, the tribal population constitutes about 8.9% of the total population and **11.3% of the total rural population.**
   b. In the states of Punjab and Haryana, as well as the union territories of Delhi, Chandigarh, and Puducherry, there are **no tribes officially recognized** as Scheduled Tribes.
   c. Mizoram and Lakshadweep have **high proportions of their populations** belonging to Scheduled Tribes, at 94.43% and 94.79% respectively.
   d. Among the major states, Chhattisgarh has the **largest proportion** of the Scheduled Tribe population at 30.62%, followed by Jharkhand at 26.21%.
   e. 71% of India's Scheduled Tribes population is concentrated in six states: Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Odisha, Gujarat, Rajasthan, and Jharkhand.

Diversity and National Identity (Unity in diversity) -

Diversity as a pillar of national identity

1. **Unity in Diversity** : Acceptance of multiple identities strengthens national cohesion. Eg. celebration of **Diwali, Eid, Christmas, and Guru Nanak Jayanti** as public holidays across India.
2. Diversity fosters **tolerance, dialogue, and democratic ethos**, which shape a resilient national identity.
3. **Cultural Pluralism** : Diverse cultural traditions together form India's national culture. Eg. recognition of **Bharatanatyam, Kathak, and Odissi** as classical dances.
4. **Linguistic Federalism** : Respect for linguistic diversity deepens democratic participation. Eg. **22 Scheduled Languages** recognised under the **Eighth Schedule of the Constitution**.

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5. **Religious Coexistence** : Peaceful cohabitation of faiths fosters inclusive nationalism. Eg. **Ajmer Sharif Dargah is visited** by people of all religions.
6. **Regional Diversity within Federalism** : Eg. **Linguistic reorganisation of states in 1956** strengthened integration instead of fragmentation.
7. **Democratic Participation of Diversity** : Representation of diverse groups legitimises the state.
8. **Shared Civilisational Values** : Common ethical values bind diverse communities. Eg. Ideal of Sarva **Dharma Sambhava** reflected in India's secular ethos.

Diversity as a Challenge to National Identity

1. **Linguistic Regionalism** : Eg. anti-Hindi **agitations in Tamil Nadu** during the 1960s.
2. **Religious Polarisation** : Eg. communal **riots during Partition (1947)** and later episodes of communal violence.
3. **Ethnic Separatism** and demand for autonomy or secession. Eg. **Insurgency in the North-East**.
4. **Caste-Based Fragmentation** : Strong caste identities can weaken broader national consciousness. Eg. vote-bank politics or caste-based mobilisations.
5. **Regional Economic Disparities** : Uneven development fuels regional alienation. Eg. demands for **separate statehood,** such as **Vidarbha**.
6. **Tribal Alienation** - Marginalisation of tribal communities challenges national integration. Eg. **Left-Wing Extremism** in parts of central India.
7. **Cultural Homogenisation Fears** - Minorities may fear erosion of their identity.
8. **Migration-Induced Tensions** : Eg. anti-migrant **movements in Assam and Maharashtra**.
9. **Political Exploitation of Identity** undermines national unity. Eg. communal and hate speeches.
10. **Weak Civic Nationalism** : Overemphasis on primordial identities over constitutional values.

Family and Marriage System

Kinship

Kinship refers to the complex system of social relationships that form an integral part of the social structure in all human societies. It is mainly recognized through blood relations (**consanguinity**) and marriage (**affinity**).

Key aspects-

1. **Blood Relations**- Kinship is based on biological relationships.
2. **Marital Relations-** Kinship extends through marital ties, spouses, and their relatives.
3. **Fictive Kinship**: This includes relationships formed through social bonds, like adoption.
4. **Social Functions**: Kinship systems help define roles, responsibilities, and authority within families and communities.
5. **Economic** and **Political Roles**- Kinship influences economic transactions and political alliances at the inter and intra-community level.

Family

According to **George Peter Murdock,** 'The family is a social group characterized by common residence, economic co-operation and reproduction.

Features of family

1. **Universality of the Family**: It is recognized as a fundamental social unit globally; the family performs essential roles for both the individual and society.

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2. **Legitimacy of Relationships**: Families are typically formed through legally and socially sanctioned unions, primarily between spouses, that may include procreation and the upbringing of children.
3. **Emotional Bonding**: Families are pivotal in providing emotional stability; members share bonds of love, care, and protection, often sacrificing personal desires for the collective good.
4. **Regulatory Framework**: Family dynamics and interactions are shaped by societal norms and legal regulations, ensuring structured relationships within the family.
5. **Shared Living Space**: Families generally share a common residence, which is crucial for nurturing and rearing children.
6. **Heritage and Lineage**: Families carry a specific kinship name that identifies their lineage, essential for recognizing familial descent and heritage.

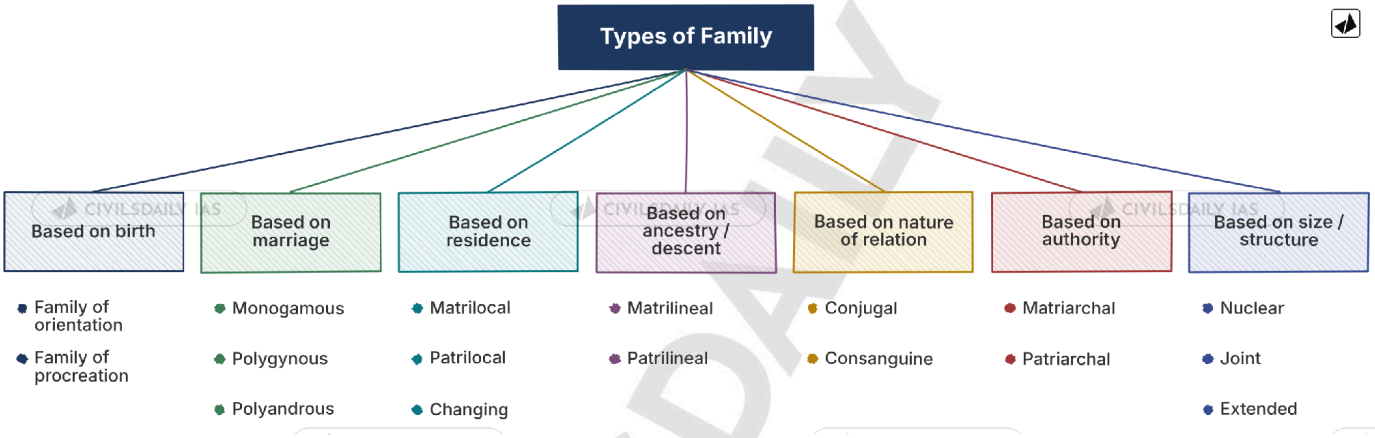


Fig. Types of Family

Types of family

1. **Joint or Extended Family:** This type of family includes **shared residence, common property, a joint kitchen, and multigenerational ties** under a single authority.
2. **Nuclear Family:** It consists of a husband and wife, along with their unmarried children. Minimal interdependent relationships with extended relatives usually characterize it.
3. **Blended Family:** It is created when two people bring children from previous relationships or marriages, and they come together to establish a new family entity.
4. **Single-parent Family:** Here, usually one parent has primary caregiving duties for the children. This can be the result of divorce, separation, the death of a partner, or a personal choice.
5. **Foster Family:** A foster family is a legally approved, temporary household that provides care, stability, and support for children unable to live with their birth parents until they can safely return home or secure a permanent placement.
6. **Chosen Family:** This is formed from emotional ties rather than biological ones. These families provide members with a sense of belonging, support, and care.

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Functions

1. **Socialization Function : Eg.** children learn to respect elders, observe caste roles, and community rituals.
2. **Emotional and Psychological Support :** Provides emotional security, belonging, and moral support.
3. **Economic Function : Eg.** family-run agriculture, small businesses, handicrafts.
4. **Educational Function : Eg.** Rural families where elders pass on occupational or ritual knowledge.
5. **Religious and Ritualistic Function :** Preserves religious beliefs, practices, and community rituals.
6. **Reproductive Function** through childbirth and parenting.
7. **Social Control Function :** Enforces conformity to social norms through approval, disapproval, and sanctions. Eg. restrictions on inter-caste marriage, gender roles, or lifestyle choices.

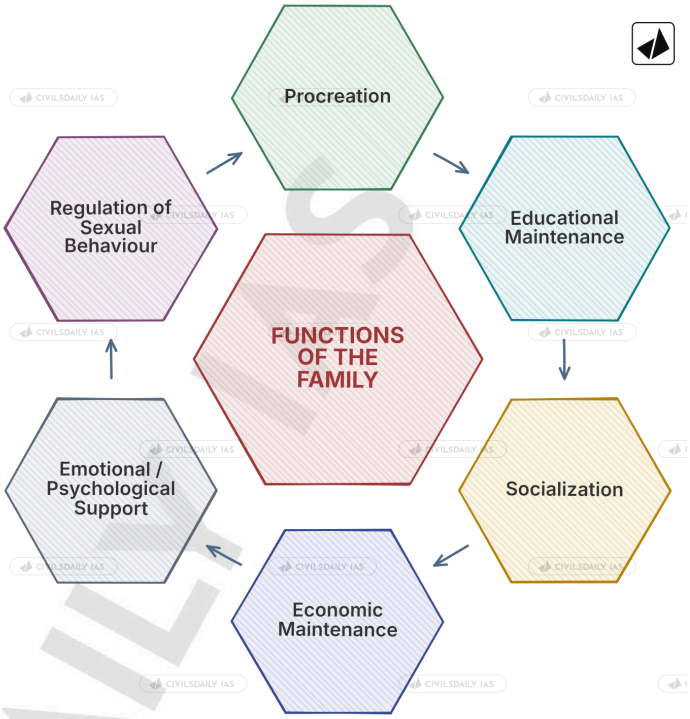


Fig. Functions of the Family

8. **Health and Care Function :** Ensures care for children, the elderly, and sick members.
9. **Status Ascription Function :** Determines ascribed status (caste, religion, class, kin group). Influences one's access to education, marriage, and occupational roles.
10. **Recreational Function :** Offers a space for bonding, entertainment, and collective leisure. Eg. family meals, festive gatherings, storytelling, games in joint households.

Changes In Structure And Functions Of Family

1. **Ronald Fletcher** also calls the family a multifunctional social institution, but whose secondary functions are today performed by bureaucratic organizations. Eg. nurseries and daycare services.
2. **Shift to Nuclear Families**: Data from the Indian census indicates that the proportion of nuclear families has risen from 41% in 2001 to 53% in 2011.
3. Due to industrialization and urbanization, **neo-local residence** has become more common, with young married couples opting to live near their places of employment.
4. **Changing Gender Roles**: Shared responsibilities in household chores and child-rearing are becoming more common. (Arlie Hochschild's concept of the **"Second Shift"**).
5. Families are adapting to **dual-income structures**, with both partners contributing financially. Economic decisions, including investments and savings, are made jointly by spouses.
6. **Socialization and Values**: The role of the family in socializing children is evolving, with greater exposure to diverse values and cultures through media and technology.
7. **Marriage Patterns**: There is a growing acceptance of love marriages, inter-caste marriages, and live-in relationships. The age of marriage is rising, with individuals prioritizing education and careers before settling down.
8. **Elder Care**- With the decline of joint families, elder care is becoming a challenge, leading to the rise of old-age homes and professional caregiving services.
9. **Technological Influence**: Technology is reshaping family interactions, with digital communication becoming integral to maintaining relationships. Eg. family WhatsApp groups.

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10. **Reproductive Choices**: Families are having fewer children, influenced by economic considerations and personal choices. As per NFHS-5, TFR has declined to 2.0.
11. **Emotional and Psychological Support**: greater openness to seeking external help, such as therapy and counseling.
12. **Emergence of Single-Parent and Live-in Families : L**egal changes (Eg. **Hindu Marriage Act amendments**, **recognition of live-in relationships**) and social shifts have legitimized **non-traditional family forms**.

Joint vs Nuclear family

FEATURES	JOINT	NUCLEAR
Structure	It includes multiple generations living under one roof.	Single unit with parents and their children
Economic Model	Resources and expenses are typically pooled together	Parents are the primary earners
Socialization	Children learn social norms and values. It helps enhance communal ties and respect for elders.	More focused attention from parents, but may have fewer interactions
Support System	Daily domestic duties are shared among many members.	They have to manage independently, or systems like daycare, etc have risen.
Decision Making	Decisions are made by senior family members, with less autonomy for younger generations.	Decisions are made democratically within the household, and children have more say in decision-making.
Emotional Dynamics	They have closer parent-child relationships due to direct interaction.	They offer a broader emotional connection.

Life Cycle of the Joint Family System

1. Formation Stage - Based on Kinship and Patriarchy
   a. A joint family is established around a **common male ancestor and his descendants**, typically following **patrilineal descent** and **patrilocal residence**.
   b. It begins with **co-residence**, shared property (coparcenary under Hindu law), and a common kitchen (sajha chulha).
   c. According to **Iravati Karve**, Indian joint families are structured around **unity of residence, property, and worship**, regardless of caste or region.
2. Expansion Stage - Vertical and Horizontal Growth
   a. With marriages and births, the family grows in both **vertical (generational)** and **horizontal (fraternal)** directions. Male members remain with their wives and children, while daughters marry out.
   b. This phase sees **collective income generation** (especially in agrarian and business families), shared authority, and internal role differentiation.
   c. **M.N. Srinivas** observed that joint families ensured **division of labor**, **economic security**, and **social capital**.

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3. Peak or Stable Stage : Institutional Consolidation
   a. The family reaches its **maximum functional strength**, operating as a **moral economy**.
   b. Ritual, emotional, and economic integration is at its highest. Roles are well-defined (elders : Authority, women : Care, children : Obedience).
   c. **Conflict management mechanisms** exist, but subservience to elder males often prevails. **Authority-solidarity balance** maintains cohesion despite interpersonal friction.
4. Disintegration Stage : Pressures of Modernity
   a. This phase marks **strain and eventual fragmentation** due to multiple pressures.
   b. **Urbanization** and job-related migration.
   c. **Individualism and nuclear aspirations** among younger generations.
   d. **Inheritance conflicts**, especially post **Hindu Succession (Amendment) Act, 2005**, giving daughters equal rights in property.
   e. **Education and exposure**, especially among women, challenge traditional gender roles.
5. Re-configuration/Re-constitution Stage : Adaptive Revival
   a. In response to **economic stress, eldercare needs, or cultural reassertion**, families may return to **modified joint setups**.
   b. **Functional joint families** emerge- members live separately but maintain economic and emotional ties.
   c. Urban middle-class families increasingly adopt **neo-joint models** where parents cohabit with working children in metro cities.
   d. Return to extended families post-COVID in many parts of India due to job losses and health dependency.

Marriage

According to **Emile Durkheim,** marriage is a social institution that contributes significantly to social cohesion and stability.

"Marriage is not a mere convention, but an implicit condition of human society." : D**r. Radhakrishnan**

Types of marriage -

Based on the number of partners involved-	**Monogamy**-	At a particular time, a man or woman remains married to only one person.
	Polygamy	More than one spouse at a given time. It is of 2 types- **Polygyny**- meaning where one man marries multiple women. Eg. Baigas and Gonds. **Polyandry**- meaning where one woman marries multiple men. Eg. Toda, Kota, Khasa, and Ladhaki Bota.
Based on spouse selection	**Endogamy**	Marriage within one caste, sub-caste, and tribe. Eg. Indian arranged marriage is based on **caste** endogamy

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Based on spouse selection	**Exogamy**	Marriage outside one's kin group. Eg. India practices gotra exogamy, i.e., one cannot marry a person belonging to the same **gotra**.
Based on spouse selection	**Levirate**	type of marriage in which a man marries the widow of his deceased brother.
Contemporary types of marriage	**Open marriage**	Marriage in which both partners consent that having an extra-marital connection is acceptable and will not be viewed as infidelity.
Contemporary types of marriage	**Same-Sex Marriage**	Marriage between two individuals of the same sex

Significance of the marriage institution in Indian society

1. **Social Legitimization of Relationships** : It defines **socially sanctioned roles** of husband and wife and legitimizes kinship bonds.
2. **Maintains Social Structure and Stability** through the socialization of children and the stabilization of adult personalities.
3. Acts as a **mechanism of social control** by regulating sexual conduct within culturally accepted norms.
4. Marriage is the basis of **nuclear or joint family structures** and kinship networks. It establishes **gotra, lineage, and descent**.
5. **Continuity of Lineage and Inheritance** - Vital for the practice of **patrilineal inheritance**, especially in Hindu society.
6. **Reinforcement of Caste and Community Identity** : E**ndogamous marriage** (within caste/community) sustains the **varna-jati hierarchy** and social boundaries.
7. **Economic and Social Alliance** : Facilitates **dowry/bridewealth exchanges**, economic alliances, and **status negotiations**.
8. **Religious and Ritual Significance** : Seen as a **sacred sacrament (samskara)** in Hinduism. Rituals like **Saptapadi, Kanyadaan, Nikah, and Anand Karaj** signify the religious depth.
9. **Socialization and Gender Role Assignment** : Traditionally, it enforces **division of labor**, caregiving roles, and kinship duties, especially for women.
10. **Symbol of Social Status and Honour** : Eg. **'Big fat Indian weddings'.**
11. **It is a source of emotional security and companionship** by providing a network of support that is valued highly in Indian society. 'Behind every successful man, there is a woman.'

Constitutional and Legal provisions related to marriage-

Constitutional Provisions

1. **Article 14 : Right to Equality : A**pplied in striking down regressive personal law practices (Eg. Triple Talaq).
2. **Article 21 : Right to Life and Personal Liberty**
   a. Includes the **right to marry a person of one's choice**, upheld in cases like Lata Singh v. State of UP (2006).
   b. Shafin Jahan v. Asokan K.M. (2018): Right to choose a spouse is part of personal liberty.
3. **Article 44 : Uniform Civil Code (Directive Principle) : A**dvocates for uniform marriage, divorce, and inheritance laws across communities.

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Legal Provisions (Statutory Laws)

1. **Hindu Marriage Act, 1955**
   a. Applies to Hindus, Buddhists, Jains, and Sikhs.
   b. Recognizes marriage as a **sacrament**.
   c. Provides for conditions of marriage, restitution of conjugal rights, and divorce.
   d. Age of marriage: 21 years (male), 18 years (female).
2. **Muslim Personal Law (Shariat) Application Act, 1937**
   a. Governs marriage, talaq, mehr, and inheritance for Muslims.
   b. Marriage is treated as a **civil contract**.
   c. Polygamy permitted under specific conditions (subject to recent judicial scrutiny).
3. **Christian Marriage Act, 1872**
   a. Regulates marriage among Christians.
   b. Registration of marriages and consent-based provisions are included.
4. **Parsi Marriage and Divorce Act, 1936 : A**pplies to Parsis; mandates monogamous marriage and outlines grounds for divorce.
5. **Special Marriage Act (SMA), 1954 : A**llows **civil marriage** irrespective of religion or caste.
6. **Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, 2006**
   a. Declares marriages of girls below 18 and boys below 21 as voidable.
   b. Prescribes penalties for those promoting, performing, or facilitating child marriage.
7. **Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act, 2005**
   a. Offers legal remedy against abuse within a marriage or live-in relationship.
   b. Ensures women's right to residence, maintenance, and protection.

Important Supreme Court Judgments on Marriage in India

1. **Shah Bano Case** : Established **maintenance rights of divorced Muslim women** under **Section 125 CrPC**.
2. **Sarla Mudgal v. Union of India (1995)** : Held that **conversion to Islam for a second marriage** without dissolving the first Hindu marriage is **invalid.**
3. **Shayara Bano v. Union of India (2017)** : Declared **instant triple talaq (talaq-e-biddat)** unconstitutional.
4. **Joseph Shine v. Union of India (2018)** : Struck down **adultery as a criminal offence**, recognising **marriage as a partnership of equals**, not male property rights.
5. **Shafin Jahan v. Asokan K.M. (Hadiya Case, 2018)** : Affirmed **right to choose one's partner** as part of **Article 21 (personal liberty)**.
6. **Independent Thought v. Union of India (2017)** : Criminalised **sexual intercourse with a wife below 18 years**, reinforcing **child protection within marriage**.
7. **K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India (2017)** : Recognised **right to privacy**, impacting marital autonomy, choice of partner, and reproductive decisions.
8. **Supriyo v. Union of India (2023)** : Declined legal recognition of **same-sex marriage**, but reaffirmed **constitutional protection of queer relationships** and urged legislative action.
9. In **Velusamy v. Patchaiammal (2010)**, the SC ruled that women in long-term live-in relationships are entitled to maintenance under the Domestic Violence Act.
10. In **Shilpa Sailesh v. Varun Sreenivasan (2023)**, the SC ruled that it can grant a divorce under Article 142 without waiting for the mandatory six-month cooling-off period.
11. In the **Shakti Vahini Case (2018)**, the SC issued strict guidelines to prevent **Khap Panchayats** from interfering in inter-caste or inter-religious marriages.

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Changes in the marriage system

1. **Delayed Marriages**: The median age at first marriage in India has increased from 19.3 years in 1990 to 22.1 years in 2019 for women, indicating a trend towards delayed marriages.
2. Influence of Globalization and Technology
   a. Matrimonial websites, dating apps, and digital platforms have **changed matchmaking practices**.
   b. Cultural symbols of marriage (Eg. destination weddings, pre-wedding shoots) show **Western influences fused with traditional rituals**.
3. Emergence of Live-in Relationships: Live-in relationships have been legally recognized by the courts (Eg. Indra Sarma v. V.K.V. Sarma, 2013).
4. Rise of Inter-Caste and Inter-Religious Marriages
   a. With rising **educational and occupational mobility**, especially in cities, **endogamy is slowly declining**.
   b. Government schemes like **Dr. Ambedkar Foundation's Inter-caste Marriage Incentive** encourage social integration.
5. Growing Acceptance of Divorce and Remarriage
   a. Divorce, once stigmatized, is becoming more common due to **changing gender roles**, legal ease, and **reduced societal taboos**.
   b. **Mutual consent divorces**, especially in urban areas, have increased.
6. Legal Reforms and Secular Regulation : Laws such as the Hindu Marriage Act (1955), Special Marriage Act (1954), and Prohibition of Child Marriage Act (2006) have standardized marriage rights and provided recourse against forced or child marriages.
7. **Redefining Gender Roles** : Eg : The concept of **"Double Income, No Kids" (DINK)** couples is rising, where both partners prioritize their careers over traditional procreation.

Negative Changes

1. **Commercialization and Materialism**
   a. Conspicuous consumption is evident in **big-fat Indian weddings**, often leading to **financial strain and indebtedness**.
   b. The **wedding industry in India is valued at over ₹3 lakh crore**, with many families taking loans or liquidating savings.
2. **Rising Dowry Demands** : Evolved into a "social expectation rather than a tradition".
3. **Increase in Marital Violence** - NFHS-5: Over **29% of women** reported facing spousal violence.
4. **Erosion of Stability and Commitment** - Growing **individualism**, unrealistic expectations, and the influence of social media are contributing to **early divorces and emotional burnout**.
5. **Misuse of Protective Laws** : Eg. Atul Subhash Case.
6. **Persistence of Honor-based Violence**
   a. Inter-caste or inter-religious marriages still face **violent backlash from communities and families**.
   b. **Khap Panchayats** and vigilante groups continue to act against couples violating customary norms.
7. The use of **dating apps and matrimonial platforms** has led to **cyber fraud, data misuse**, and **emotional manipulation**.
8. **Marriage as a Pressure, Not a Choice** : In many rural and traditional settings, marriage is still **forced upon women at a young age**, driven by honor, control, or economic burden.

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Marriage age for women

The Prohibition of Child Marriage (Amendment) Bill, **2021,** has sought to amend the Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, 2006, to increase the minimum age of marriage for women from 18 to 21 years.

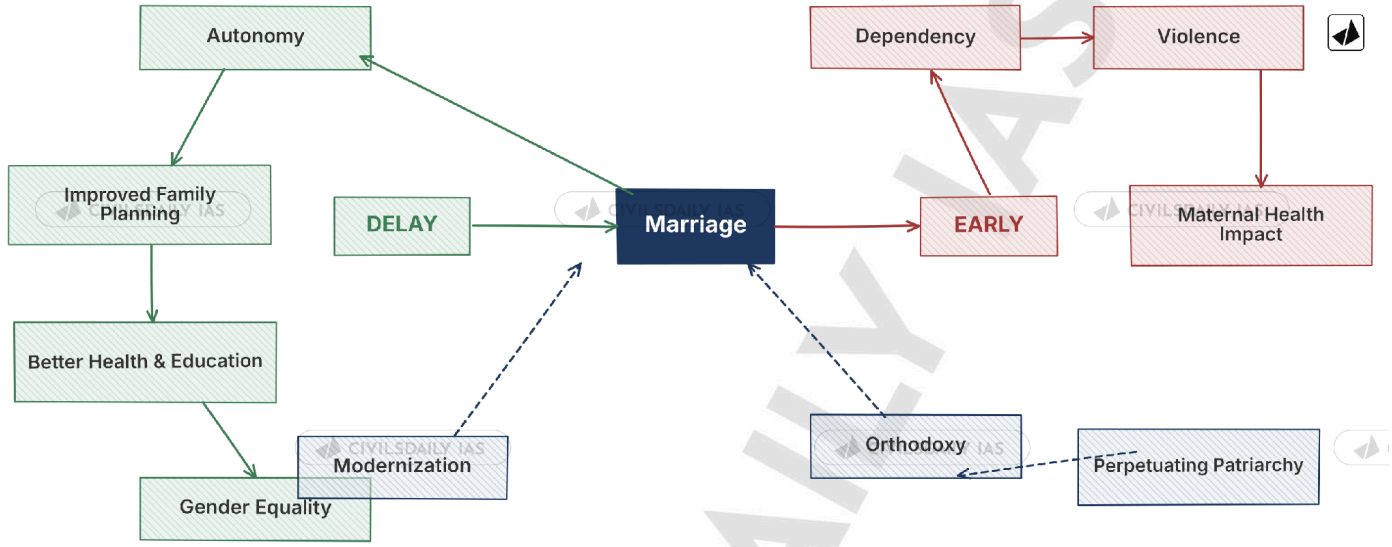


Fig. Age at Marriage — Delay vs Early

Arguments in favor

1. **Equality Between Genders**: Raising the marriage age to 21 for women promotes gender equality, ensuring both sexes have the same legal standards.
2. **Improved Family Planning** : Eg. Kerala, with a higher average marriage age, has a TFR of 1.8. In contrast, Bihar, with a lower average marriage age, has a TFR of 3.4.
3. **Improved Maternal Health** : Higher age at marriage reduces risks of maternal mortality and pregnancy-related complications.
4. **Better Child Health Outcomes** : Delayed marriage leads to healthier pregnancies and children.
5. **Educational Continuity** : Increased marriage age enables women to complete higher education.
6. **Economic Empowerment** - More time for skill development and employment before marriage.
7. **Reduction in Child Marriage** : Raising the legal age discourages early and forced marriages.
8. **Enhanced Decision**-Making Capacity - Greater emotional and psychological maturity improves marital stability.
9. **Inter-generational Benefits** : Educated and mature mothers invest more in children's health and education.

Challenges in Increasing the Marriage Age

1. **Cultural and Social Norms:** abrupt changes imposed from outside can lead to **social tension and resistance**.
2. **Potential for Increase in Illegal Marriages**: Raising the legal age can lead to an increase in unregistered or illegally conducted marriages, similar to the prohibition impacts in the US.
3. **Weak Enforcement Capacity** : Eg. continued child marriages despite the Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, 2006.
4. **Poverty and Economic Insecurity** : Poor families view early marriage as economic relief.

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5. **Gender Norms and Patriarchy** : Early marriage is seen as a way to control women's sexuality. Eg. Social stigma attached to unmarried older women.

Same-sex marriage

It grants same-sex couples the same legal and social recognition, rights, and privileges that are traditionally associated with marriage.

SC Judgment

1. The **Navtej Singh Johar (2018)** judgment struck down Section 377, allowing same-sex adults to engage in consensual relationships.
2. In the **Supriyo Case (2023)**, the Supreme Court ruled that while queer couples have a right to cohabit, there is no fundamental right to marry under current laws.
3. It has also rejected the demands for the re-interpretation of the Special Marriage Act (SMA) 1954 to include the word "spouses" in place of "man and woman".
4. The Supreme Court stated that only **Parliament** has the power to amend the Special Marriage Act to include non-heterosexual couples.

Arguments in favor

1. **Right to Equality** : Denying marriage rights based on sexual orientation violates the principle of equal treatment before the law.
2. **Individual Liberty and Choice** : The **Puttaswamy (Privacy) Judgment** established that intimate personal choices, like marriage, are protected under the Right to Life (**Article 21**).
3. **Legal and Financial Security** : Eg - Without legal marriage, a same-sex partner may be denied **pension or gratuity** benefits after the death of their spouse.
4. **Social Validation** : Legalizing marriage removes the social stigma associated with queer relationships and provides them with societal "respectability."
5. **Right to Family and Parenting** : Allows same-sex couples to be recognized as **"joint parents"** on a child's birth certificate or school records.
6. **Evolutionary Nature of Law** : Supporters argue that laws must change as society evolves. **Eg** - Just as **Sati and Child Marriage** were abolished despite being "traditions".
7. **Decoupling Marriage from Procreation** : Indian law allows **infertile couples or the elderly** to marry, proving that the ability to procreate is not a requirement for a valid marriage.
8. **Global Human Rights Standards** : Eg : Over **30 countries**, including Nepal in South Asia, have already legalized same-sex marriage, setting a precedent for human rights.
9. **Prevention of Exploitation** : Legal marriage provides a framework for divorce, alimony, and protection against domestic violence.

Arguments against

1. Marriage is viewed as a holy union exclusively between a "biological man" and a "biological woman" in Indian culture.
2. Religious bodies argue that same-sex unions cannot fulfill the "natural order" of procreation and lineage.
3. **Administrative Hurdles** : Eg. existing **gender-based protections** are specifically designed to protect women, and applying them to same-sex couples would create legal confusion.
4. The **NCPCR (National Commission for Protection of Child Rights)** argued that children of same-sex parents might face social stigma and adaptive challenges in Indian society.

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5. **Risk of "Slippery Slope"** : If individual autonomy is the only criteria, it might eventually lead to the questioning of laws against **incest or polygamy**.
6. **Heteronormative Legal Framework** : Existing marriage laws are structured around heterosexual unions. Eg. **Hindu Marriage Act, 1955** uses gendered terminology.
7. **Alternative Legal Protections Available** : Eg. court-recognised **cohabitation rights** and anti-discrimination principles under **Article 21**.

Rising divorce rates

According to a report by the United Nations, **despite having the lowest divorce rate globally (around 1.1%), India has witnessed a rise in divorce cases in the past few years**. This trend is even more prominent for couples who have been in long-term marriages of 20 years or more. There has been a **350% increase in divorce rates in India over the last two decades. 53% of divorces filed in India are by people aged 25-34 years old.**

- For Hindus, Buddhists, Jains, and Sikhs, divorce proceedings are governed by the **Hindu Marriage Act of 1955. Muslims adhere to the Dissolution of Muslim Marriages Act of 1939.**
- For Parsis, the **Parsi Marriage and Divorce Act of 1936** applies, while Christians are guided by the **Indian Divorce Act of 1869. Inter-community marriages fall under the purview of the Special Marriages Act of 1954.**

Reasons for an increasing rate of divorce

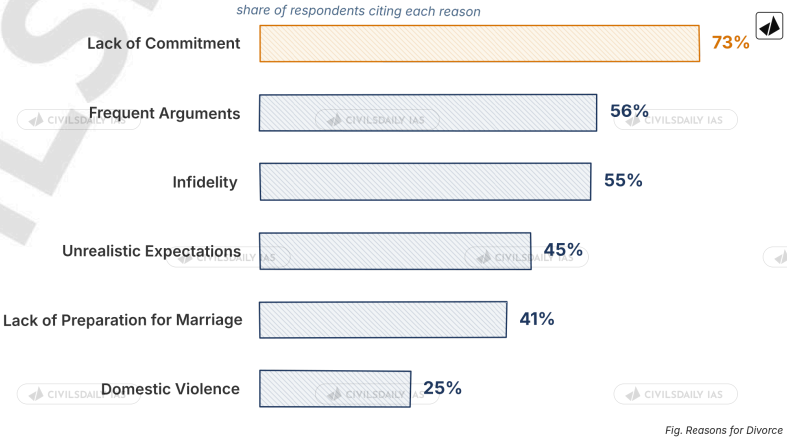


Fig. Reasons for Divorce

1. **Divorce among older couples :** As children leave home and couples enter the **empty-nest phase**, they may find themselves rediscovering each other and facing new challenges.
2. **Infidelity and trust :** Its occurrence is more common in longer-term marriages due to the greater opportunities for connection and temptation that exist in today's interconnected world.
3. **Economic Independence of Women** reduced tolerance for patriarchal marriages.
4. **Changing Attitudes towards Marriage** - Marriage is increasingly viewed as a **partnership based on compatibility**, not an unbreakable sacrament.
5. **Reduced Social Stigma Around Divorce** : Divorce is no longer viewed as an absolute social failure.
6. **Urbanisation and Nuclear Families** : Reduced influence of extended family mediation.
7. **Higher Education Levels** : Education raises awareness of **rights, self-worth, and legal remedies**.
8. **Changing Gender Roles** : Conflict arising from a mismatch in expectations of domestic and professional roles.
9. **Legal Awareness and Judicial Access** : Easier access to courts and simplified divorce procedures. Eg. Mutual consent divorce under the **Hindu Marriage Act, 1955**.
10. **Influence of Globalisation and Media** : Exposure to global norms normalising divorce.

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Live in Relationships

Recently, the Uttarakhand government tabled the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) 2024 Bill in the Uttarakhand Assembly. All live-in relationships will have to be registered with the registering authority notified under the law. If any of the partners is less than 21 years old, the registrar will inform the parents of the couple and forward the registration to the local police station. Children born out of live-in relationships will have all legal rights. If one of the partners is married, they will not be allowed.

In **Velusamy v. Patchaiammal (2010)**, the SC granted women the right to claim maintenance under the **Domestic Violence Act**.

In **S. Khushboo v. Kanniammal (2010)**, the SC dropped all charges against the actress, stating that living together is an extension of the **Right to Life (Article 21)**

Arguments in favor

1. **Individual Autonomy and Choice** Recognised under **Article 21 (Right to Life and Personal Liberty)** by the Supreme Court.
2. **Legal Recognition and Protection** : I**ndra Sarma v. V.K.V. Sarma (2013)** recognised live-in relationships under the **Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act, 2005**.
3. **Legal Precedents Supporting Legitimacy** : Children born from live-in relationships are legally protected.
4. **Alignment with Constitutional Morality** : Upholds dignity, privacy, and freedom over social morality. Principles reaffirmed in **Navtej Singh Johar (2018)** and **Puttaswamy (2017)**.
5. **Compatibility Assessment** : Allows partners to test emotional and practical compatibility before marriage.
6. **Gender Equality** : Challenges patriarchal control over women's relationships and choices.
7. **Changing Social Realities** : Reflects urbanisation, education, and modern work patterns.
8. **Reduction in Forced Marriages** : Offers an alternative to early or forced marriages.

Arguments against

1. **Social Non-Acceptance** - Eg. social stigma in rural and semi-urban areas.
2. **Erosion of Traditional Family Values** : Seen as weakening the institution of marriage.
3. **Vulnerability of Women** : Absence of marital safeguards may expose women to exploitation.
4. **Psychological Insecurity** : Lack of long-term commitment can create emotional instability.
5. **Impact on Children** : Concerns about identity, social acceptance, and legal clarity.
6. **Cultural Disconnect** : Live-in relationships conflict with the sacramental view of marriage in India.
7. **Risk of Misuse** : Potential misuse to evade legal responsibilities of marriage. Eg. avoidance of alimony or inheritance obligations.
8. **Urban-Centric Phenomenon** - Not reflective of broader socio-economic realities of India.

Way forward

1. **Legal Reforms: E**stablish Clear Legal Protections similar to those available to married couples.
2. **Public Awareness Campaigns** to change societal perceptions and promote Social Acceptance.
3. **Support Systems: P**rovide access to counseling and support services for couples in live-in relationships to help them navigate challenges and strengthen their bonds.
4. **Workplace Policies: Eg. workplace diversity training programs** to promote understanding and acceptance of different relationship forms.

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Chapter 2

Caste System

A caste system is defined as a system that comprises several endogamous groups, recruited by birth, with hereditary membership, which within the group determines many behaviours, expectations, obligations, and evaluation of individuals.

The caste system is underpinned by values of **ritual purity and impurity**, which justify segregation and division of labour. Eg. Only Brahmins can lead religious rituals.

Mahatma Gandhi : If Hindu society has been able to stand, it is because it is founded on the caste system".

Ambedkar : On caste

- "Caste is not just a division of labour; it is a division of labourers."
- "The caste system is not a divine institution. It is a human institution that can be changed by human effort.

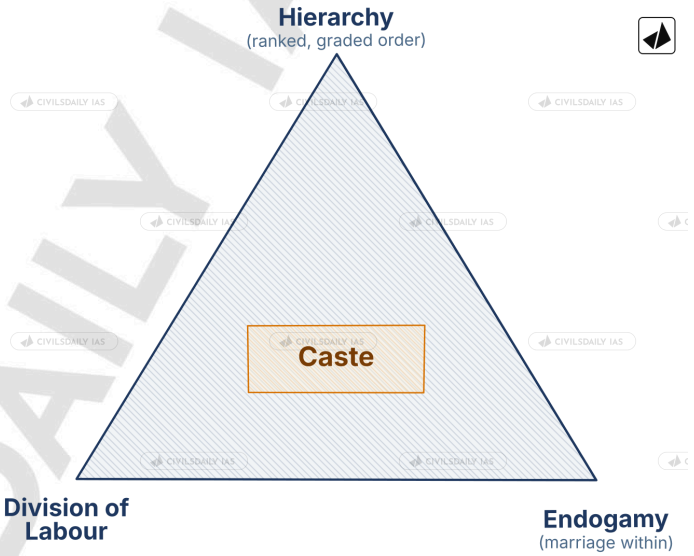


Fig. The Caste System

Karl Marx, in his essay on **'The Future Results of British Rule in India',** characterised the Indian castes as **"the most decisive impediment to India's progress and power".**

Sociological Theories related to a caste system

1. **Functionalist Theory - G.S. Ghurye, M.N. Srinivas :** Caste functions as a **system of social organisation,** ensuring role allocation and social order. Eg. Jajmani system.
2. **Structural-Functionalism** : **Louis Dumont :** Caste based on **hierarchy of purity and pollution**, not economic class.
3. **Marxist Theory - Karl Marx, D.D. Kosambi** : Caste as a tool of **economic exploitation** and control of labour.
4. **Weberian Theory** : Caste as a **status group**, not merely an economic class. Eg. Endogamy maintains caste boundaries.
5. **Sanskritisation Theory - M.N. Srinivas** : Lower castes adopt practices of upper castes to achieve upward mobility.
6. **Dominant Caste Theory** : Power is determined by **numerical strength, land ownership, and political influence**, not ritual status alone. Eg. Jats in Haryana, Marathas in Maharashtra.
7. **Subaltern Perspective - B.R. Ambedkar** : Caste as a system of **graded inequality** and denial of human dignity.

Characteristics of the Caste System

1. **Hierarchy** : Caste groups are arranged in a graded social order from high to low.
2. **Ascription by Birth** : Caste membership is determined at birth and is unchangeable.
3. **Endogamy** : Strict rules governing marriage within one's own caste.

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4. **Occupational Fixity** : Traditional linkage between caste and occupation.
5. **Purity and Pollution** : Ritual purity determines social status and interaction.
6. **Restrictions on Social Interaction** : Eg. separate utensils for lower castes in earlier periods.
7. **Social and Religious Disabilities** : Lower castes faced exclusion from temples and education.
8. **Hereditary Social Status** : Social prestige and stigma are passed across generations.
9. **Segmental Division of Society** : Society is divided into multiple closed groups.
10. **Jajmani System** : Interdependent economic relationships between castes.
11. **Social Control Mechanisms** : Enforcement of caste norms through community pressure. Eg. caste panchayats.

Difference between caste and varna system -

Aspect	Varna System	Caste System (Jati)
Origin	Rooted in **Vedic texts** (Eg. Rigveda, Manusmriti)	Evolved from **historical socio-economic stratification** over centuries
Number of Categories	**4 broad varnas**: Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya, Shudra	**3,000+ jatis** (sub-castes) with regional and occupational variation
Basis of Classification	**Guna (quality)** and **karma (deed)** as per Bhagavad Gita	**Birth-based and hereditary**, linked to occupation, marriage, and ritual status
Mobility	Theoretically **flexible**; status could change with learning/occupation	**Rigid**; no mobility; caste determined by **birth**
Nature	**Idealistic and philosophical** construct	**Practical, localized**, and socially **enforced reality**
Untouchability	Does **not include Dalits/Avarnas** within the 4 varnas	**Institutionalized untouchability** and **exclusion** of Dalits
Social Function	Aimed at **division of labor** in harmony (functionalist ideal)	Created **hierarchy and inequality** with **privilege and oppression**
Religious Sanction	Supported by **Hindu scriptures**	Reinforced by **customs, practices**, and **ritual purity** codes
Current Relevance	Mostly **theoretical or symbolic** in modern society	**Still active** in politics, marriage, and social behavior

Relevance of Caste in Understanding Indian Society

Aspect	Arguments in Favour (Caste is Relevant)	Arguments Against (Caste is Losing Relevance)
Social Hierarchy	Caste still defines **status, respect, and purity** in many communities,	Urbanization and education have promoted **egalitarian norms**. Class

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Aspect	Arguments in Favour (Caste is Relevant)	Arguments Against (Caste is Losing Relevance)
	especially in rural India. (**Srinivas : Dominant Caste**).	now overshadows caste in many contexts. (**Béteille**).
Politics and Elections	Caste remains central to **vote bank politics**; caste-based parties like BSP, SP thrive. (**Rajni Kothari, Yogendra Yadav**).	Many voters now focus on **development, governance, and leadership**, diluting caste's political hold.
Marriage and Kinship	**Over 90%** of marriages are within caste, proving endogamy's persistence. (**Karve, IHDS 2011**)	Inter-caste marriages and urban anonymity are rising, especially in educated, mobile populations.
Economic Disparities	**Dalits and OBCs face hiring discrimination**, unequal access to credit, and land. (**Ashwini Deshpande**).	Global markets and skill-based jobs reduce the role of caste in **private sector employment**.
Urban and Regional Presence	Caste clusters exist even in cities; housing segregation is common. (**Béteille**).	Cities promote **cosmopolitan, meritocratic values** and cross-caste socialization.
Legal and Institutional Structures	Affirmative action (reservations, SC/ST laws) requires **categorical caste identification**.	Affirmative actions promote social mobility and make caste irrelevant
Daily Social Life	Caste governs access to **temples, wells, festivals, and rituals** in many regions.	In modern urban contexts, **caste-based ritual exclusions** are often symbolic or irrelevant.
Violence and Discrimination	Caste-based violence and atrocities persist (Eg. **Hathras, Khairlanji**), showing **deep-rooted oppression**.	Legal awareness, media activism, and civil society have **reduced impunity** in many cases.
Identity and Mobilization	Caste offers a source of **identity and collective assertion**, especially among SC/ST/OBC groups.	Identity is increasingly shaped by **profession, language, region, and gender**, not just caste.

Major challenges of the Caste System

Category	Challenge	Elaboration
Political	Underrepresentation in Power Structures	SC/ST communities remain marginal in leadership and bureaucracy, weakening policy voice (2024 policy reports).
	Caste-based Violence and Atrocities	NCRB (2022): Crimes against SCs up by **13.1%**, against STs by **14.3%**; UP and Rajasthan top the list.

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Category	Challenge	Elaboration
	Vote Bank Fragmentation	Caste identity used for political mobilization, deepening sectionalism (Yadav & Kothari).
	Hindrance to National Unity	Demand for Jat reservation and agitation by the Patidar community.
Institutional	Manual Scavenging (90% Dalits) and Occupational Hazard	3 deaths in Bikaner (May 2025) highlight systemic failure.
	Educational Backwardness and Dropouts	Higher dropout rates among Dalit students due to caste bias and low cultural capital (ASER 2023).
	Mental Health Inequality	2024 studies link caste discrimination to high anxiety and depression among Dalits; care systems lack inclusivity. Eg. Rohith Vemula case
Economic	Social Stratification and Job Exclusion	SC/STs are overrepresented in informal work and underrepresented in white-collar sectors (Deshpande & Ramachandran 2024).
	Check on economic-intellectual advancement.	Undermines the efficiency of labor and **prevents perfect mobility of labor**, capital, and productive effort
	Occupational Segregation	Caste still dictates labor roles; sanitation and manual work are dominated by Dalits (Safai Karamchari data 2024).
	Inequitable Access to Resources	2024 sanitation study shows lower caste homes lack access to clean water/toilets (ScienceDirect).
Social	Low Rate of Inter-Caste Marriage	IHDS 2024: Only **~5%** of marriages are inter-caste, showing strong endogamy and social closure.
	Urban Discrimination and Exclusion	JNU study (2024): Dalits face rental and job discrimination even in cities like Delhi and Mumbai.
	Hardships on women	Eg. Honor killings in Haryana
	An obstacle to Modernization	Eg. Ban on girls wearing jeans in Khap Panchayats.

Reasons for the Continuance of Caste-Based Discrimination in the Modern Age:

1. **Deep-Rooted Socialisation** : Caste norms internalised through family and community upbringing. Eg. Endogamy and food taboos continue across generations.
2. **Endogamy and Control over Marriage :** Continued insistence on intra-caste marriages preserves caste boundaries; IHDS (2024) shows only ~5% inter-caste marriages in India.
3. **Caste in Urban and Institutional Spaces :** Urban housing, jobs, and education still reflect caste preferences; a JNU (2024) study shows rental bias against Dalits in metros.

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4. **Economic Inequality** : Historical deprivation limits the mobility of lower castes. Eg. over 90% of manual scavengers are Dalits
5. **Persistence of Caste in Politics :** Political parties mobilize caste blocs for electoral gain, which reinforces caste identities rather than weakening them.
6. **Digital Reinforcement of Caste Identities -** Matrimonial apps and social media retain caste filters and identifiers, reasserting caste boundaries in modern settings.
7. **Institutional Apathy and Poor Law Enforcement : D**espite strong laws like the SC/ST Atrocities Act, underreporting and weak prosecution allow discrimination to continue.
8. **Lack of Representation in Power Structures : D**alits and backward castes are underrepresented in the judiciary, academia, media, and corporate leadership.
9. **Resistance to Reservation : P**ushback from upper castes against affirmative action creates social tension and resentment, reinforcing discriminatory attitudes.
10. **Traditional power relations persist in villages**. Eg. Dominance of upper castes in land ownership.
11. **Educational and Digital Divide** - Eg. Higher dropout rates among SC/ST students.
12. **Intersection with Other Inequalities** : Caste intersects with gender and class. Eg. Dalit women facing multiple forms of discrimination.

Difference between the urban and rural caste systems

Aspect	Rural Caste System	Urban Caste System
Nature of Caste	Rigid and traditional	Relatively flexible
Basis of Status	Birth-based hierarchy dominates	Education, income, and profession increasingly matter
Occupational Link	Strong caste-occupation linkage	Occupational mobility common
Social Interaction	Restricted inter-caste interaction	Greater social mixing
Endogamy	Strictly enforced	Gradual increase in inter-caste marriages
Purity and Pollution	Actively practiced	Largely diluted
Social Control	Caste panchayats influential	Formal legal institutions dominate
Economic Relations	Jajmani system prevalent	Market-based relations
Political Mobilisation	Caste-based local dominance	Caste is used more as identity politics
Discrimination	Open and visible	Subtle and institutional

Suggestions to Eradicate the Caste System

1. **Revise NCERT and state board textbooks to include anti-caste history, laws, and real case studies.**
2. **Launch a centralised portal for anonymous reporting of caste discrimination in schools and colleges.**
3. **Link disbursal of RUSA and NAAC funds to caste inclusion in faculty hiring :** Institutions failing to meet SC/ST/OBC recruitment norms should face academic funding penalties.

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4. **Enforce the 60-day disbursal of the ₹5 lakh incentive under the Dr. Ambedkar Inter-caste Marriage Scheme.**
5. **Issue mandatory guidelines to matrimonial websites and apps to remove caste as a filter**
6. **Create an anti-caste media fund under the Ministry of I&B : S**upport independent Dalit and Adivasi content creators, YouTube channels, podcasts, and print media.
7. **Make caste-sensitivity training mandatory in all police training academies and judicial academies.**
8. **Create a National Caste Discrimination Index : U**se indicators like housing segregation, atrocity rates, inter-caste marriage data, and education equity.

Dalit movements

Ghanshyam Shah classifies Dalit movements into two categories: **reformative and alternative**. Reformative movements aim to reform the caste system to address the problem of untouchability. In contrast, alternative movements seek to create a new socio-cultural structure through religious conversion, education, economic advancement, and political power.

Category	Name	Description
Movements	Dalit Panthers	A radical movement founded in 1972 in Maharashtra, inspired by the Black Panthers.
	Bhim Army	Founded in 2015 by Chandrashekhar Azad in Uttar Pradesh, focuses on Dalit rights.
	Namantar Andolan	A movement for renaming Marathwada University after Dr. B.R. Ambedkar.
	Elgar Parishad	Organised in 2017 to commemorate the Battle of Bhima Koregaon and highlight Dalit issues.
Entrepreneurs	Kalpana Saroj	CEO of Kamani Tubes, often referred to as the original 'Slumdog Millionaire'.
	Milind Kamble	Founder of the Dalit Indian Chamber of Commerce and Industry (DICCI).
	Ashok Khade	CEO of DAS Offshore Engineering, a successful entrepreneur in the oil and gas sector.
	Parmeshwar Pansare	Founder of Jai Bhim Vikas Education Foundation, promoting education among Dalits.
	Suraj Yengde	Dalit intellectual and author of "Caste Matters", involved in various entrepreneurial ventures.
Atrocities	Hathras Case (2020)	Gang rape and murder of a Dalit woman
	Una Flogging Incident (2016)	Public flogging of Dalit men in Una, Gujarat, for allegedly skinning a dead cow.

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Category	Name	Description
	Rohith Vemula (2016)	Suicide of a Dalit PhD student at Hyderabad Central University due to caste discrimination.
	Bhima Koregaon Violence (2018)	Clashes during the commemoration of the Battle of Bhima Koregaon highlighted caste tensions and resulted in several arrests.
	Sikar Case (2019)	A Dalit man in Sikar, Rajasthan, was beaten to death for allegedly stealing water from a higher-caste family's well.
	Tamil Nadu Caste Violence (2022)	In July 2022, a Dalit boy in Tamil Nadu was attacked and killed for reportedly drawing water from an upper-caste well.
	Telangana Case (2023)	In February 2023, a Dalit woman in Telangana was assaulted and paraded naked for resisting land encroachment by upper-caste individuals.
	Karnataka Incident (2023)	In September 2023, a Dalit man was beaten to death in Karnataka for allegedly entering a temple.
	Uttar Pradesh Incident (2024)	In March 2024, a Dalit family in Uttar Pradesh was attacked, and their house was set on fire due to a land dispute with upper-caste individuals.
	Madhya Pradesh Case (2024)	In May 2024, a Dalit girl in Madhya Pradesh was assaulted and left critically injured by upper-caste men for refusing to work in their fields.
	Peeing Incident (2023)	In July 2023, a video surfaced showing a man urinating on a Dalit youth in Sidhi, Madhya Pradesh.
	Tamil Nadu	Around 200 Dalit families threatened to embrace Islam after they were denied permission to attend a temple festival in **the Karur** region.

Case	Judgment
Dr. Subhash Kashinath Mahajan vs. State of Maharashtra	Required prior sanction for prosecuting public servants under the SC/ST Act; later overturned due to backlash.
State of Karnataka vs. Appa Balu Ingale	Social boycotts of Dalits are unconstitutional; emphasized the need to protect Dalits' dignity and equality.
Lata Singh vs. State of Uttar Pradesh	Adults have the right to marry anyone of their choice; harassment or violence against inter-caste couples is illegal.

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Case	Judgment
Union of India vs. R. Rajesh	Upheld reservation in promotions for SC/ST employees in government jobs to ensure equality.

Present Trend

1. **Increased Militancy:** This trend reflects a growing frustration with persistent discrimination and a demand for more immediate and tangible changes. Eg. **Elgar Parishad** and subsequent violence in Bhima Koregaon in 2018.
2. **Sub-caste Assertion:** This trend highlights the diversity within the Dalit community and addresses intra-caste inequalities and discrimination. Eg. **Matang Samaj Sangharsh Samiti.**
3. **Middle-class Activism:** This group uses its resources and education to advocate for Dalit rights and to challenge systemic inequalities. Eg. **Dalit Indian Chamber of Commerce and Industry (DICCI).**
4. **Public Symbolism:** The use of symbols, public rallies, and cultural events has become more prominent in the Dalit movement. This helps in raising awareness, fostering unity, and keeping the issues of Dalit rights in the public eye. Eg. celebration of **Ambedkar Jayanti.**
5. **Rightward Shift:** This shift involves aligning with political parties or ideologies that promise economic development and social mobility, albeit sometimes at the cost of broader social justice goals. Eg. **Republican Party of India (Athawale)** faction.

Positive impact

Social Mobility and Empowerment

1. **Increased Representation**: Eg. Ram Nath Kovind.
2. **Educational Opportunities**: Reservation policies have increased Dalit enrollment in higher education. In 2022, over 14% of students in higher education institutions belonged to Scheduled Castes (SC).
3. **Economic Upliftment**: The Dalit Indian Chamber of Commerce and Industry (DICCI) reports that there are now over 5,000 Dalit-owned enterprises contributing significantly to the economy. Eg. Kalpana Saroj, CEO of Kamani Tubes.

Reduction of Social Discrimination

1. **Abolition of Untouchability**: Legal reforms like the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989, have led to a reduction in practices of untouchability.
2. **Awareness and Advocacy**: Movements such as the **Dalit Panthers** have raised awareness and advocated for Dalit rights, leading to a more inclusive society.

Cultural Revival and Identity Formation

1. **Cultural Assertion**: The contributions of Dalit leaders and activists are now more widely recognized and celebrated, leading to a broader acceptance and respect for Dalit identity.
2. **Literary Contributions**: Dalit assertion has led to the revival and preservation of Dalit culture and history, promoting pride in their heritage and countering negative stereotypes.

Political Mobilization and Activism

1. **Political Organisations**: The Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP) has mobilised Dalits politically, helping them secure political representation and influence.
2. **Grassroots Movements:** Movements like the Ambedkarite movement have empowered local Dalit communities to fight against caste injustices.

Legal Reforms and Constitutional Safeguards

1. **Legal Framework**: Laws such as the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act have provided legal recourse for Dalits facing caste-based violence.

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Societal Attitudes and Norms

1. **Changing Mindsets**: Dalit movements have contributed to changing societal attitudes towards caste, promoting more inclusive and egalitarian values.
2. **Inter-Caste Interactions**: Increased social interactions between different castes have led to a gradual reduction in caste-based prejudices.

Major Issues

1. **Manual Scavenging** : O**ver 400 people died** cleaning sewers/septic tanks between 2018 and 2023. 100% of these victims belong to Dalit sub-castes.
2. **Landlessness** : I**ndia Human Development Survey (IHDS)** reveals that nearly **60% of Dalit households** are landless agricultural laborers, compared to only 25% of Forward Castes.
3. **Workplace Discrimination** - "Upper-caste" networks create a glass ceiling in the private sector where no reservations exist.
4. **Educational Attrition** : Institutional bias and "merit" stigmas lead to higher dropout rates among marginalized students in elite colleges.
5. **Representation in Judiciary** - nearly **79% of High Court judges** appointed in the last five years belonged to the General Category.
6. **Atrocities Against Women** : Dalit women face a "double burden" of gender and caste-based violence with low legal redress. Eg. Hatras rape case.
7. **Residential Apartheid** : Urbanization has not erased segregation; it has simply modernized it into "ghettos" and "gated communities."

Way Forward

1. **Transition to "Dalit Capitalism"** : Strengthening the **Stand-Up India** scheme and supporting the **Dalit Indian Chamber of Commerce and Industry (DICCI)** to build independent wealth.
2. Adopting the **"Diversity Disclosure"** model, where Indian firms publicly report the social composition of their workforce to ensure inclusive hiring.
3. Implementing the Supreme Court's **State of Punjab (2024)** verdict on sub-categorization to prevent "creamy layer" saturation.
4. Enacting the **"Rohith Act"** to create mandatory anti-discrimination cells and sensitize faculty in premier institutes like IITs and AIIMS.
5. Increasing the representation of Dalits in the **Cabinet Secretariat** and as **Heads of Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs)**, where they currently hold less than 10% of top-tier positions.
6. **Legal Literacy and Support** : Establishing **Caste-Specific Legal Aid Clinics** and ensuring that **25% of police officers** at the station level are from marginalized communities.

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Chapter 3

Communalism And Secularism

PYQs

[2023] Discuss the impact of the post-liberal economy on ethnic identity and communalism.

[2022] Are tolerance, assimilation, and pluralism the key elements in the making of an Indian form of secularism? Justify your answer.

[2019] What are the challenges to our cultural practices in the name of secularism? (10m,150 words)

[2018] Communalism arises either due to power struggle or relative deprivation. Argue by giving suitable illustrations.

[2018] How is the Indian concept of secularism different from the Western model of secularism? Discuss.

[2017] Distinguish between religiousness/religiosity and communalism, giving one example of how the former has transformed into the latter in independent India.

[2014] How do the Indian debates on secularism differ from the debates in the West?

Communalism

Communalism is an aggressive political ideology linked to religion. According to **Bipan Chandra**, communalism is a belief system in which a group of people who practice a particular religion share similar social, political, and economic interests.

Ram Ahuja defined communalism as a belief that is characterized by strong antagonism practiced by the members of one community against the people of another community.

Communalism is about politics and not about religion. Although communalists are intensely involved with religion, there is no necessary relationship between personal faith and communalism. The key factor is the attitude towards those who believe in other kinds of identities, including other religion-based identities.

"Communalism is the negation of the spirit of religion. The communalist is a traitor to the cause of religion and to his own nation." - **Jawaharlal Nehru.**

"The poison of communalism should not be allowed to spread. It is the duty of every Indian to ensure that communal harmony is maintained and that we do not let divisive forces tear our country apart." : **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel.**

"The idea of India, as a nation, should be inclusive, embracing all its diverse elements. Communalism is a scourge that undermines the very essence of our unity." : **Rabindranath Tagore.**

"Communalism is fundamentally a form of sectarianism, which seeks to divide and polarize society. It thrives on fear and mistrust" **: Amartya Sen.**

"Communalism is a pathology of the collective mind. It turns legitimate concerns for cultural survival into paranoia and hatred." **: Ashis Nandy.**

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"Communalism is a manifestation of the failure of the state to protect the rights and identities of all its citizens equally. It is a sign of political decay and social fragmentation." : R**ajni Kothari.**

Historical background

1. **Ancient India** was united with no communal feelings; people were tolerant of other cultures and traditions. This can be seen in **Ashoka's Dhamma,** which focused on religious tolerance.
2. In medieval history, it was Babur who, for the first time, used Jihad (religious war) in India to gain the support of his army when he lost his kingdom in Fergana to his uncle.
3. But even in **medieval India**, few rulers were tolerant of other religions. Eg. establishment of **Din-i-ilahi** and **Ibadat Khana by Akbar**.
4. However, Rulers like Aurangzeb, known for their intolerance towards other religions, deepened communal differences in India by imposing taxes on non-Muslim practices, destroying temples, enforcing conversions, and killing Sikh gurus.
5. Communalism in modern India is a 20th-century concept. It is a product of **the divide-and-rule** policy of the British.
    a. **Partition of Bengal in 1905**
    b. **Religious Revivalism in 1924**: The Shuddhi and Sangathan movements among the Hindus and the Tabligh and Tanzim religious movements among the Muslims invoked religious revivalism.
    c. **Communal Violence (1923-30)**: The violence began with the Moplah Rebellion, which intensified hatred among the Hindus and Muslims in the Malabar region. The most serious riots happened at Saharanpur in connection with the Muharram festival.
    d. **Communal Award, 1932**: To fuel communalism and appease various communities, the British provided separate representation for Muslims, Sikhs, Anglo-Indians, Indian Christians, Europeans, Landlords, the depressed classes, and commerce and industry.

Pre-Independence (Liberal Phase)

- Communalism in India got its initial start in the 1880s when **Syed Ahmed Khan** opposed the national movement initiated by the Indian National Congress.
- Prominent Muslims like Aga Khan, Nawab Moshin-ul-Mulk, etc., founded the **All India Muslim League** to consolidate Muslim interests.
- Simultaneously, **Hindu communalism** was manifested in organizations like the **Punjab Hindu Sabha** (1909), **All India Hindu Mahasabha**, etc.
- **Revivalist movements** like Arya Samaj, Shuddhi Movement (among Hindus), Wahhabi Movement (among Muslims), etc., gave further impetus to communalist tendencies.

Pre-independence (Extremist Phase)

- **Post-1937**, India witnessed extreme communalism based on the **politics of fear, psychosis, and irrationality**. Communalism also became the only political recourse of colonial authorities and their **policy of divide and rule.**
- **M.A. Jinnah** declared that Muslims would be suppressed under the Hindu-dominated Congress after the British left India. Thus, the only recourse would be a separate state for Muslims, i.e., the creation of **Pakistan.**
- The Hindu Mahasabha and the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) demanded that the non-Hindu groups of India adopt the Hindu culture and language and hold the Hindu religion in reverence.

1. **Post Independence**
    a. **Partition of India, 1947 :** The 1947 Partition led to mass displacement and violence, with millions migrating and widespread killings and rapes. Refugee rehabilitation became a significant challenge.

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b. No major communal disturbances occurred until 1961, when the **Jabalpur riots** erupted due to economic competition between Hindu and Muslim bidi manufacturers.
c. **Anti-Sikh Riots, 1984 :** Following Prime Minister Indira Gandhi's assassination by her Sikh bodyguards, anti-Sikh riots resulted in thousands of Sikh deaths and widespread violence.
d. **Ethnic Cleansing of Kashmiri Pandits, 1989 : E**xtremist Islamic terrorism in Kashmir in 1989 led to the mass killing and exodus of Kashmiri Pandits, who became refugees in their own country.
e. **Babri Masjid Demolition, 1992 :** The 1992 demolition of the Babri Masjid by Hindu activists led to extensive riots and heightened Hindu-Muslim tensions.
f. **Gujarat Riots, 2002 :** A fire on the Sabarmati Express in 2002 ignited severe Hindu-Muslim violence in Gujarat, resulting in extensive loss of life and ongoing legal battles.
g. **Assam Communal Violence, 2012 :** In 2012, ethnic clashes between Bodos and Bengali-speaking Muslims in Assam led to significant violence and fatalities.
h. **Muzaffarnagar Violence, 2013 :** Ethnic clashes between Jats and Muslims in Muzaffarnagar in 2013, fueled by social media and eve-teasing incidents, resulted in substantial violence.
i. **Delhi Riots, 2020 : I**n February 2020, communal violence over the Citizenship Amendment Act (CAA) led to over 50 deaths, hundreds of injuries, and widespread homelessness in Delhi.

Stages of Communalism

Bipan Chandra in "India's Struggle for Freedom" has given 3 elements:

1. **Communal Consciousness:** Described as "the first bedrock of communal ideology." It is a belief that people from similar religious communities have common secular interests, such as political, economic, social, and cultural interests. Eg. formation of the Muslim League in 1906.

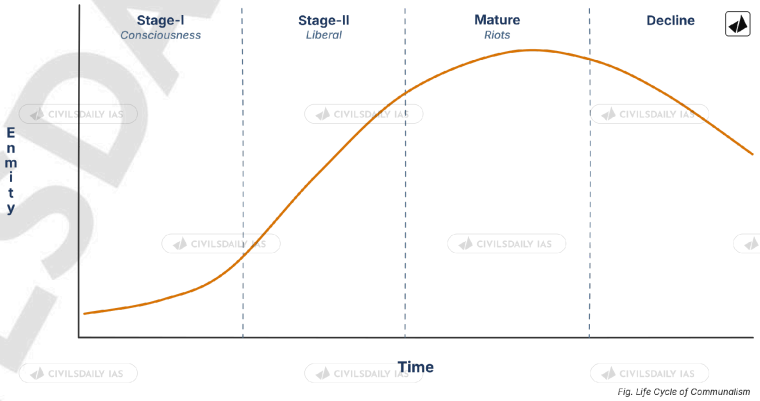


Fig. Life Cycle of Communalism

2. **Liberal communalism:** The belief that people belonging to different religious communities do not share common secular interests, be they social, economic, cultural, or political. This belief leads to a perception of division and separateness among different religious communities. Eg. Hindu Mahasabha's ideology in the early 20th century.
3. **Extreme communalism**: The stage where relationships between different religious communities are seen as mutually incompatible, hostile, and antagonistic. This perception leads to open conflict and deep-seated enmity among communities. Eg. Partition of India in 1947.

Features of Communalism

1. **Religious Identity as the Primary Marker : C**ommunalism promotes a singular religious identity as the core of a person's political and social self, reducing diversity within communities. Eg. Labeling all Muslims as a monolithic voting bloc.
2. **Perception of Conflict Between Religious Communities (***Zero-sum mindset***) -** It thrives on the belief that the interests of different religious groups are mutually incompatible and adversarial. Eg. speech by Pakistan Army Chief Asif Munir.
3. **Historical Revisionism and Distortion of the Past : C**ommunal narratives often reinterpret history to emphasize religious conflicts (Eg. Mughals vs. Rajputs), fueling mistrust. Eg. portraying the medieval period solely as "Muslim oppression" of Hindus.
4. **Political Mobilization on Religious Lines : Eg.** use of slogans or religious processions for electoral gain.

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5. **Belief in the Superiority of One's Own Community** in terms of culture, religion, and social values. This sense of superiority can lead to **exclusionary practices and discrimination** against other communities.
6. **Economic Competition : C**ommunalism often frames economic disparities and competition as issues between different religious communities. Eg. The 1961 Jabalpur riots stemmed from an economic rivalry between Hindu and Muslim bidi manufacturers.
7. **Social Segregation :** Eg. Segregated residential areas, schools, and workplaces create echo chambers where communal prejudices are reinforced.
8. **Institutional Bias : C**ommunalism can infiltrate state and societal institutions, leading to biased practices and policies that discriminate against certain communities.
9. **Use of Religion to Justify Violence : C**ommunalism often legitimizes aggression against "others" in the name of protecting one's religion. Eg. riots in Gujarat (2002), Muzaffarnagar (2013), or Delhi (2020) rooted in communal polarization.
10. **Dehumanization of the 'Other' Community : I**t paints the other community as a threat, often using stereotypes and hate speech. Eg. labelling all members of a religious group as terrorists, anti-national, or foreign agents.
11. **Opposition to Secularism and Pluralism : C**ommunalism rejects the idea of *composite culture* or *Sarva Dharma Sambhava* (equal respect for all faiths), promoting majoritarianism. Eg. opposing mixed marriages, shared festivals, or secular curriculum in schools.
12. **Spread Through Rumors and Propaganda: I**t uses misinformation via social media, pamphlets, and speeches to create panic and mobilize hatred. Eg. fake videos circulated during the Delhi riots (2020) to incite violence.
13. **Psychological Fear and Victimhood Narrative : Eg.** claims of "religious population imbalance" to create fear of cultural extinction.
14. **Organizational Support and Radicalization : Eg.** training camps, hate rallies, and extremist preaching in the name of religious awakening.

Types of Communalism

Sociologist T.K. Oommen has given 6 fold classification

Dimension	Description	Example
Assimilationist	Small religious groups are integrated into larger ones.	The integration of smaller Christian denominations into mainstream Protestantism.
Welfarist	Focus on the welfare and betterment of a specific community.	JITO for the Jain community.
Retreatist	The community advises members to either participate in or abstain from politics.	Bahaism religion prohibits its members from political participation
Retaliatory	One community harms members of another in rivalry.	The 2002 Gujarat riots
Separatist	Demand for a distinct identity and separation from a larger group.	demand for Greater Nagalim, Bodoland, etc.
Secessionist	A group demands to secede from a state or nation for a separate political identity.	The demand for Khalistan and independent Tamil Eelam by the LTTE in Sri Lanka.

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Other Types

Type	Description	Example
Political Communalism	Use of communal identities for political mobilization. This leads to political polarization and communal violence.	Muslim League and Hindu Mahasabha
Economic Communalism	Economic disparities are framed as communal issues. It exacerbates economic inequalities and tensions.	Syed Ahmad Khan established the **Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental College** in 1875. Recent examples of the Twitter trend of banning Halal Meet.
Cultural Communalism	Emphasis on the cultural identity of a community. It manifests in cultural hegemony, violence, and the imposition of a dominant culture on others.	The burka tradition in the Muslim community. Promotion of Hindi as a national language and the resistance by Tamil Nadu.
Social Communalism	Community-oriented social behavior and practices. It reinforces social segregation and discrimination, hinders social integration, and perpetuates social inequality.	Opposition to Valentine's Day and violence by groups such as Bajrang Dal in Megacities.
Religious Communalism	Strict adherence to religious practices and beliefs leads to segregation. Promotes religious intolerance, social exclusion, and undermines secularism.	Certain orthodox Jewish communities in Israel promote religious exclusivity.
Ethnic Communalism	Focus on ethnic identity and solidarity. This leads to ethnic violence, displacement, and genocide.	Ethnic conflicts in Rwanda between Hutus and Tutsis. The recent conflict in Manipur between the Kuki and the Meitei.
Linguistic Communalism	Emphasis on linguistic identity and differences. It causes linguistic chauvinism and hinders national integration.	Tamil language rights movement in Sri Lanka.
Caste-Based Communalism	Focus on caste identity and hierarchy. It obstructs social mobility and undermines social cohesion.	Jat agitation for OBC status.

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Factors aiding Communalism in India

1. **Historical Legacy**
   a. **Colonial Policies:** The British adopted a 'Divide and Rule' strategy, fostering divisions between Hindus and Muslims. This was evident in the partition of Bengal in 1905, which was based on religious lines.
   b. **Partition of India:** The partition in 1947 led to large-scale violence and mass migrations, sowing seeds of distrust and hostility between communities. Over a million people were killed, and 15 million were displaced.
2. **Political Factors**
   a. **Identity Politics : S**trong identification with religion over national identity is misused by politicians to mobilize support. Eg. **The demolition of the Babri Masjid in 1992** was used by some political groups to polarize voters.
   b. **Secularism Implementation:** Weak enforcement of secular principles has allowed communal ideologies to flourish. The lack of strict action against hate speech by political leaders contributes to the problem.
3. **Economic Factors**
   a. **Economic Disparities:** Economic inequality exacerbates communal tensions. In regions with high poverty rates, such as Uttar Pradesh and Bihar, there are frequent communal clashes due to competition for resources.
   b. **Unemployment:** High unemployment rates among youth make them vulnerable to communal propaganda. Eg. The 2013 Muzaffarnagar riots had significant participation from unemployed youths.
4. **Social Factors**
   a. **Caste and Religion:** The overlap of caste and religious identities strengthens communal divisions. In many parts of India, such as Tamil Nadu, caste-based and religious tensions often intersect.
   b. **Cultural Practices:** Practices like **'ghar wapsi'** (reconversion to Hinduism) by some groups and issues like beef consumption, Hindi/Urdu imposition create friction between religious communities.
5. **Media and Communication**
   a. **Sensationalism:** Media often sensationalizes communal issues for TRPs, worsening tensions. During the Delhi riots of 2020, certain news channels were accused of biased reporting that incited further violence.
   b. **Social Media:** Platforms like Facebook and WhatsApp are used to spread communal propaganda quickly. Fake news and inflammatory posts played a significant role in the 2018 Dhule mob lynching incident.
6. **Weak Governance and Law Enforcement**
   a. **Inadequate Response:** Often, there is a lack of timely action against communal violence. The slow response during the 2002 Gujarat riots.
   b. **Impunity:** Perpetrators of communal violence often go unpunished, emboldening others. The 1984 anti-Sikh riots saw many culprits evading justice for decades.
7. **Religious Organizations :** Organizations like SIMI promote radical ideologies that contribute to communal tensions. The activities of these groups often incite violence and hatred.
8. **Psychological Causes**
   a. **Prejudices and Biases**: Deep-rooted prejudices and stereotypes against other religious communities fuel communal tensions. Eg. global rise in Islamophobia post 9/11 attacks.
   b. **Fear and Insecurity**: Perceptions of threat and fear, fueled by communal propaganda and incidents, lead to the rise of communalism. Eg. **Fear of demographic change** was a major factor behind the 2012 Assam riots between Bodos and Muslims.

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Theories on Communalism

1. **Ethnic Competition Theory** (Horowitz, 1985) : Communalism arises from competition between ethnic groups for limited resources, such as jobs, education, and political power.
2. **Primordialism** (Clifford Geertz, 1963) : Communalism is rooted in the ancient, deep-seated bonds of kinship, language, religion, and tradition. These bonds are seen as natural and immutable.
3. **Constructivism** (Benedict Anderson, 1983) : Communal identities are socially constructed through historical processes, colonial legacies, and political manipulation. These identities are flexible and can be reshaped by social and political changes.
4. **Instrumentalism** (Paul Brass, 1991) : Instrumentalism views communalism as a tool used by political elites to mobilize support and gain power. Communal identities are seen as instrumental in achieving political goals.
5. **Modernization Theory** (Karl Deutsch, 1961) : Communalism arises as a reaction to the disruptions caused by modernization and social change. As traditional social structures break down, people seek security in communal identities.
6. **Relative Deprivation Theory** (Ted Robert Gurr, 1970) -perceived discrepancies between expected and actual living standards fuel communalism. When a community feels deprived relative to others, it resorts to communalism as a form of protest.

Consequences of Communalism

Communal violence obstructs economic development, social progress, cultural assimilation, and political tolerance.

Political

1. **Political Polarization :** Communalism can lead to increased political polarization, with political parties exploiting religious divisions to gain support, thereby undermining democratic processes and secularism.
2. **Undermining National Unity :** People are guided by vested and narrow interests due to communalism; they tend to prioritize community interest over the national interest. Eg. Khalistan Movement.

Economic

1. **Hinders economic progress:** According to the **Global Peace Index** (2022), India ranked 72nd, and the economic cost of violence is as much as **6%** of GDP.
2. **Obstruction to Development :** Frequent communal riots in Uttar Pradesh have diverted government resources towards maintaining law and order, away from development initiatives.
3. **Threatens demographic dividend**: The flow of labor from productive activities is diverted to unproductive activities; this kills the vibrant demography in communal violence.

Social

1. **Social Segregation :** Communalism reinforces social divisions, leading to communities living in isolated enclaves with limited interaction, which perpetuates mistrust and hostility. Eg. In cities like Mumbai and Ahmedabad, distinct Hindu and Muslim neighborhoods have emerged, with minimal social interaction between the communities.
2. **Human Rights Violations :** Communal conflicts often lead to gross human rights violations, including mass killings, sexual violence, forced displacement, and destruction of property. Eg. Bilkis Bano.
3. **Displacement and Refugee Crises :** Eg. The 1989 exodus of Kashmiri Pandits from the Kashmir Valley due to communal violence led to a large displaced population living in refugee camps in Jammu and other parts of India.
4. **Sow suspicion in society:** Communalism sows the seeds of suspicion among the members of society, which puts the community at a disadvantage. Eg. Muslims were denied medical treatment for being suspected of being 'Super spreaders' during Covid-19.

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Cultural Erosion : Communalism can lead to the erosion of cultural heritage, as violence and segregation diminish the rich cultural exchanges that occur in a pluralistic society.

Psychological Trauma : Individuals and communities affected by communal violence often suffer from long-term psychological trauma, including anxiety, depression, and post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD).

Steps to check the growth of Communalism

1. **Encouraging Interfaith Dialogue**, cultural exchange programs, and educational initiatives to foster understanding and respect among different communities. Eg. **the Inter-religious Council of Kenya**, **Interfaith councils in the US.**
2. **Community Policing,** such as the **Jan Maithri Suraksha** project of **Kerala.**
3. **Addressing Socio-Economic Inequalities** to reduce competition and tensions between communities. (**Sachar Committee and Ranganath Mishra Commission**).
4. **Holding Political Leaders Accountable**: Strictly enforcing the Model Code of Conduct by the Election Commission of India to prevent communal rhetoric during elections.
5. **Media Monitoring**: strict implementation of the Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021, to regulate online content.
6. **Implementing Legal Measures**: Enforce strict laws against hate speech and communal violence under sections **153A and 295A** of the Indian Penal Code.
7. **Educational Reforms : A**martya Sen emphasizes the role of education in promoting a sense of shared identity and reducing communal prejudices.
8. **Civil Society Engagement : E**ngagement with NGOs like the Citizens for Justice and Peace in promoting communal harmony and legal support for victims of communal violence.
9. **Grassroots conflict Resolution Mechanisms** like **Peace Committees** in Maharashtra involve community leaders in resolving local conflicts.
10. **Addressing historical issues** : T**ruth and Reconciliation Commissions** along the lines of post-conflict societies like South Africa, which focus on healing and rebuilding communal relationships.
11. **Sachar Committee:** Appointed in 2005, it recommended the establishment of the Equal Opportunity Commission.
12. **Ranganath Misra Commission:** It recommended 10% and 5% reservations for Muslims and other minorities, respectively, in central and state government jobs.
13. **2nd ARC's recommendations to curb religious conflicts:**
    a. **District Peace Committees/Integration Councils.**
    b. **Mohalla Committees** to identify local problems with the potential to degenerate into communal conflicts.
    c. Setting up **special courts** for the expeditious trial of cases related to communal violence.
    d. Prescription of norms of **relief and rehabilitation.**

SC judgments

1. **S.R. Bommai vs. Union of India (1994) :** Secularism as a basic feature of the Constitution.
2. **Tehseen S. Poonawalla vs. Union of India (2018) : T**he Supreme Court issued guidelines to curb mob violence and lynching. It directed the state governments to appoint nodal officers in each district to take proactive steps.
3. **Prakash Singh vs. Union of India (2006) : T**he Supreme Court laid down directives for police reforms, including the establishment of a Police Complaints Authority and fixed tenure for key police officials.
4. **Aruna Roy vs. Union of India (2002)** underscored the importance of maintaining a secular curriculum in educational institutions.

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5. **State of Karnataka vs. Dr. Praveen Togadia (2004) :** SC held that the right to free speech and movement can be reasonably restricted to prevent communal violence and maintain public order.

Secularism

Secularism is a principle or ideology that advocates for the separation of religious institutions and beliefs from the affairs of the state, government, or public institutions.

According to **Akeel Bilgrami**, Secularism consists of three commitments:

1. Freedom of religious belief and practice,
2. Principles enshrined in the constitution, such as equality, freedom of speech, and gender equality
3. Meta-commitment, which says that if there is a clash between the first and second commitments, the second commitment must get priority
4. **Indira Gandhi**: Secularism is not an import or a mere matter of Western education. It is indigenous to India and has been part of our heritage for centuries."
5. **Shashi Tharoor**: "Indian secularism has always been the idea of India. This idea of India is that it is not just a country; it's an idea, a pluralistic idea."
6. **Maulana Abul Kalam Azad**: Secularism is not confined merely to political democracy but goes much beyond that. It is a political, social, and cultural process."
7. **Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam**: "For a successful revolution, we need more than just democracy. We need a spirit of inclusiveness and secularism."

Secularism under the Indian Constitution

1. **Article 15:** Prohibits discrimination on grounds of religion, race, caste, sex, or place of birth. It ensures that the state shall not discriminate against any citizen on these grounds.
2. **Article 16:** Guarantees equality of opportunity in matters of public employment and prevents discrimination on grounds of religion, race, caste, sex, descent, place of birth, or residence.
3. **Article 25-28:** Ensures the freedom of religion, allowing individuals to profess, practice, and propagate their religion, subject to public order, morality, and health.
4. **Article 28** : It guarantees the right of minorities to establish and administer educational institutions.
5. **Articles 29** and **30** provide cultural and educational rights to minorities.
6. **Article 44**: Encourages the state to secure for its citizens a **Uniform Civil Code** throughout the territory of India. The idea behind this is to promote a common set of laws for all citizens, irrespective of their religious beliefs.
7. **Article 51A:** Fundamental duty to promote harmony and the spirit of common brotherhood and to value and preserve the rich heritage of our composite culture.

Significance of secularism

1. **Religious Pluralism:** Secularism in India is crucial for maintaining social harmony and fostering peaceful coexistence among diverse religious groups.
2. **Protection of Individual Rights**: Secularism promotes the idea that individuals should be free to practice their religion or hold secular beliefs, free from state coercion and societal discrimination.
3. **Constitutional Framework**: Secularism is a fundamental feature of the Indian Constitution. It is explicitly mentioned in the Preamble, and various articles uphold the principles of religious equality, freedom of religion, and non-discrimination based on religious grounds.

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4. **Equality and Inclusion**: It helps prevent favoritism towards any particular religious group, ensuring that all citizens are treated equally regardless of their religious affiliations. This contributes to a more inclusive and harmonious society.
5. **Protection of Minority Rights**: The Constitution guarantees the right to establish and administer educational institutions for religious and linguistic minorities, ensuring that minority communities have the freedom to preserve and promote their distinct cultural and religious identity.
6. **Prevention of Religious Discrimination**: By separating religious institutions from political power, it discourages the imposition of religious beliefs on the entire population and promotes tolerance and acceptance of diverse viewpoints.
7. **Promotion of Rational Governance**: A secular approach encourages governments to base their policies on rational, evidence-based considerations rather than religious dogma. Further, by prioritizing reason and evidence over dogma, secular societies tend to be more open to advancements in education, science, and technology.
8. **Political Inclusivity** by discouraging the use of religion as a basis for political mobilization. It aims to create a political environment where leaders and parties appeal to a broad cross-section of society rather than focusing on narrow religious constituencies.

Western vs Indian secularism

Western secularism	Indian secularism
Implies a **clear and distinct division** between religious institutions and governmental affairs. Eg. The French laïcité model bans religious symbols in public institutions.	Represents the **positive notion** of secularism, wherein equal reverence is accorded to all religious beliefs.
Evolved during the European Renaissance as a response to widespread corruption in the Church and undue interference in state matters.	It originated in the ancient Vedic era and is grounded in religious pluralism (**Sarva Dharma Samabhav** and **Dharma Nirapekshata).**
Equal distance model : Religion is generally seen as a private matter, and the state aims to maintain equal distance from all religious institutions.	**Principled distance model** : Recognizes the importance of religion in society and aims to accommodate diverse religious beliefs and practices. It involves state support for religious communities and the promotion of religious pluralism.
Individual rights take precedence in Western secularism.	Extends beyond individual rights to also address the concerns and rights of religious and cultural minority communities.
It does not accommodate the notion of state-sponsored religious reform.	It is in harmony with the concept of state-sponsored religious reform. Eg. Article 17, Triple Talaq Ban

Criticism of and Threats to Indian Secularism

1. **Selective Secularism**: There are instances where the state has been accused of favoring certain religious communities, leading to a lack of true equality among religious groups. The surge of religious nationalism in recent times has given rise to incidents such as mob lynching.

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2. **Minority appeasement,** particularly during elections. This has led to concerns about **vote-bank politics**. The politicization of a particular religious group sparks competitive politicization among other groups, leading to inter-religious conflicts.
3. **Religious Intervention in State Matters:** Critics argue that the Indian state has, at times, involved itself too much in religious matters, such as managing and funding religious institutions. Eg. The government's control over Hindu temples in some states.
4. **Lack of a Uniform Civil Code**: Critics argue that personal laws based on religious affiliations contribute to inequalities and perpetuate a fragmented legal system.
5. **Rise of Communal Tensions**: Some critics argue that the state has not been effective enough in preventing and addressing such conflicts, leading to questions about the success of Indian secularism in fostering true religious harmony.
6. **Inadequate Protection of Freedom of Speech:** In certain instances, there have been criticisms that Indian secularism has been used to curb freedom of speech and expression, particularly when it comes to criticism or satire of religious beliefs.
7. **Ineffectiveness in Addressing Social Issues**: Critics argue that despite its commitment to social justice, Indian secularism has not been entirely effective in addressing deep-rooted social issues, such as caste discrimination.
8. **Need for Reinterpretation**: Some scholars and thinkers suggest that the concept of secularism in India needs reinterpretation to align with contemporary challenges and to ensure a more inclusive and fair application across diverse religious communities.

Scholar views

1. **Rajeev Bhargava** has critiqued the **concept of "principled distance"** in Indian secularism, arguing that it may not be sufficient in addressing the complex issues arising from religious diversity. He emphasizes the need for a more nuanced and context-specific approach.
2. **Ashis Nandy** has expressed concerns about the potential for secularism to become a **form of cultural imperialism**, imposing Western values on diverse cultural and religious traditions in India. He argues for a more culturally sensitive approach.
3. **T. N. Madan** has highlighted issues such as the persistence of caste-based discrimination and the tensions between individual rights and community rights. He suggests a need for reevaluation and adaptation.
4. **Martha Nussbaum** has highlighted concerns about the inadequacy of secularism in addressing issues related to gender justice in India. She argues that a more comprehensive approach is needed to ensure the protection of women's rights within diverse religious communities.
5. **Asghar Ali Engineer**, while advocating for interfaith dialogue, has criticized the lack of concrete measures in Indian secularism to address the socio-economic disparities faced by religious minorities. He emphasizes the need for more inclusive policies.

SC judgments related to secularism

1. **Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala** : The Supreme Court of India held that secularism is a part of the basic structure of the Constitution.
2. **S.R Bommai v. Union of India** : The principle laid down in the Kesavananda Bharati case was reiterated. The Supreme Court cleared the doubt over the word 'secularism' in the Constitution. The Court held that the secular nature of a society does not make it an atheist society. Secularism makes society more heterogeneous.
3. **Ahmedabad St. Xavier's College v. State of Gujarat** : The Supreme Court held that secularism neither means anti-God nor pro-God. Secularism, therefore, eliminates the concept of God in matters of the state.

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4. **Stanislaus Rev v. State of MP: T**he court clarified that while Article 25 guarantees the right to publicly declare (profess), actively perform (practice), and transmit (propagate) religious beliefs, the right to propagate does not extend to the right to convert another person.
5. **Indian Young Lawyers Association v. State of Kerala**: Preventing women in their "menstruating years" from entering the Sabarimala temple as per the religious custom violates women's constitutionally protected fundamental rights to equality. The dissent of Justice Indu Malhotra has raised doubts regarding the extent to which established religious practices can be challenged based on equality.

Way forward

1. Promote **Inclusive Policies,** ensuring that the rights of all religious communities, as well as non-religious individuals, are protected without favoritism.
2. **Empower Marginalized Groups,** including women and religious minorities, through affirmative action and targeted policies to address historical injustices and socio-economic disparities.
3. **Strengthen Legal Frameworks** that ensure gender justice, protect individual rights, and promote uniform civil laws to minimize disparities arising from different personal laws. Eg. Uniform Civil Code.
4. Integrate **curriculum modules on religious tolerance** and **cultural diversity** into educational institutions to foster a culture of respect for diverse religious and cultural backgrounds.
5. Encourage **Interfaith Dialogue** to promote understanding, tolerance, and cooperation among different religious communities, fostering social harmony.
6. Address Communal Tensions by promoting a **culture of dialogue, tolerance, and understanding.** This can be done through community policing initiatives and rapid response teams.
7. Ensure **Political Neutrality in religious matters** by discouraging the use of religious identity for electoral gains. Encourage political leaders to focus on inclusive governance rather than divisive religious appeals.
8. **Safeguard freedom of speech and expression** while also promoting responsible discourse, ensuring that it does not incite religious hatred or violence. Balancing individual rights with societal harmony is crucial.
9. Extend the principles of secularism to address broader issues of social justice, including caste-based discrimination, economic disparities, and other forms of marginalization.

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Chapter 4

Impact Of Globalization On Indian Society

PYQs

[2026] Evaluate the impact of globalization on Indian youths with reference to social, political, economic and cultural spheres. 15

[2026] Do you think digital technology promotes social empowerment? Explain with examples. 10

[2024] Globalization has increased urban migration by skilled, young, unmarried women from various classes. How has this trend impacted their personal freedom and relationship with family? 15

[2022] Elucidate the relationship between globalization and new technology in a world of scarce resources, with special reference to India. 15

[2021] What is Cryptocurrency? How does it affect global security? Has it been affecting Indian society also? 10

[2020] Is diversity and pluralism in India under threat due to globalization? Justify your answer. 15

[2019] Are we losing our local identity for a global identity? Discuss. 15

[2018] 'Globalization is generally said to promote cultural homogenization, but due to this, cultural specificities appear to be strengthened in the Indian Society. Elucidate. 15

[2016] To what extent has globalisation influenced the core of cultural diversity in India? Explain. 12.5

[2015] Discuss the positive and negative effects of globalization on women in India. 12.5

[2013] Critically examine the effects of globalization on the aged population in India. 10

IMF defines globalization as the increasing integration of economies around the world, particularly through the movement of goods, services, and capital across borders.

Globalisation refers to the growing interdependence of global economies, cultures, and populations, driven by the cross-border exchange of goods and services, technological progress, and the movement of capital, people, and information.

Quotes

Kofi Annan: *"It has been said that arguing against globalization is like arguing against the laws of gravity."*

Jack Ma (Founder, Alibaba): *"The future of globalization is no longer just physical trade. It will be related to the interconnection of knowledge, information, and technology."*

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Evolution of Globalization

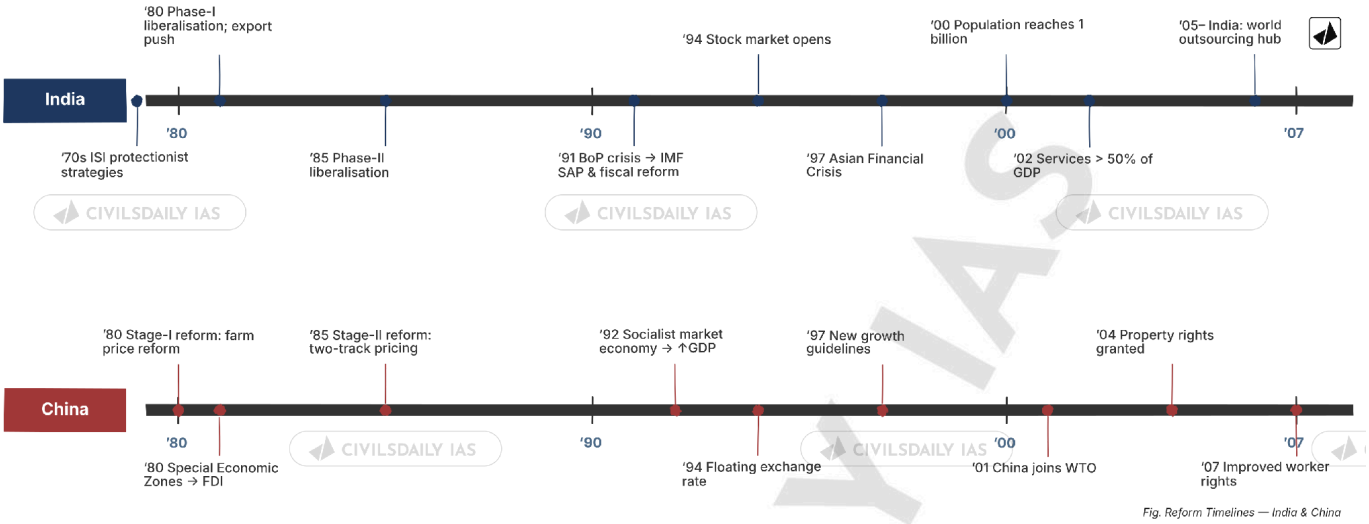


Fig. Reform Timelines — India & China

Theories of Globalization

1. **Hyperglobalist Perspective -**
   a. This perspective states that globalization is leading to a borderless society. The global market and transnational institutions (like the WTO, the IMF, the UN, EU) are becoming central to governance.
   b. Global capitalism is spreading liberal democracy, consumerism, and economic integration.
   c. Eg. The fall of the USSR, India's liberalization in 1991, rise of global MNCs like Apple, Google, and Amazon operating beyond national jurisdictions.
2. **Skeptical Perspective-**
   a. Globalization is **not new** but a continuation of older forms of capitalist expansion (like colonial trade).
   b. The world is not truly globalized but **regionalized**; inequalities among and within nations are **widening**, and many countries remain marginalized from global flows.
   c. Eg. Trans Pacific Partnership(TPP), Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership(RCEP), rise of protectionism (Eg. **US-China trade war**, Brexit)
3. **Transformationalists Perspective -**
   a. This is a **middle-path approach**, which argues that globalization is a complex, dynamic process that is restructuring societies in unpredictable ways.
   b. Globalization leads to both **homogenization** (standardized culture/values) and **heterogenization** (diverse local adaptations). Emphasis on **"glocalisation"**, where global influences are customized locally.
   c. Eg. **Bollywood** incorporates Western cinematic techniques; **McDonald's** offers McAloo Tikki or Maharaja Mac in India.

Factors Leading to the Emergence of Globalization

Category	Factor	Examples
Technological	**Advancements in communication and information technology** enabled real-time interaction and integration across borders.	Internet, mobile phones, satellite communication, fibre optics.

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Category	Factor	Examples
	Revolution in transportation reduced the time and cost of moving goods and people globally.	Container shipping, air cargo, high-speed rail.
Economic	**Liberalization of economies** facilitated free trade, capital mobility, and foreign investments.	LPG reforms in India (1991), WTO, IMF structural reforms.
	The rise of multinational corporations (MNCs) expanded production and marketing globally.	Companies like Apple, Toyota, and Amazon operate in dozens of countries.
Political	**The collapse of the Soviet Union and the end of the Cold War** led to a unipolar world and market-oriented governance.	U.S.-led global capitalism post-1991.
	Policy shifts towards deregulation and privatization created favorable conditions for global market integration.	Washington Consensus, structural adjustment programs.
Social	**Global cultural exchanges** promoted through media, tourism, and education enhanced interconnectivity.	Hollywood, global fashion trends, international student exchanges.
	Growth of global civil society and NGOs pushed for interconnected responses to global issues.	Greenpeace, Amnesty International, and global environmental/rights campaigns.
Institutional	**The establishment of global trade and financial institutions** provided platforms for global economic governance.	WTO, IMF, World Bank.
Legal	**Harmonization of trade laws and investment policies** made cross-border business easier and more predictable.	Bilateral investment treaties, intellectual property rights under TRIPS.
Crisis Response	**Oil shocks and debt crises** in the 1970s-80s forced developing nations to adopt global market policies.	Mexico (1982 debt crisis), India's BoP crisis (1991).
Cultural	**The rise of English as a global lingua franca** facilitated communication and integration.	Global business, academia, and entertainment are adopting English as the standard medium.

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Key Features of Globalization

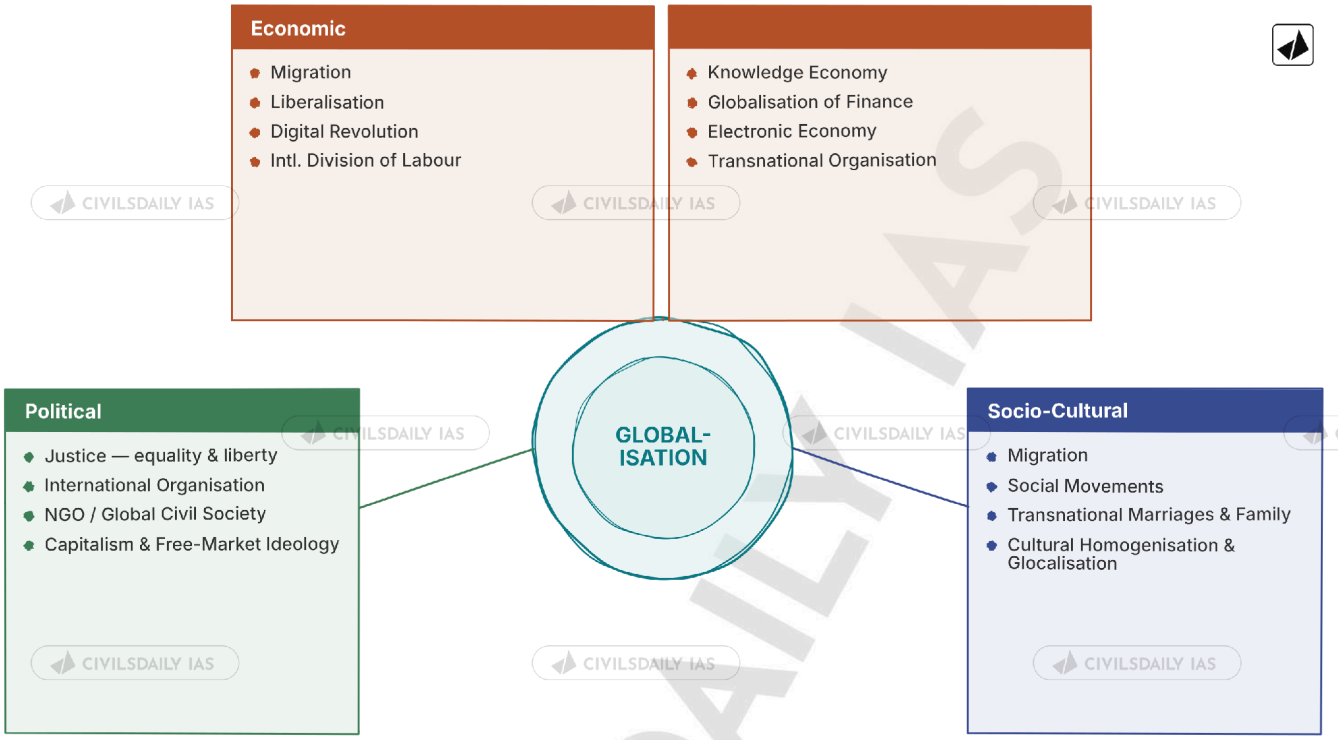


Fig. Dimensions of Globalisation

Impact

Positive

Category	Impact	Examples
Political	Enhanced **global diplomatic relations** and strategic alliances through trade, defense, and multilateral ties.	India–U.S. civil nuclear deal; G20 and WTO participation; QUAD alliance.
Economic	Increased **foreign direct investment (FDI)** and trade liberalization expanded GDP and employment.	Over $71 billion in FDI in 2023; growth of services and manufacturing sectors.
	The emergence of **Indian multinationals** strengthened global competitiveness and exports.	Tata Group, Infosys, and Mahindra operate in multiple countries.
Social	Improved **standard of living** through access to global goods, services, and modern lifestyles.	Rise in urban middle class; availability of global brands in retail and e-commerce.
	Greater **cultural exchange** and awareness of liberal democratic values via media and education.	Popularity of global films, cuisines, fashion, and international student exchange programs.

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Category	Impact	Examples
Technological	Access to **advanced technology and innovation** through collaboration with global partners.	Expansion of 5G, fintech, AI in healthcare; partnerships with Apple, Google, etc.
	Boost to **digital infrastructure and IT exports** due to global demand for tech services.	India's IT exports crossed $200 billion in 2022–23; Bengaluru is a global tech hub.
Legal	Adoption of **global trade laws and standards** helped modernize domestic policies and improve business ease.	Introduction of GST; alignment with WTO, TRIPS, and international IPR norms.
	Better **labor rights and compliance frameworks** due to global supply chain integration.	Improved labor codes and workplace audits in export-based sectors like textiles and pharma.
Environmental	Globalization encouraged the **adoption of sustainable technologies and environmental awareness**.	Growth in the solar energy sector, electric mobility, and support from global climate funds.
	Participation in **global climate agreements** strengthened environmental governance.	India's commitment to the Paris Agreement and International Solar Alliance initiatives.

Positive Impact of Globalization on Indian Society and Culture

Aspect	Impact	Example
Cultural Exchange and Hybridization	Promoted cultural hybridization by blending global and Indian traditions in food, fashion, and music.	Indo-western clothing, fusion cuisine, Indian hip-hop.
Cosmopolitan Values	Strengthened liberal and secular values, encouraging openness to diversity and human rights.	Rising urban support for LGBTQ+ rights and gender equality.
Global Media Exposure	Access to international cinema, music, and art broadened social and cultural perspectives.	Netflix, Marvel, K-pop, international book fandoms.
Digital Connectivity and Social Activism	Empowered people to engage in social expression and activism through global digital platforms.	Youth campaigns on caste, feminism, and climate change via Instagram, Twitter, and YouTube.
Modernized Lifestyles	Shifted urban consumption patterns and daily habits, influencing work, food, and recreation.	McDonald's, Starbucks, smartphone usage, mall culture, OTT binge-watching.

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Aspect	Impact	Example
Global Education & Exchange	Increased cross-border educational and career opportunities through scholarships and cultural exchange programs.	Indian students in global universities and international fellowships.
Social Mobility and Aspirations	Redefined social identity beyond caste and religion, emphasizing merit and achievement.	IT professionals and creators from marginalized groups are gaining national and global visibility.
Globalization of Indian Culture	Exported Indian practices like yoga, Ayurveda, and spirituality globally, boosting cultural pride.	International Yoga Day, turmeric lattes, Bollywood dance workshops abroad.
Women's Empowerment	Inspired by global gender equity discourse, women gained visibility in public, professional, and leadership roles.	Women-led startups, corporate leadership, MeToo India movement.
Cultural Openness and Tolerance	Reduced ethnocentrism and promoted intercultural acceptance among the youth.	Mixed-faith friendships, global holiday celebrations, cultural acceptance in metros.

Negative

Aspect	Impact	Example
Cultural Homogenization	Globalization has promoted Western cultural dominance, weakening indigenous traditions, languages, and practices.	Fast food, Western clothing, and English are displacing regional cuisines, attire, and languages.
Erosion of Traditional Values	Exposure to global media has led to a decline in community-based lifestyles and growing individualism.	Youth distancing from joint family systems and local customs.
Commodification of Culture	Indian culture is often commercialized and packaged for global consumption, stripping it of its original meaning.	Yoga is marketed globally as fitness, ignoring its spiritual roots.
Cultural Alienation among Rural Youth	The rapid spread of global media has created a sense of inadequacy and loss of identity among non-urban populations.	Rural youth imitate urban lifestyles, leading to confusion and identity conflict.
Decline of Indigenous Art Forms	Global consumerism has marginalized local artisans and	Handloom weavers are losing their livelihood to factory-made global fashion brands.

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Aspect	Impact	Example
	folk traditions in favor of mass-produced culture.	
Increase in Materialism and Consumerism	Market-driven globalization promotes material success as a value, displacing spiritual and ethical priorities.	Brand obsession among youth; rise in status-symbol-based identity (gadgets, clothes, etc.).
Widening Urban-Rural Divide	Unequal access to global trends and benefits creates social discontent and cultural disconnection.	Rural areas lack exposure to global opportunities; urban youth have access to global education.
Cultural Dilution through Media	Foreign content dominates TV, films, and OTT, reducing demand for regional stories and values.	Decline in Doordarshan viewership; rise of Western content on Netflix, Amazon Prime, etc.
Identity Crisis in Youth	Conflicting influences between local upbringing and global exposure lead to confusion and a lack of rootedness.	Students are struggling to balance a Westernized lifestyle with traditional expectations.
Cultural Appropriation	Global entities adopt Indian elements without context or credit, often reinforcing stereotypes.	Use of Indian symbols (like bindis, Om) in fashion without cultural understanding.
Indigenous knowledge	Traditional community knowledge is increasingly patented without proper acknowledgment.	Turmeric and neem patents in the US were challenged by India.
Language		**UNESCO** estimates that one language dies every **two weeks**; 197 Indian languages are endangered.
Rise of Hyper-Nationalism	Binary global-local identity struggles often fuel narrow nationalism, affecting free expression and democratic spaces.	

Impact on Culture

Homogenization

1. **Cultural Homogenization:** Globalization fosters a borderless cultural exchange, often dominated by Western (especially American) norms of consumerism, democracy, and language. Eg. According to a 2022 report by the **McKinsey Global Institute, 70%** of Indian companies have adopted Western management practices & corporate culture.
2. **Language**: English now has over **1.5 billion speakers globally (Ethnologue, 2023),** making it the lingua franca of globalization.

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3. **Food**: Western fast food chains have altered dietary habits. A **National Restaurant Association of India report(2022)** cites a **25% increase** in fast food consumption among Indian urban youth.
4. **Dressing**: Traditional Indian attire is increasingly replaced by Western styles like jeans and T-shirts, especially in urban areas.
5. **Popular Culture:** Globalization has spread Indian classical music and dance globally while introducing Western music and dance forms to India. Eg. A 2022 **survey by the Indian Council for Cultural Relations** found a 30% increase in foreign students enrolling in Indian classical dance courses.
6. **Cultural Revival and Homogeneity:** The global popularity of **Yoga, Ayurveda, and Indian spirituality.** Eg. The **Yoga Market Report 2023** estimated that 300 million people practice yoga worldwide.

Retreat of Cultural Nationalism

1. **Multicultural Societies:** Global interaction promotes multiculturalism, rationality, and tolerance, reducing exclusivist cultural narratives. Eg. **Bangalore's Karaga Festival** exemplifies communal harmony, celebrated by people across communities in a globalized tech city.
2. **Ethnic Chauvinism:** Movements like the **Marathi Manoos campaign by Shiv Sena** reflect resistance to perceived cultural dilution due to internal migration and globalization.

Commercialization of Indigenous Knowledge

1. **Indigenous Knowledge:** Globalization has led to the privatization of traditional knowledge systems. Eg. patents filed abroad on turmeric and neem triggered debates on biopiracy.
2. **Protection Measures:** India's **Traditional Knowledge Digital Library (TKDL)** has successfully prevented over 220 wrongful patents. **(CSIR & Ministry of AYUSH)**

Hybridisation of Culture

Global and local cultures are blending, giving rise to hybrid forms.

1. **Language:** The rise of **Hinglish** in urban discourse exemplifies linguistic fusion.
2. **Fashion:** The pairing of jeans with a kurta reflects a blend of Western and Indian dressing styles.
3. **Festivals: Urban Navratri** celebrations now include Bollywood and EDM remixes along with traditional Garba.
4. **Entertainment: Hollywood movies** are increasingly dubbed in regional Indian languages, creating localized global content.
5. **Music: Indi-pop fusions** featured on international music channels showcase cross-cultural creativity.
6. **Matchmaking:** Platforms like **Shaadi.com** commercialize traditional caste-based matchmaking using modern technology.
7. **Glocalization:** Global brands adapt to local cultures for deeper market penetration. Eg. **McDonald's India** offers McAloo Tikki and Maharaja Mac, blending Indian taste with a global format.

Religion

Positive Impacts of Globalization on Religion	Negative Impacts of Globalization on Religion
Interfaith Dialogue fosters religious tolerance by facilitating cross-faith contact at global forums like the Parliament of the World's Religions.	Led to **religious fundamentalism** and radicalism as a reaction to global cultural influence. *Eg.* Rise of ISIS, right-wing religious extremism. (Samuel Huntington's *Clash of Civilizations*.)
Popularized **Indian spiritual practices** like yoga, meditation, and Ayurveda on the global stage. *Eg.*	Contributed to the **commodification of religion**, where sacred practices are turned into commercial

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Positive Impacts of Globalization on Religion	Negative Impacts of Globalization on Religion
International Day of Yoga. (Roland Robertson's *glocalization* : Local traditions adapted globally.)	products. *Eg.* Yoga is promoted as an exercise without spiritual roots.
Made **religious content and rituals more accessible** via digital platforms, breaking physical and caste-based barriers. *Eg. online* darshan, live-streamed church services, digital Gita apps.	Caused **cultural homogenization**, leading to the marginalization of local and tribal faiths. *Eg.* Decline of indigenous deities and oral traditions in Northeast and Central India.
Supported the **global humanitarian role of religions**, enhancing their relevance in addressing global crises. *Eg.* Faith-based NGOs like Caritas, Islamic Relief, and Sikh Langar services during COVID-19.	Created **identity-based fragmentation** in diaspora communities, where religion is used to maintain in-group exclusivity. *Eg.* Caste divisions in temples in the U.S. or U.K.
Strengthened **religious tourism and cultural diplomacy**, helping economies and fostering spiritual exchange. *Eg.* Growth in foreign pilgrims visiting Bodh Gaya, Varanasi, Mecca, and the Vatican.	Enabled **religious misinformation and hate speech** to spread rapidly via unregulated digital platforms. *Eg.* WhatsApp rumors during Delhi riots (2020), Facebook posts inciting violence.
Promoted **secular ethics and shared global values** such as peace, compassion, and universal brotherhood. *Eg.* Pope Francis' interreligious climate appeal; Buddhist compassion campaigns.	Undermined the **traditional authority of religious elders and institutions** due to the rise in individualized belief systems. *Eg.* Youth rejecting institutional rituals in favor of DIY spirituality.
Supported the **revival of marginalized religions and sects** through global awareness. *Eg.* International support for Tibetan Buddhism and the Dalai Lama's cause.	Increased **competition between religious groups** for global visibility, sometimes leading to sectarian tensions. *Eg.* Evangelical vs. indigenous belief systems in tribal regions.
Fostered **cross-cultural marriages and interfaith families**, increasing religious harmony at micro-social levels. *Eg.* Hindu-Christian, Hindu-Muslim interfaith families in urban India.	Encouraged **loss of community-based practices**, as youth adopt global norms over local customs. *Eg.* Disinterest in festivals, rituals, and religious storytelling among Gen Z.
Religious Reforms: Eg. The Church of England ordained its first female bishop in 2015.	**Conversions Driven by External Support: Eg.** notable rise in Christian populations in tribal belts of India **(2011 Census).**

Caste

Positive Impacts	Negative Impacts
Enabled economic mobility and class-based identities among lower castes through access to private sector jobs. *Eg.* Dalits in IT, BPO, and retail sectors are gaining financial independence.	**Widened inequalities** between elite and marginalized castes due to unequal access to education and skill training. *Eg.* Upper castes benefiting more from tech-driven sectors.

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Positive Impacts	Negative Impacts
Reduced caste visibility in urban, globalized workplaces where merit and productivity are prioritized. *Eg.* Corporate offices, call centers with mixed-caste teams, and less overt discrimination.	**Caste discrimination continues in informal and unregulated sectors** despite global exposure. *Eg.* Dalits in sanitation work, manual scavenging persists.
Created alternative spaces for Dalit entrepreneurship and self-representation, challenging traditional hierarchies. *Eg.* Rise of Dalit-owned businesses supported by DICCI (Dalit Indian Chamber of Commerce and Industry).	**Reservation backlash and dominant caste anxiety** increased as globalization shifted job focus to the private sector, where affirmative action is absent. *Eg.* Protests against SC/ST/OBC quotas in public jobs and education.
Digital platforms have empowered marginalized voices to share lived experiences and challenge casteism publicly. *Eg.* Anti-caste activism on Twitter, YouTube, Round Table India.	**Caste markers persist in digital and matrimonial platforms**, reinforcing social boundaries. *Eg.* Caste filters on matrimonial websites like Shaadi.com.
Increased global awareness of caste as a human rights issue, inviting international solidarity. *Eg.* Cisco caste discrimination case in the U.S. raised the caste debate in the diaspora.	**Globalization encourages meritocratic narratives** that often overlook or deny structural caste privilege. *Eg.* "Caste-blind" hiring used to avoid affirmative action in private firms.
Encouraged inter-caste social mixing in urban education and housing for upwardly mobile families. *Eg.* Hostel life in metro cities, shared PGs, and apartments.	**Ghettoization of Dalit communities in urban spaces** due to economic and social exclusion. *Eg.* Dalit-dominated slums in metropolitan areas like Mumbai and Delhi.
Secularisation of Caste: Focus shifting from identity politics to development. Eg. **The Lokniti-CSDS, 2022,** said 65% of Dalit respondents want leaders to prioritize economic development.	**Continued Caste-Based Inequality:** There is a 10% increase in caste-based violence cases from 2020 to 2022 (National Dalit Movement for Justice).
Rise in Dalit Movements: Dalit activism draws from global civil rights movements. Eg. Bhim Army saw 30% membership growth (2019–2023), inspired by Black Lives Matter. (The Indian Express).	**Persistence of Untouchability:** Despite modernisation, caste-based exclusion remains prevalent. Eg. According to **NCRB(2022),** over 40,000 cases of caste-based discrimination were reported.

Family

Positive Impacts	Negative Impacts
Improved standard of living through global income opportunities and remittances. Example: NRI families in Kerala benefiting from Gulf jobs.	Increased materialism is weakening traditional values and emotional bonds. Example: Urban youth prioritizing careers over caregiving.
Rise of nuclear families offering independence and individual agency. Example: Young couples living separately in metro cities.	Breakdown of joint families, reducing intergenerational support. Example: Elderly parents living alone in rural areas.

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Positive Impacts	Negative Impacts
Exposure to liberal values promoting gender equality and shared responsibilities. Example: Women in urban families pursuing careers and higher education.	Work-life imbalance due to competitive, global work culture is reducing family time. Example: IT sector employees in Bengaluru working long hours.
Access to global parenting styles promoting child-centric upbringing. Example: Use of international education methods in Indian preschools.	Decline in respect for elders as hierarchical family structures weaken. Example: Fewer joint celebrations or family rituals in urban homes.
Increased family communication across borders via digital technology. Example: Video calls connecting NRIs with families in India.	Cultural conflict within families due to value differences between generations. Example: Disputes over dating, clothing, or lifestyle choices.

Marriage system

Positive Impact

1. **Acceptance of Love Marriages:** Global exposure and urbanization have made love marriages more socially acceptable. Eg. **India Human Development Survey (2022)** stated that love marriages increased to 35% from just 5% in the 1970s.
2. **Decline in Caste and Religious Barriers:** Increasing inter-caste and inter-faith marriages indicate a shift towards more inclusive unions. Eg. **Pew Research Center (2023)** stated that 20% of Indian marriages are now inter-caste.
3. **Reduction in Child and Widow Marriages:** Awareness and legal enforcement have curbed regressive practices. Eg. As per **NFHS-5 (2019–21),** Child marriage among women aged 20–24 fell to 21% from 47% in 2005–06.
4. **Gender Parity in Marital Relationships: UN Women Report (2023)** reported a 20% rise in joint decision-making among married couples. Eg. spouses increasingly share responsibilities and decisions, especially in urban India.

Negative Impact

1. **Erosion of the Sacredness of Marriage:** As per the **Indian Journal of Psychological Medicine (2022),** Bangalore's divorce rate reached 4.5%, among the highest in India.
2. **Marriage as a Contractual Arrangement:** Young couples are prioritizing compatibility and mutual benefit over religious or traditional elements. Eg. As per the **YouGov India Survey (2022),** 45% of urban youth see marriage as a pragmatic partnership.
3. **Increase in Live-In Relationships:** Modern youth are embracing alternative relationship models, challenging conventional norms. Eg. As per **India Today Group (2023), 18%** of urban youth support live-in relationships, up from 5% in 2010.
4. **Challenges to Traditional Marriage Norms:** Exposure to global lifestyles has popularized the concept of serial monogamy. Media depictions of evolving romantic relationships have normalized this shift. Eg. As per the **International Journal of Indian Psychology (2022),** 15% of respondents reported multiple monogamous relationships.

Women

Positive Impact

1. **Increased Workforce Participation:** The rise of MNCs in India has significantly increased formal sector employment for women. As of 2022, women constitute 23.3% of the total workforce in India's formal sector, up from 19.2% in 2010.

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2. **Strengthening Informal Sector:** Enhanced trade and export flows have boosted women's participation in the informal sector. Eg. **Kutch Craft**, involving 110 craftswomen's groups, has created 6000 jobs since the onset of globalization.
3. **Enhanced Decision-Making Power:** Higher employment and better pay have increased women's self-confidence, enhancing their role in family decisions. Eg. In 2022, a survey indicated that 72% of employed women reported having a strong voice in household decisions.
4. **Promotion of Gender Equality:** Increased representation in governance reflects rising empowerment. Eg. women hold 14% of parliamentary seats, up from 11% in 2010 **(Inter-Parliamentary Union Data, 2020)**
5. **Resistance to Patriarchal Norms:** High-profile cases and global movements have led to legal and societal reform. Eg. The 2012 Nirbhaya case led to stricter anti-rape laws via the **Justice Verma Committee** and greater public support for women's rights.
6. **Stronger Role in Nuclear Families:** With the shift to nuclear households, women find more space to assert rights and negotiate family roles.
7. **Changing Mindsets Through Global Influence:** Global discourses on feminism and rights have reshaped attitudes in urban India. Eg. **The #MeToo movement in India (2018 onward)** led to workplace reforms and increased reporting of harassment.

Negative Impact

1. **Persistent Glass Ceiling:** Despite progress, women remain underrepresented in leadership roles. Eg. only 15% of senior management positions in India are held by women **(Grant Thornton Report, 2022)**
2. **Health Issues in the Unorganized Sector:** Long hours and poor working conditions lead to health issues. Eg. women in the **bidi industry** suffer from respiratory problems, with over 50% reporting health issues related to their work.
3. **Gender-Based Violence:** Resistance to changing norms has led to Patriarchal Backlash. Eg. honor killings in Haryana against inter-caste marriages still occur, with several reported cases in 2023.
4. **Impact on Traditional Industries:** Automation in traditional industries has displaced many women workers. Eg. The introduction of power looms has reduced employment for handloom weavers, with a 30% decline in female weavers from 2015 to 2020.
5. **Commodification and Cultural Exploitation:** Media representations often objectify women, leading to societal consequences. Eg. As per **NCRB (2021),** a 20% rise in harassment and sexual violence reports, attributed in part to the influence of exploitative media and digital content.

Youth

Positive Impact

1. **Enhanced Employment Opportunities:** Globalisation has created diverse job avenues in IT, services, startups, and gig economies. Eg. As per **NASSCOM (2023),** 1.8 million Indian youth are employed in tech-enabled services linked to global outsourcing.
2. **Access to Global Education:** Exposure to international curricula and study-abroad programs has widened career prospects. Eg. As per the **Ministry of Education (2023),** over 13 lakh Indian students were enrolled in foreign universities, the highest ever.
3. **Rise of Entrepreneurial Spirit:** Startup culture influenced by Silicon Valley models has inspired Indian youth. Eg. 45% of Indian startups are founded by entrepreneurs below 30 **(Startup India Report, 2022).**
4. **Cultural Exposure and Innovation:** Global media and exchange programs promote creativity, fashion, music, and art among youth. Eg. The rise of **K-pop fandom and YouTube creators** in India illustrates cultural convergence.

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5. **Increased Awareness and Activism:** Access to global news and digital platforms has made youth more socially conscious. Eg. Indian youth have led climate strikes and LGBTQ+ rights campaigns, inspired by global movements.

Negative Impact

1. **Cultural Erosion and Identity Crisis:** Western lifestyle influences have sometimes diluted indigenous values and traditions. Eg. As per **CSDS(2023),** 60% of respondents felt that youth are drifting away from Indian cultural roots.
2. **Mental Health Concerns:** Pressure to meet global standards and exposure to unrealistic social media portrayals have increased stress. Eg. **Lancet Study (2022)**, one in seven Indians aged 15–24 suffers from some form of mental health issue.
3. **Digital Addiction and Reduced Physical Activity:** Excessive screen time has impacted physical and mental well-being. Eg. Indian adolescents spend an average of 6+ hours daily on screens, leading to sedentary lifestyles **(ICMR, 2023).**
4. **Unemployment Despite Qualifications:** Skill mismatch due to overemphasis on degrees rather than employability skills. Eg. As per **the Periodic Labour Force Survey (2022), the** youth unemployment rate stood at 12.4%, especially among urban graduates.
5. **Vulnerability to Radical Ideologies:** Online platforms have also become breeding grounds for misinformation and extremist views. Eg. As per the **National Crime Records Bureau (2022),** there is a rise in cybercrime and radical content consumption among the 18–25 age group.
6. **Substance Abuse:** The National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) reported a 20% increase in drug abuse cases among youth in 2023 compared to the previous year.

Tribals

Positive Impact

1. **Improved Access to Education and Healthcare:** Government and NGO initiatives inspired by global development goals have improved literacy and healthcare in tribal areas. Eg. Under the **Eklavya Model Residential Schools scheme,** over 480 schools have been sanctioned across India for tribal students (Ministry of Tribal Affairs, 2023).
2. **Employment through Skill Development:** Globalisation-led schemes have brought skill training and job opportunities to tribal youth. Eg. Around 1.5 lakh tribal youth have been trained under **the Skill India Mission (NSDC, 2022).**
3. **Market Access for Tribal Products:** Traditional crafts, forest produce, and artworks now have national and international markets. Eg. **TRIFED's "Van Dhan Yojana"** has generated income for over 1 lakh tribal gatherers through value addition and e-commerce platforms.
4. **Empowerment through Technology:** Mobile phones and internet access have connected remote tribal areas, improving access to government schemes and education. Eg. The Digital India initiative has reached over 60% of tribal districts with digital literacy programs.
5. **Cultural Showcasing and Tourism:** Global interest in indigenous traditions has promoted tribal tourism and cultural preservation. Eg. Tribal festivals like **"Aadi Mahotsav"** showcase art and lifestyle to national and global audiences.

Negative Impact

1. **Land Alienation and Displacement:** Over 50% of the displaced people due to development projects in India are from Scheduled Tribes **(World Bank Report, 2020).**
2. **Loss of Cultural Identity:** Exposure to dominant cultures and consumerism threatens tribal languages, rituals, and lifestyles. Eg. **The 2018 UNESCO report** noted the extinction risk of many tribal languages like Bo, Sora, and Kui.

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3. **Exploitation in Labour Markets:** Adivasi workers in brick kilns and construction often earn below minimum wage **(Oxfam India, 2022).**
4. **Environmental Degradation:** Mining and logging by multinational corporations have degraded forests, affecting tribal livelihoods and biodiversity. Eg. Mining in Odisha's Niyamgiri Hills was opposed by the Dongria Kondh tribe due to a threat to their sacred land.
5. **Health and Nutrition Crisis:** The shift from traditional diets to market-based processed food has led to malnutrition and lifestyle diseases. Eg. **The NFHS-5 (2019–21)** found high malnutrition rates in tribal-dominated districts of Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, and Odisha.

Rural society

Positive Impact

1. **Enhanced Employment Opportunities:** Globalisation has introduced non-agricultural jobs such as construction, retail, and services in rural areas. Eg. Under the Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY), over 40% of trained beneficiaries are from rural India **(MSDE, 2022).**
2. **Improved Access to Information and Technology:** Mobile phones and the internet have connected rural areas with the wider world, boosting awareness and participation. Eg. **BharatNet** has connected over 1.5 lakh gram panchayats with high-speed broadband **(DoT, 2023).**
3. **Diversification of Agriculture:** Exposure to global markets led to crop diversification, the use of better seeds, and improved farming techniques. Eg. Contract farming and organic exports in Punjab and Maharashtra have given farmers access to international markets.
4. **Market Access**: Globalization has opened up international markets for Indian farmers, increasing their income. Eg. India's agricultural exports reached **$41.25 billion in 2020-21.**
5. **Better Infrastructure and Services:** Globalisation-driven reforms led to improved roads, electricity, banking, and education in many rural areas. Eg. **PMGSY** has built over 7 lakh km of roads, enhancing connectivity to remote villages **(Rural Development Ministry, 2023).**
6. **Cultural Exchange and Social Awareness:** Rural youth are exposed to ideas on gender equality, education, and health through media and migration. Eg. Rural girls increasingly aspire to higher education, with female literacy in rural India rising from **46% (2001) to 61% (2011 Census).**

Negative Impact

1. **Erosion of Traditional Livelihoods:** Mechanization and imports have displaced traditional rural occupations like weaving, pottery, and indigenous crafts. Eg. A 2021 **NITI Aayog report** noted a 30% decline in rural artisans' income due to global competition.
2. **Rising Inequality:** Benefits of globalisation are uneven, with wealth concentrating among better-off rural households. Eg. According to **NABARD All India Financial Inclusion Survey (2016–17),** only 24% of rural households had access to formal credit.
3. **Consumerism and Changing Values:** Exposure to urban lifestyles has increased consumerist tendencies and weakened community cohesion.
4. **Migration and Family Disintegration:** Migration for better jobs to cities has led to 'left-behind' elderly and women, affecting family structure.
5. **Environmental Impact:** Commercial farming and industrial expansion have led to overexploitation of groundwater and deforestation. Eg. Punjab's green revolution belt faces severe groundwater depletion due to intensive farming practices.

Education System

Positive Impact on Education

1. **Curriculum Modernisation:** Global trends have encouraged skill-based, interdisciplinary, and technology-driven education. Eg. **The National Education Policy (NEP) 2020** emphasizes critical thinking, coding from early grades, and flexibility in subject choices.

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2. **Growth of Private and International Schools:** Increased demand for global standards has led to the rise of international curriculum schools **(IB, Cambridge). Eg.** India has over 700 IB and Cambridge-affiliated schools as of 2023 **(IBO data).**
3. **Technology Integration: EdTech platforms and smart classrooms** have revolutionized teaching and learning processes. Eg. platforms like **BYJU'S, Unacademy, and SWAYAM** have made quality education more accessible.
4. **Expansion of Higher Education and Foreign Collaboration:** Globalisation has increased student mobility and academic collaborations with foreign universities. Eg. **IIT Madras and Deakin University (Australia)** jointly launched the first international campus in GIFT City in 2023.
5. **Rise in Global Rankings and Research Focus:** Indian institutions are increasingly participating in QS and THE world rankings, focusing more on research output. Eg. IISc Bengaluru ranked top among Indian universities in the 2023 QS Rankings.

Negative Impact

1. **Widening Inequality in Access:** Privatisation and rising costs of education have deepened the urban-rural and rich-poor divide.
2. **Overemphasis on Commercialisation:** Education is increasingly treated as a business rather than a public good. Eg. Mushrooming of unregulated private colleges and coaching institutes with poor quality standards.
3. **Cultural Alienation:** Western influence has led to a declining emphasis on indigenous knowledge and local languages.
4. **Brain Drain:** Talented students often migrate abroad for better opportunities, leading to a loss of skilled human capital. Eg. According to **MEA data, over 7.5 lakh Indian students** went abroad for studies in 2022 alone.
5. **Standardisation Over Local Relevance:** Global curriculum models may not align with local socio-cultural and economic realities. Eg. A **McKinsey report (2023)** warns that a "one-size-fits-all" curriculum fails to prepare students for region-specific challenges.

Health

Positive Impact on Health

1. **Improved Access to Medicines and Technology:** Global supply chains and trade liberalisation have enhanced access to affordable medicines and advanced medical equipment. Eg. India became a major exporter of generic medicines, making life-saving drugs affordable in Africa and Asia **(WHO, 2022).**
2. **Medical Tourism:** Globalisation has led to a boom in medical tourism, promoting investment in world-class healthcare infrastructure. Eg. India ranked among the top 10 global destinations for medical tourism **(Medical Tourism Index, 2021).**
3. **Cross-border Knowledge Exchange:** Exchange of health practices, medical training, and research collaborations has strengthened healthcare systems. Eg. Indian doctors often receive training or certifications from international institutions like the **WHO and Johns Hopkins.**
4. **Rise in Public Health Awareness:** Global campaigns on lifestyle diseases, vaccinations, and hygiene have influenced national health programs. Eg. India's adoption of WHO's guidelines for tobacco control under the National Tobacco Control Programme.
5. **Cross-Border Health Services:** Health services can be provided across borders using telemedicine tools. Eg. Tele-diagnostics and tele-radiology services are available through platforms like **Practo.**
6. **Improved Research and Treatment:** Foreign companies in India have improved the quality of research and treatment.

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Negative Impact on Health

1. **Increased Lifestyle Diseases:** Urbanisation and fast-food culture from the West have increased obesity, diabetes, and heart conditions. Eg. **The National Family Health Survey (NFHS-5)** reported a 30% rise in adult obesity over the last decade.
2. **Privatisation and Inequality in Healthcare Access:** Globalised health models often favour private investment, creating disparities. Eg. 65% of health expenditure in India is out-of-pocket, affecting poor households **(NITI Aayog, 2022).**
3. **High Cost of Medicines**: A study published in 2023 found that branded drugs in India cost 2-3 times more than their generic counterparts.
4. **Brain Drain in the Medical Sector:** Doctors and nurses migrate to developed countries, weakening domestic healthcare systems. Eg. According to **OECD (2021),** over 69,000 Indian doctors and 56,000 nurses work abroad.
5. **Spread of Global Pandemics:** Increased mobility and interconnectedness have facilitated the rapid spread of diseases. Eg. The rapid spread of Zika and coronavirus globally is due to international travel.
6. **Commodification of Health:** Health is increasingly treated as a market commodity rather than a basic right. Eg. Surge in unregulated wellness and cosmetic surgery clinics, driven by profit motives.

Old Age

Positive impact

1. **Improved Healthcare Access:** Globalisation has brought better medical technologies and healthcare services, improving elderly life expectancy. Eg. Availability of geriatric care, hip replacements, cataract surgeries, and telemedicine services has expanded in India.
2. **Increased Financial Independence:** Pension reforms, remittances from migrant children, and elderly-focused financial instruments (like the Senior Citizens' Savings Scheme) have empowered many elderly. Eg. **World Bank (2023)** reported a rise in financial independence among the elderly in countries with high migration rates.
3. **Global Awareness on Elderly Rights:** International advocacy (like **WHO's Decade of Healthy Ageing 2021–2030**) has influenced domestic policies on elderly care. Eg. India's Maintenance and Welfare of Parents and Senior Citizens Act (2007) was strengthened with global best practices.
4. **Communication:** Improved Connectivity due to technological advancements like smartphones and video calling apps (Eg. WhatsApp, Skype, Zoom) helps the elderly stay connected with family and friends, reducing isolation.
5. **Flexible Employment Opportunities:** The rise of remote work allows seniors to remain economically active through part-time or freelance work from home. Eg. online teaching, consulting, and content creation.

Negative Impact:

1. **Family Fragmentation and Isolation:** Migration of youth for education and work has led to nuclear families, leaving many elderly alone. Eg. According to the **2021 Longitudinal Ageing Study in India (LASI), 20%** of the elderly reported feeling isolated due to children living abroad or in cities.
2. **Erosion of Traditional Support Systems:** Globalisation-induced cultural shifts have weakened traditional respect and care for the elderly. Eg. **HelpAge India** reported a 40% increase in elder abuse complaints in 2022.
3. **Economic Vulnerability:** In the absence of universal pension systems, the elderly without formal sector jobs face economic insecurity. Eg. Only 30% of Indian elderly are covered by any form of pension **(Economic Survey, 2022).**
4. **Digital Divide:** While tech adoption has increased, many elderly people still struggle with digital platforms, accessing online healthcare, banking, and social security.

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5. **Triple Jeopardy for Aging Women:**
   a. **Aging:** Perceived as an economic burden.
   b. **Gender:** Devalued in a patriarchal society.
   c. **Living Conditions:** Many live in poverty or as dependents.
6. **Empty Nest Syndrome:** In the globalization era, empty nest syndrome is leading to permanent loneliness for parents. Eg. a **2023 study by the Indian Journal of Gerontology** found that 68% of elderly parents in urban areas experience loneliness due to children living far away for education or employment.

Emergence of New Middle Class

Reasons for the Emergence

1. **Economic Liberalization**: Economic reforms in the 1990s opened up the Indian economy, fostering growth and creating numerous job opportunities, particularly in the service sector.
2. **FDI and Multinational Companies**: The influx of foreign direct investment (FDI) and the establishment of multinational companies have created a plethora of high-paying jobs.
3. **IT and Telecom Boom**: The IT and telecom sectors have been pivotal in creating a large number of white-collar jobs. For example, the IT sector alone employs over 4 million people in India.
4. **E-commerce**: The rise of e-commerce platforms like Amazon and Flipkart has led to significant job creation and entrepreneurial opportunities.
5. **Educational Opportunities**: Increased access to higher education has equipped individuals with the skills needed for better-paying jobs. The number of higher education institutions has grown significantly, contributing to a more educated workforce.
6. **Professional Courses**: The popularity of professional courses in management, engineering, and medicine has prepared a skilled workforce ready for new-age industries.
7. **Urbanization**: Large-scale migration from rural to urban areas in search of better employment opportunities has contributed to the growth of the middle class.
8. **Infrastructure Development**: Improved urban infrastructure has supported economic activities, further bolstering middle-class growth.

Features of the New Middle Class

1. **Economic Characteristics**: Increased disposable income has led to higher consumption levels, driving demand for goods and services. According to a 2023 report by the Brookings Institution, the Indian middle class is projected to grow from 80 million in 2010 to 580 million by 2025.
2. **Investment in Assets**: A significant portion of the middle class invests in real estate, stocks, and mutual funds, contributing to economic stability.
3. **Consumerism**: There is a noticeable shift towards consumerism, with increased spending on lifestyle products, vacations, and luxury items.
4. **Technology Savvy**: High adoption rates of technology, including smartphones, the internet, and digital banking, are prevalent.
5. **Educational Attainment**: Education remains a priority, with families investing heavily in the education of their children, leading to a highly skilled workforce.
6. **Global Exposure**: Increased exposure to global cultures and practices through media and travel.
7. **Social Characteristics**: A shift to nuclear family structures is evident, and changing gender roles with more women entering the workforce, leading to dual-income households.

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Issues Faced by the New Middle Class

1. **Economic Pressures**:
   a. **Cost of Living**: Rising cost of living, especially in urban areas, poses a significant challenge. For instance, housing and education costs are escalating.
   b. **Job Insecurity**: The volatile job market, particularly in the IT sector, leads to job insecurity and stress.
2. **Social Pressures**:
   a. **Work-Life Balance**: High-pressure jobs and long working hours affect work-life balance and lead to stress and health issues.
   b. **Cultural Shifts**: Rapid cultural shifts create a generational divide, with traditional values clashing with modern lifestyles.
3. **Educational Challenges**:
   a. **Quality of Education**: While access to education has improved, the quality of education remains a concern, with many institutions not meeting global standards.
   b. **Higher Education Costs**: The rising cost of higher education creates financial strain on middle-class families.
4. **Health Concerns**:
   a. **Lifestyle Diseases**: Increased incidence of lifestyle diseases such as diabetes, hypertension, and obesity due to sedentary lifestyles and dietary changes.
   b. According to the **World Health Organization,** non-communicable diseases account for 63% of all deaths in India, highlighting the impact of lifestyle changes.
   c. **Mental Health**: Stress, anxiety, and depression are on the rise due to competitive work environments and economic pressures.
5. **Environmental Impact**:
   a. **Urban Pollution**: Rising pollution levels in urban areas where the middle class predominantly resides lead to health issues.
   b. **Resource Strain**: Increased consumption strains natural resources, contributing to environmental degradation.

Impact of Globalisation on the New Middle Class

Positive Impacts

1. **Increased Consumer Choices and Lifestyle Upgradation:** The inflow of global brands and products has transformed consumption patterns. Eg. Rising demand for electronics, global fashion, fast food chains, and international travel among urban middle classes.
2. **Employment in Service and IT Sectors:** Globalisation led to the expansion of IT, BPO, retail, and hospitality sectors, which became major employers. Eg. India's IT-BPM sector employed over 5 million people by **2023 (NASSCOM),** mostly from the urban middle class.
3. **Educational and Skill Development Opportunities:** Growing enrolment in international curriculum schools and foreign university collaborations **(UGC 2022 guidelines).**
4. **Rise of Entrepreneurship and Startups:** Global market exposure and digital tools have fostered middle-class entrepreneurship. Eg. Government schemes like Startup India and digital payment systems enabled many middle-class-led startups.
5. **Cultural Exposure and Liberal Values:** Media, the internet, and travel have introduced liberal ideas, promoting meritocracy, individualism, and aspirational living. Changing attitudes toward career choices, gender roles, and marriage norms.

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Negative Impacts

1. **Consumerism and Debt Dependency:** Rising aspirations have increased reliance on credit cards and EMIs. Eg. The **RBI** reported a 30% increase in personal loans and credit card debt between 2021 and 2023.
2. **Job Insecurity and Stress:** Despite job creation, many globalised sectors involve contract-based work and long hours. Eg. The gig economy and startup culture often lack job stability and work-life balance.
3. **Cultural Disorientation and Identity Crisis:** Rapid westernisation has sometimes led to loss of traditional values or cultural confusion. Eg. Generational clashes within families regarding lifestyle and values.
4. **Exclusion of Lower Middle Class:** Not all segments benefited equally; rising inequality within the middle class. Eg: Urban slums are expanding near IT hubs, where lower-income middle-class workers face housing and inflation pressures.
5. **Pressure to Perform and Compete Globally:** The new middle class faces intense competition in globalised job markets, requiring constant upskilling.

Impact of Globalization on Tier 2 Cities

Positive Impact of Globalization on Tier 2 Cities

1. **Economic Diversification and Job Creation:** Globalization has attracted investments in IT, retail, and manufacturing sectors in Tier 2 cities. Eg. Cities like Coimbatore, Indore, and Bhubaneswar have emerged as IT and industrial hubs, supported by state industrial policies and SEZs.
2. **Real Estate and Infrastructure Development:** Improved connectivity, better roads, airports, and housing have upgraded urban infrastructure. Eg. Under **the Smart Cities Mission, 100 cities—mostly Tier 2: H**ave received central assistance to upgrade urban services.
3. **Reverse Migration from Metros:** Due to rising costs in metros, professionals are moving to Tier 2 cities for better work-life balance. Eg. A NASSCOM **report (2022)** highlighted a 15% increase in tech jobs in Tier 2 cities post-COVID, driven by remote work culture.
4. **Improved Education and Healthcare Access:** Foreign collaborations and private investments have expanded schools, colleges, and hospitals in smaller cities. Eg. Cities like **Surat and Vizag** have seen a rise in international schools and multi-specialty hospitals.
5. **Rise in Aspirational Consumption:** Exposure to global media and retail has increased demand for branded goods, e-commerce, and fast food. Eg. E-commerce giants like **Amazon and Flipkart** report a significant share of sales now coming from **Tier 2 and 3 cities.**

Negative Impact of Globalization on Tier 2 Cities

1. **Urban Sprawl and Environmental Stress:** Rapid development has led to unregulated construction, traffic congestion, and pollution. Eg. Cities like Lucknow and Jaipur face rising air and water pollution due to infrastructure strain.
2. **Cultural Homogenization:** Global media and retail have diminished local languages, crafts, and traditions. Eg. Decline in traditional industries like handloom and handicrafts in cities such as Mysuru and Varanasi.
3. **Uneven Development:** While central areas prosper, surrounding rural or slum areas often remain underdeveloped. Eg. Satellite towns around Patna and Bhopal lack basic civic amenities despite city center growth.
4. **Rising Cost of Living:** Gentrification and real estate booms have made housing and services unaffordable for lower-income groups. Eg. Property prices in cities like Chandigarh and Kochi have doubled in the past decade.
5. **Skill Mismatch and Job Disparity:** The influx of global firms often demands high-skill labor, which the local workforce may lack. Eg. Many Tier 2 youth remain underemployed due to a lack of soft skills and industry-relevant training.

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Way Forward for Globalization

Focus Area	Specific Measures
1. Cultural Safeguarding	Enforce a **mandatory quota for regional content** on OTT platforms like Netflix and Prime to protect linguistic and folk diversity. Launch **"Digital India Culture Fund"** to subsidize local artists creating culturally rooted content.
2. Skill Development	Set up **Global Job Readiness Cells** under Skill India Mission specifically for SC/ST/OBC youth to prepare for private and international markets. Include **global soft skills** and industry-aligned English training in ITIs and vocational schools.
3. Digital Platform Regulation	Amend the **IT Rules (2021)** to require platforms like Facebook, YouTube, and WhatsApp to auto-flag casteist and communal content. Impose **algorithm transparency audits** to detect cultural bias and digital exclusion.
4. Protecting Indigenous Knowledge	Create a **National Register of Traditional Knowledge and Practices** to prevent global misappropriation (Eg. Yoga, Basmati). Expand GI (Geographical Indication) tagging for tribal and rural products (Eg. Warli art, Kullu shawls).
5. Inclusive FDI Policies	Make it **mandatory for foreign companies** investing in India to employ a minimum percentage (say 20%) of socially or regionally disadvantaged groups. Conduct **Social Equity Impact Assessments (SEIA)** before approving large MNC projects.
6. Diaspora Reform	Through Indian embassies, enforce **anti-caste sensitization training** for diaspora institutions, temples, and schools. Support **Dalit and tribal diaspora cultural organizations** through ICCR grants.
7. Inclusive Education	Introduce a **"Globalization with Indian Values"** course in CBSE and state boards from Class 9 onwards. Make a study of the Indian Constitution and global justice movements (Eg. Mandela, Ambedkar, MLK) compulsory in teacher training programs.
8. Work-Life and Family Welfare	Mandate a **maximum of 48-hour work weeks and flexible schedules** in tech and BPO sectors through revised labor codes. Incentivize companies offering **family welfare support**, including eldercare, creches, and paid parental leave.
9. Ethical Consumption Promotion	Launch a **"Buy Local First" digital label** across e-commerce platforms like Amazon and Flipkart for certified Indian products. Enforce **eco-social labels** for imported products based on labor and environmental standards.
10. Rural Globalization Models	Link **tribal homestay schemes** in the Northeast and Jharkhand with global eco-tourism platforms like Airbnb. Train SHGs in **export packaging and branding** for local crafts through KVIC and TRIFED collaboration.

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Chapter 5

Population, Migration & Poverty

PYQs

[2026] Critically examine the challenges of demographic transition in contemporary India. 15

[2026] How do you understand disability? Substantiate the need for inclusive policy framework in India in this regard. 10

[2024] Why do large cities tend to attract more migrants than smaller towns? Discuss in the light of conditions in developing countries. 10

[2024] What is the concept of a 'demographic winter'? Is the world moving towards such a situation? Elaborate. 10

[2024] In dealing with socio-economic issues of development, what kind of collaboration between government, NGOs, and the private sector would be most productive? 10

[2021] Discuss the main objectives of Population Education and point out the measures to achieve them in India in detail. 10

[2023] Why did human development fail to keep pace with economic development in India? 15

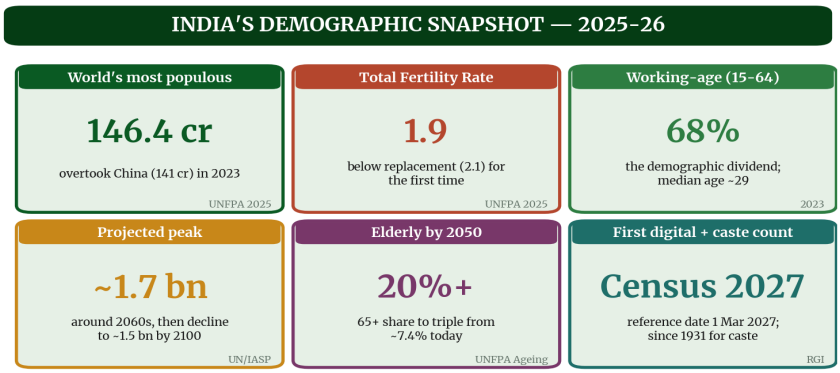
[2025] Achieving sustainable growth with emphasis on environmental protection could come into conflict with poor people's needs in a country like India. Comment. 15

[2025] Does tribal development in India centre around two axes, those of displacement and of rehabilitation? Give your opinion. 15

PART A — POPULATION & MIGRATION

1. Introduction, Key Data & Concepts of Population

India is now the world's most populous country, yet its fertility has fallen below the replacement level — placing it at a demographic inflection point. The challenge has shifted from controlling numbers to harnessing a young workforce before the window closes and managing an emerging old-age and regional imbalance.



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Concepts & measurement

Total Fertility Rate (TFR): average children per woman; replacement level is 2.1. India's TFR is ~1.9-2.0 — below replacement.

Demographic momentum: population keeps growing for decades after fertility falls, because a large share is still of reproductive age.

Net Reproduction Rate (NRR): daughters per woman surviving to reproductive age; NRR = 1 is the long-run stabilisation goal of NPP 2000.

- **Most populous nation** – 146.39 crore in April 2025; overtook China (141 crore) in 2023. Eg. UNFPA SOWP 2025.
- **Below replacement** : TFR 1.9 (UNFPA) / 2.0 (NFHS-5); urban India crossed replacement by ~2004, rural by ~2023.
- **Regional divergence** : Only 5 states remain above replacement. Eg. Bihar (3.0), Meghalaya (2.9), UP (2.7), Jharkhand, Manipur; 31 below.
- **Young but aging** : Median age ~29; working-age (15-64) is 68%; elderly to exceed 20% by 2050.
- **Census 2027** : First fully digital census with caste enumeration since 1931; reference date 1 March 2027; ₹11,718 crore.

Mains angle: *Frame India as being at a 'demographic crossroads' — no longer an over-population story but a race to convert the dividend into prosperity before ageing sets in.*

2. Factors: Distribution & Growth of Population

Factors influencing distribution

- **Physiography & climate** : Plains and moderate climates draw dense settlements. Eg. Indo-Gangetic plain; sparse Himalayas/Thar.
- **Water & soil** : Fertile, well-watered tracts support high density. Eg. alluvial Ganga basin vs arid Rajasthan.
- **Economy & industry** : Jobs concentrate people in industrial-urban belts. Eg. Mumbai-Pune, NCR, Bengaluru.
- **Urbanisation & connectivity** : Transport corridors and cities attract migrants.
- **Historical & political** : Long-settled cultural cores and administrative hubs.
- **Density contrast** : Bihar ~1,106/km^2 vs Arunachal ~17/km^2 (Census 2011) — among the world's widest.

Factors affecting population growth

- **Fertility decline** : Rising education, contraception and aspirations cut TFR. Eg. Kerala/TN below 1.6; Bihar 3.0.
- **Mortality falls** : Better health cuts death and infant-mortality rates. Eg. IMR down to ~28; life expectancy 72.
- **Female education & autonomy** : The strongest fertility depressant. Eg. Kerala's high female literacy → low TFR.
- **Age at marriage** : Later marriage lowers fertility. Eg. mean female marriage age ~22-24.
- **Urbanisation** : Urban life lowers desired family size.
- **Son preference & access gaps** : Keep fertility higher in some northern states.
- **Demographic momentum** : Young age structure sustains growth despite low TFR.
- **Migration** redistributes the population to receiving states/cities.

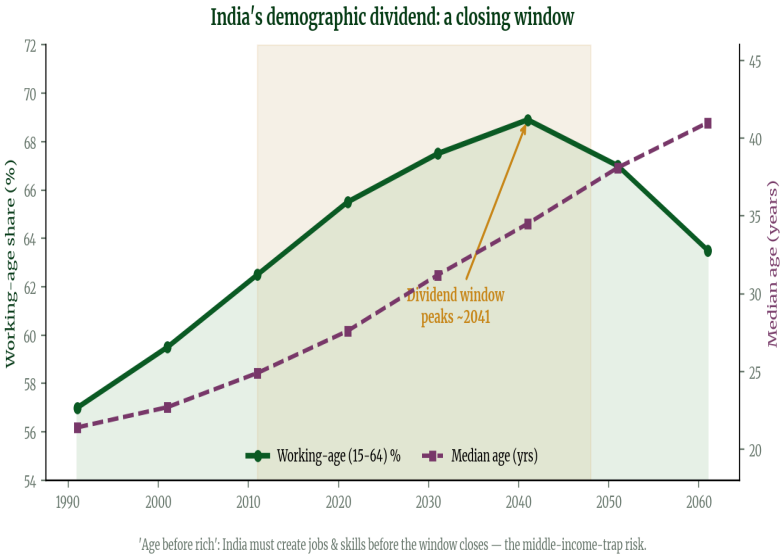
Theories: *Malthus(population outruns food → positive checks); Demographic Transition Theory (Thompson/Notestein : Four states); Ester Boserup (population pressure spurs agricultural innovation : The anti-Malthusian view).*

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India's Demographic Dividend

Significance / Opportunity:

- **Large workforce** : 68% working-age; a low dependency ratio (~46) boosts savings and growth.
- **Savings & investment** : Fewer dependents raise household savings and capital formation.
- **Consumption & markets** : A young population powers demand, housing and services.
- **Global labour edge** : A young India can supply skills as advanced economies age. Eg. IT, healthcare, care-work exports.
- **Innovation & entrepreneurship** : Youthful workforce drives start-ups and a digital economy.
- **Window timing** : The dividend peaks around 2041 before the working-age share contracts.



'Age before rich': India must create jobs & skills before the window closes — the middle-income-trap risk.

Risks & Challenges:

- **Jobless growth** : Too few quality jobs for new entrants; high youth unemployment.
- **Skill deficit** : Low employability. Eg. only a fraction of graduates are job-ready; PLFS shows a mismatch.
- **'Age before rich'** : Fertility may fall to 1.3 by 2050 — risking the middle-income trap.
- **Low female participation** : FLFPR ~41.7% wastes half the potential dividend.
- **Regional mismatch** : Young workers in Bihar/UP, jobs in the ageing South — needs internal mobility.
- **Health & nutrition gaps** : Anaemia and stunting reduce productivity.
- **Informality** : 90%+ informal jobs offer low productivity and no security.
- **Automation/AI threat** : Technology may erode the labour-cost advantage.

Way Forward:

- **Skill & educate** : Scale Skill India, NEP 2020, and apprenticeships for employability.
- **Create quality jobs** : Labour-intensive manufacturing (PLI), MSMEs and services.
- **Raise FLFPR** : Care economy, safety and flexible work to draw women in.
- **Health & nutrition** : POSHAN 2.0 and Anaemia Mukt Bharat for a productive workforce.
- **Enable mobility** : Portable benefits (One Nation One Ration Card) to match workers to jobs.

Mains angle: *PYQ link (Prelims/Mains): the dividend 'will remain theoretical unless our manpower becomes educated, skilled and creative' — skilling and jobs are the binding constraints.*

4. National Population Policy 2000 & Determinants of Change

National Population Policy (NPP) 2000

- **Long-term goal** : Achieve a stable population by 2045, at a level consistent with sustainable development (NRR = 1).
- **Immediate aim** : Address unmet contraception, health-care and infrastructure needs.
- **Medium-term aim** : Bring TFR to replacement (2.1) through inter-sectoral action.

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- **Socio-demographic goals** : Universal school enrolment, lower IMR (<30) and MMR, and reduced infectious disease.
- **Approach** : Voluntary, target-free and rights-based — not coercive.
- **Institutional** : Set up the National Commission on Population and a target of delaying marriage.

Determinants of Population Change

- **Fertility (births)** : Shaped by education, income, contraception and marriage age.
- **Mortality (deaths)** : Falling with health-care, nutrition and sanitation gains.
- **Migration** alters distribution and growth across regions.
- **Marriage patterns** : Age and universality of marriage affect fertility.
- **Education & women's status** : The most powerful determinant of declining fertility.
- **Government policy** : Family welfare, health and incentive schemes.

Mains angle: *Note the rights-based pivot: post-2000 India rejects coercion (unlike the 1975-77 sterilisation excesses) — the 'cafeteria approach' of informed, voluntary choice.*

5. The Ageing of India

As fertility falls and longevity rises, India faces accelerating population ageing — a 'silver challenge' superimposed on incomplete development ('growing old before growing rich').

Data

- **Rising elderly share** – 65+ population ~7.4% now, projected above 20% by 2050 (UNFPA India Ageing Report).
- **Absolute scale** – ~150 million elderly today, set to ~347 million by 2050.
- **Feminisation of ageing** : Women outlive men (life expectancy 74 vs 71) — more elderly widows.
- **Southern lead** : Kerala, Tamil Nadu age fastest; northern states still young.
- **Old-age dependency** : Rising elderly dependency will strain the workforce.

Challenges / Issues

- **Income insecurity** : Most elderly lack pensions; ~85% worked in the informal sector.
- **Health burden** : Rising non-communicable and geriatric diseases; weak geriatric care.
- **Social isolation** : Nuclear families and migration erode traditional joint-family support.
- **Elder abuse & neglect** : Financial and emotional abuse of seniors is rising.
- **Feminised vulnerability** : Elderly widows face poverty and dependency.
- **Care infrastructure gap** : Few old-age homes, day-care, or trained caregivers.
- **Digital exclusion** : Seniors struggle with digital services and banking.
- **Fiscal pressure** : Pension and health costs will mount as the share rises.

Way Forward

- **Universal pension floor** : Strengthen NSAP/old-age pensions and Atal Pension Yojana.
- **Geriatric health** : Scale the National Programme for Health Care of the Elderly (NPHCE).
- **Active ageing** : Skilling, re-employment and social engagement for seniors.
- **Care economy** : Build elder-care services and trained caregivers as formal jobs.
- **Implement the law** : Enforce the Maintenance and Welfare of Parents and Senior Citizens Act 2007.
- **Silver economy** : Tap senior-focused products, housing and tourism.

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6. Population, Development & the Environment

Population interacts with development and ecology in complex ways — the debate runs from Malthusian alarm to the view that consumption patterns, not headcount, drive environmental stress.

Impact / Linkages

- **Resource pressure** : Rising numbers and incomes strain land, water and energy. *Eg. per-capita water below the 1,700 m^3 stress line.*
- **Food & land** : Demand for food drives intensive farming and land conversion.
- **Urban ecological stress** : Rapid urban growth fuels waste, pollution and heat islands.
- **Consumption, not just count** : The rich consume far more; the top decile's footprint dwarfs the poor's.
- **Climate vulnerability** : Dense populations in coastal and flood-prone zones face rising risk.
- **Demographic-environment link** : Education and lower fertility ease long-run pressure.
- **IPAT framework** : Impact = Population × Affluence × Technology — all three matter.
- **Energy transition** : A growing economy must decouple growth from emissions.

Way Forward

- **Sustainable consumption** : Shift the affluent towards low-carbon lifestyles (Mission LiFE).
- **Green technology** : Renewables and efficiency to break the growth-emissions link.
- **Resource efficiency** : Circular economy, water harvesting and conservation.
- **Educate & empower** : Female education lowers fertility and raises ecological awareness.
- **Climate-resilient planning** : Protect dense, vulnerable habitats.

Debate: Neo-Malthusians (Paul Ehrlich, 'Population Bomb') stress numbers; critics (Boserup, Amartya Sen) argue distribution, technology and consumption matter more — India's per-capita footprint is still far below the West's.

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7. The Gendered Dimension of Population

Issues

- **Skewed sex ratio at birth** : Son preference and sex-selection. *Eg. SRB 929 (NFHS-5).*
- **'Missing women'** : Amartya Sen's concept — tens of millions absent from sex-selective neglect.
- **Female mortality disadvantage** : Historical neglect in nutrition and health (now partly reversed).
- **Fertility burden on women** : Contraception and family size decisions fall on women.
- **Marriage migration** – ~67% of female migration is for marriage, limiting autonomy.
- **Low workforce participation** : FLFPR ~41.7% despite falling fertility — a paradox.
- **Education-fertility link** : Educating girls is the strongest route to demographic balance.
- **Ageing widows** : Feminisation of ageing creates a vulnerable elderly-women cohort.

Way Forward

- **Enforce the PCPNDT Act** : Curb sex-selection; strengthen Beti Bachao Beti Padhao.
- **Invest in girls' education** : The most effective fertility and empowerment lever.
- **Boost FLFPR** : Care infrastructure and safe work to use the female dividend.
- **Reproductive autonomy** : Universal access to contraception and maternal health.
- **Social security for elderly women** : Pensions and care for widows.

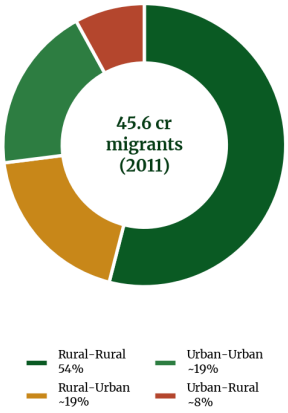
Mains angle: *Tie the gender dimension to the 'real fertility crisis' (UNFPA 2025) — the issue is unmet reproductive choice and autonomy, not just numbers.*

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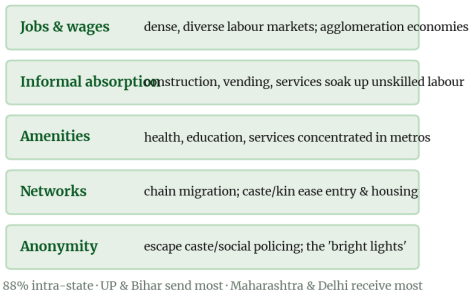
Migration

Data & streams · why large cities attract migrants (2024) · the 'demographic winter' debate (2024).

Internal migration streams



Why large cities pull migrants



Internal migration — the numbers (Census 2011)	
Total migrants	45.6 crore (38% of population); up 45% over 2001
Internal share	99% internal; 1% international
Largest stream	Rural-rural — 21 crore (54%)
Intra-state	~88% of internal migration

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Largest senders	Uttar Pradesh & Bihar
Largest receivers	Maharashtra & Delhi
Female migration	~67% for marriage; male mainly for work

Why do large cities attract more migrants than smaller towns (2024 PYQ)

- **Agglomeration economies** : Dense, diverse labour markets raise the odds and pay of finding work. *Eg. Mumbai, Delhi, Bengaluru.*
- **Informal-sector absorption** : Construction, vending and domestic work soak up unskilled migrants.
- **Higher & varied wages** : Metros offer wage premiums over rural/small-town work.
- **Amenities & services** : Health, education, and infrastructure concentrated in big cities.
- **Social networks** : Chain migration via caste/kin lowers the cost and risk of moving.
- **Urban primacy** : Developing countries over-invest in a few mega-cities, magnifying their pull.
- **Anonymity & freedom** : Cities loosen caste/social policing — the 'bright lights' effect.
- **Rural push** : Agrarian distress and disguised unemployment drive distress out-migration.

Theories: Lewis dual-sector model (surplus rural labour shifts to modern urban sector); Harris-Todaro model (migration responds to expected, not actual, urban wages — explaining migration despite urban unemployment); Lee's push-pull framework.

'Demographic winter' — concept & the world (2024 PYQ)

Demographic winter: a sustained fall of fertility below replacement, leading to population decline and rapid ageing — a 'wintering' of human numbers.

- **Developed world** : Japan, Italy, South Korea (TFR ~0.7) face shrinking, ageing populations.
- **China's turn** : Population began declining in 2022-23 amid sub-replacement fertility.
- **India's signal** : TFR below replacement (1.9) — early signs in southern states.
- **But not universal** : Sub-Saharan Africa still has TFR above 4; world population still grows to a peak in the ~2080s.
- **Drivers** : Rising costs, female education and careers, urbanisation, and unmet reproductive support.
- **Verdict** : The world is partially moving there — the rich world is already in winter; the globe is trending but not yet declining.

Mains angle: *For the 2024 PYQ, balance the answer: yes, much of the developed world (and now China) faces demographic winter, but Africa's youth bulge means global population still rises for decades.*

9. Population Education

Definition: Population Education (UNESCO) is an educational programme that builds awareness of population dynamics and their relationship with quality of life — enabling responsible, informed decisions about family, resources and the environment.

Main Objectives

- **Population-resource awareness** : Understand how population size affects resources, environment and development.
- **Small-family & responsible parenthood** : Promote the value of a planned, small family.
- **Reproductive & adolescent health** : Impart knowledge of family planning and sexual health.
- **Gender equality** : Challenge son-preference and promote girls' education and autonomy.
- **Delaying marriage** : Encourage later marriage and spacing of births.
- **Sustainable-development outlook** : Link population to ecology and quality of life, not just numbers.

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Measures to achieve them in India

- **Curriculum integration** : Embed population concepts in school syllabi via NCERT/NCF.
- **Adolescence Education Programme** : AEP delivers life-skills, reproductive and health education in schools.
- **Teacher & institutional capacity** : NPEP (National Population Education Project) trains teachers and develops material.
- **Mass media & IEC** : Awareness campaigns through TV, radio and community drives.
- **Frontline workers** : ASHA, ANM and Anganwadi outreach on family planning and health.
- **Convergence with schemes** : Link to Mission Parivar Vikas, RMNCH+A and Beti Bachao Beti Padhao.

10. The State's Response & Way Forward

Policy architecture

- **NPP 2000 & NCP** : Voluntary, target-free stabilisation framework via the National Commission on Population.
- **Mission Parivar Vikas** : Focused on family planning in high-fertility districts; expanded contraceptive choice.
- **Reproductive health** : RMNCH+A strategy; free contraceptives; Antara/Chhaya injectables.
- **Skilling & jobs** : Skill India, NEP 2020, PLI and apprenticeships to use the dividend.
- **Elderly care** : NPHCE, NSAP pensions and the Senior Citizens Act.
- **Census 2027** : Digital, caste-enumerated data to refresh all demographic planning.

Way Forward

- **Invest in human capital** : Education, health and skills to convert numbers into productivity.
- **Jobs-led growth** : Labour-intensive sectors to absorb the youth bulge.
- **Mainstream gender** : Raise FLFPR and reproductive autonomy.
- **Plan for ageing now** : Pensions, geriatric care and the silver economy.
- **Balance regions** : Support high-fertility states and enable internal mobility.
- **Reject coercion** : Stay with rights-based, voluntary population stabilisation.

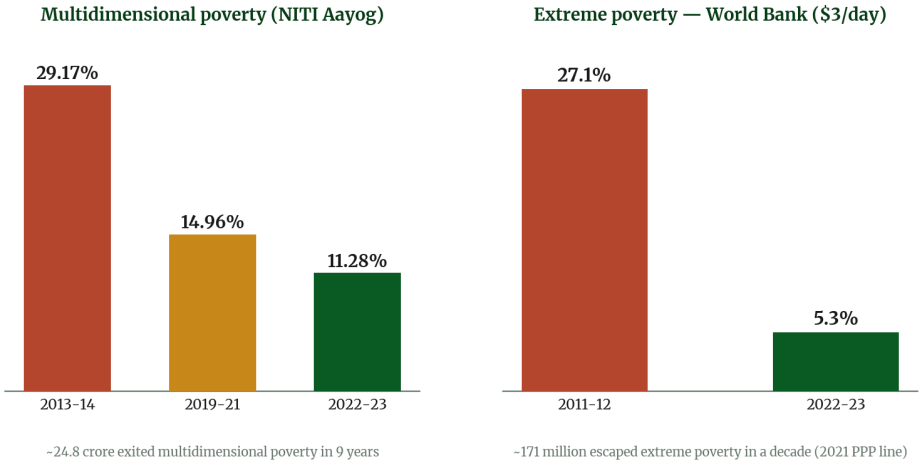
Mains angle: *Cite the 16th Finance Commission debate: as the South ages and the North stays young, fiscal devolution and delimitation must not penalise states that controlled fertility.*

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PART B — POVERTY & DEVELOPMENTAL ISSUES

11. Conceptualising Poverty — Measures, Lines & MPI

Poverty is, in the World Bank's words, 'pronounced deprivation in well-being'. India's measurement has evolved from a calorie-based income line to a multidimensional view of deprivation — and the headline numbers have fallen dramatically.



Ways of measuring poverty

Absolute vs relative poverty: absolute = inability to afford a fixed minimum basket (poverty line); relative = falling below a society's prevailing living standard (Peter Townsend's 'relative deprivation').

Income vs multidimensional: income poverty uses a consumption line; multidimensional poverty (MPI) captures overlapping deprivations in health, education and living standards (Alkire-Foster method, OPHI).

- **Tendulkar Committee (2009)** : Set the line at ~₹33 (urban)/₹27 (rural) per day; poverty ~21.9% in 2011-12.
- **Rangarajan Committee (2014)** : Raised the line (₹47 urban/₹33 rural); ~29.5% in 2011-12 — not officially adopted.
- **National MPI (NITI Aayog)** : Three dimensions, 12 indicators; headcount fell 29.17% (2013-14) → 11.28% (2022-23).
- **Global MPI (UNDP/OPHI)** : 415 million Indians exited multidimensional poverty (2005-06 to 2019-21).
- **World Bank (June 2025)** : New $3.00/day line (2021 PPP); India's extreme poverty fell 27.1% → 5.3%; ~171 million escaped.
- **Headline shift** : ~24.8 crore exited multidimensional poverty in 9 years; rural extreme poverty 18.4% → 2.8%.

Mains angle: *Know the measurement debate: a missing 2017-18 consumption survey and differing lines explain why estimates vary (UNDP 15% vs NITI 11.28% for 2019-21). Use both income and multidimensional lenses.*

12. Six Paradoxes of Indian Poverty Today

India's poverty story is full of contradictions — sharp progress alongside stubborn deprivation. These 'paradoxes' are powerful analytical hooks.

- **Growth without enough jobs** : High GDP growth, yet weak formal job creation and 90%+ informality.
- **Falling income poverty, persistent malnutrition** : Extreme poverty at 5.3%, yet 57% of women are anaemic, and child stunting is high.

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- **Food surplus amid hunger** : Record grain stocks and exports, yet India ranks low on the Global Hunger Index.
- **Welfare expansion, continued deprivation** : Vast schemes (free foodgrains to ~80 crore), yet pockets of acute poverty remain.
- **Urban prosperity, rural and tribal distress** : Booming metros beside agrarian and tribal deprivation.
- **Demographic dividend, jobless youth** : A young workforce, yet high youth and graduate unemployment.
- **Rising income, widening inequality** : Growth concentrated at the top; India loses ~31% of HDI to inequality.
- **Digital leap, digital divide** : World-leading digital public infrastructure, yet exclusion of the poorest.

Mains angle: *These paradoxes frame the 2023 PYQ (growth vs human development) and the 2025 PYQ (sustainability vs the poor) — growth has not automatically translated into well-being for all.*

13. Theories & Structural Drivers of Poverty

Concepts & thinkers

Capability approach: Amartya Sen — poverty is 'capability deprivation', the lack of freedoms to live a valued life, not merely low income ('Development as Freedom').

Culture of poverty: Oscar Lewis — argued poverty perpetuates through adaptive behaviours (a contested, often-criticised thesis).

Entitlement & 'soft state': Sen's entitlement theory (famine from access failure, not just food shortage); Gunnar Myrdal's 'soft state' explaining weak implementation in 'Asian Drama'.

Structural drivers in India

- **Agrarian distress** : Small holdings, low productivity and indebtedness keep rural India poor.
- **Informality & low wages** – 90%+ informal work with no security traps workers in working poverty.
- **Caste & social exclusion** : Dalits, Adivasis and minorities face compounded, inherited disadvantage.
- **Gender inequality** : Low FLFPR and unpaid care work limit women's escape from poverty.
- **Regional disparity** : The 'BIMARU' belt and tribal districts lag behind richer states.
- **Asset & land inequality** : Skewed land and capital ownership perpetuate deprivation.
- **Health & education deficits** : Out-of-pocket health costs and learning gaps reproduce poverty.
- **Climate & disaster shocks** : Floods, drought and heat push vulnerable families back into poverty.

Inter-generational trap: low human capital → low income → low investment in children — the poverty trap Nurkse described as a 'vicious circle'.

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Human Development vs Economic Development

Why has human development failed to keep pace with India's economic growth?

India on the Human Development Index (HDR 2025)	
HDI rank	130 of 193 (value 0.685, 2023)
Category	Medium human development (high ≥ 0.700)
Life expectancy	72 years (up from 58.6 in 1990)

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Mean years of schooling	6.9; GNI per capita (PPP) ~$9,000
Inequality-adjusted HDI	~0.475 — India loses ~31% of HDI to inequality
Neighbours above	China (78), Sri Lanka (89); Bangladesh on par

Why has human development lagged behind economic growth (2023 PYQ)

- **Low social-sector spending** : Public health ~2% of GDP and education ~3% — below targets.
- **Jobless & unequal growth** : Growth concentrated in capital-intensive sectors and at the top.
- **Rising inequality** : India loses nearly a third of its HDI to inequality (IHDI).
- **Persistent malnutrition** : Anaemia and stunting persist despite higher incomes.
- **Gender gap** : Low FLFPR and 131st on the Gender Gap Index drag human development.
- **Regional & caste disparities** : Kerala rivals Europe while Bihar/UP lag far behind.
- **Informality** – 90%+ informal jobs mean income without security or mobility.
- **Quality deficits** : Schooling and health access rose, but learning and outcomes lagged.

Way Forward

- **Invest in human capital** : Raise health and education spending to 2.5% and 6% of GDP.
- **Inclusive, jobs-led growth** : Labour-intensive sectors and MSMEs to spread gains.
- **Reduce inequality** : Progressive spending, social protection and quality public services.
- **Close gender & regional gaps** : Targeted investment in women and lagging states.
- **Outcome focus** : Shift from access to learning and health outcomes.

Scholarly frame: Amartya Sen vs Jagdish Bhagwati debate — Sen prioritises social investment (health/education) as the route to growth; Bhagwati stresses growth-first. Mahbub ul Haq's HDI reframed development as enlarging human choices, not just GDP.

15. Faces & Lived Experience of Poverty

The faces of poverty today

- **The agrarian poor** : Small/marginal farmers and landless labour facing distress and debt.
- **The urban informal poor** : Slum dwellers, street vendors and gig/construction workers.
- **The socially excluded** : Dalits, Adivasis and minorities with inherited deprivation.
- **Women & female-headed households** : The 'feminisation of poverty'.
- **Children & the elderly** : Malnourished children and pensionless seniors.
- **Migrants & the 'missing'** : Circular migrants invisible to local welfare (exposed in 2020).

The lived experience — body, mind, dignity

- **The body** : Hunger, anaemia, stunting and untreated illness; out-of-pocket health shocks.
- **The mind** : Chronic stress, insecurity and the 'bandwidth tax' of scarcity (Mullainathan & Shafir).
- **Dignity & exclusion** : Stigma, powerlessness and social humiliation, beyond mere income.
- **Time poverty** : Long hours of survival labour, especially for women.
- **Voicelessness** : Exclusion from decisions and weak access to entitlements.

Mains angle: *Use the 'body-mind-dignity' lens to humanise answers — poverty is a lived condition of insecurity and indignity, echoing Sen's capability deprivation, not just a statistic.*

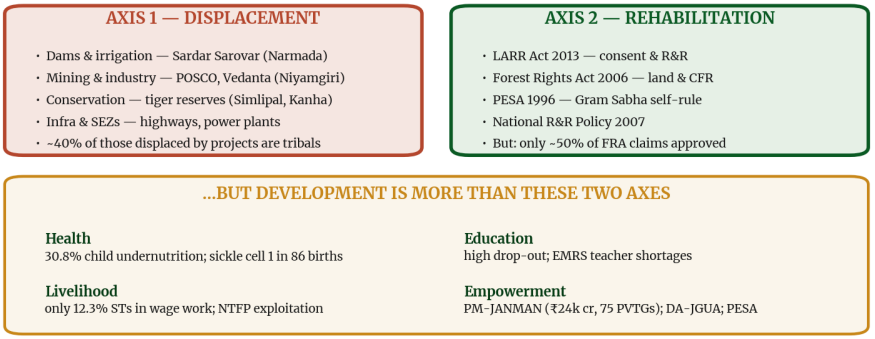
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Tribal Development

Axis 1 — Displacement

- **Dams & irrigation** : Mega-projects submerge tribal land. Eg. Sardar Sarovar (Narmada) displaced thousands.
- **Mining & industry** : Extraction on mineral-rich tribal belts. Eg. POSCO and Vedanta (Niyamgiri) in Odisha.
- **Conservation eviction** : Relocation from protected areas. Eg. tiger reserves — Simlipal, Kanha, Nagarhole.

Tribal development: the two axes — and beyond



Verdict: displacement & rehabilitation are the most visible failures — but true development also needs health, education, livelihood & self-rule.

- **Infrastructure & SEZs** : Highways, power plants and zones displace settlements.
- **Disproportionate burden** : Tribals are ~8.6% of people but a large share of project-displaced.

Axis 2 — Rehabilitation

- **LARR Act 2013** : Consent, social-impact assessment and resettlement guarantees.
- **Forest Rights Act 2006** : Recognises individual and community forest rights. Eg. The Dongria Kondh Gram Sabha vetoed Vedanta.
- **PESA 1996** : Gram Sabha self-rule in Scheduled Areas.
- **National R&R Policy 2007** : Humane resettlement, but uneven implementation.
- **Implementation gap** : Only ~50% of FRA claims are approved; rehabilitation is often delayed.

...but development is more than two axes

- **Health** – 30.8% child undernutrition; sickle-cell disease in 1 of 86 tribal births.
- **Education** : High dropout; Eklavya Model Residential Schools face teacher shortages.
- **Livelihood** : Only 12.3% of STs in wage work; exploitation in NTFP markets.
- **Empowerment** : PM-JANMAN (₹24,000 cr, 75 PVTGs) and DA-JGUA for saturation development.
- **Governance & culture** : Effective PESA self-rule and protection of tribal identity.

Opinion / Way Forward

- **Minimise displacement** : Treat it as a problem to reduce, with free, prior, informed consent.
- **Rights-based rehabilitation** : Full FRA, PESA and fair, land-for-land resettlement.
- **In-situ development** : Eco-tourism, agro-forestry and Van Dhan value-addition.
- **Human-development focus** : Health, nutrition and education for all tribals, not only the displaced.
- **Participatory governance** : Empowered Gram Sabhas and tribal voice in decisions.

Mains angle: *2025 verdict: displacement and rehabilitation are the most visible axes, but a complete view must add health, education, livelihood and self-rule — development must be more than damage-and-repair.*

17. Future Forces — Poverty, Climate Change & AI

Poverty in the age of climate change (2025 PYQ)

- **Climate hits the poor first** : Farmers, fishers and informal workers bear the brunt of heat, floods and drought.

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- **Growth-vs-poor tension** : Strict environmental limits can raise costs for the poor. *Eg. fuel/cooking costs, forest-access curbs.*
- **Energy access** : Clean-energy transitions must not deny the poor affordable power. *Eg. Ujjwala LPG, solar.*
- **Livelihood disruption** : Climate shocks reverse poverty gains and force distress migration.
- **Just transition** : Balance ecology and equity — the poor need protection, not exclusion.
- **India's stance** – 'common but differentiated responsibilities'; low per-capita emissions; Mission LiFE.
- **Reconciling both** : Green jobs, climate-resilient agriculture and PDS-linked safety nets can align goals.
- **Way forward** : Pro-poor climate finance, resilient livelihoods and inclusive green growth.

Mains angle: *For the 2025 PYQ, argue that sustainability and poverty-reduction need not conflict if transitions are 'just' — but acknowledge real short-term trade-offs (Eg. conservation vs forest livelihoods) that need pro-poor design.*

Poverty in the age of AI

- **Opportunity** : AI can target welfare, detect leakage and improve service delivery. *Eg. DBT, agri-advisory, tele-health.*
- **Risk of exclusion** : Automation may displace low-skill jobs and widen the digital divide.
- **Skills imperative** : Reskilling is essential so the poor share in AI-era gains.
- **Governance** : India's 'human-centric AI' vision and IndiaAI Mission stress inclusion.
- **Way forward** : Digital literacy, social protection and AI for public good.

Society's Role & Collaboration

Why collaboration is needed (2024 PYQ)

- **Complementary strengths** : The State brings scale and legitimacy, NGOs reach and trust, business efficiency and innovation.
- **Government's role** : Policy, funding, public goods and rights guarantees. *Eg. MGNREGA, PDS, Ayushman Bharat.*
- **NGOs' role** : Last-mile delivery, community mobilisation and accountability. *Eg. SEWA, PRADAN, Goonj.*
- **Private sector's role** : Jobs, technology, supply chains and CSR finance. *Eg. skilling, fintech for inclusion.*
- **Convergence models** : Blended finance, social-impact bonds and PPPs for social outcomes.
- **Examples that work** : Aspirational Districts Programme (govt + NGOs + business); Kudumbashree; corporate-NGO skilling.

Principles for productive partnership

- **Clear role division** : Leverage each actor's comparative advantage; avoid duplication.
- **Accountability & transparency** : Social audits, outcome metrics and grievance redress.
- **Community at the centre** : Participatory, demand-driven design with local ownership.
- **Sustainable financing** : Blend public funds, CSR and philanthropy for continuity.
- **Trust & autonomy** : Respect NGO independence; balanced FCRA regulation.
- **Technology as an enabler** : JAM, DBT and data for targeting and leakage control.

Mains angle: *The 2024 PYQ answer: no single actor can end poverty alone — the State sets the frame and funds, NGOs deliver and hold to account, and business brings jobs and innovation; the Aspirational Districts Programme is the model of such convergence.*

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Chapter 6

Role of Women & Women's Organisations

PYQs

[2024] Distinguish between gender equality, gender equity, and women's empowerment. Why is it important to take gender concerns into account in programme design and implementation? 10

[2023] Explain why suicide among young women is increasing in Indian society. 10

[2018] 'Women's movement in India has not addressed the issues of women of lower social strata.' Substantiate your view. 10

1. Women in India — Key Quotes & Core Concepts

"I measure the progress of a community by the degree of progress which women have achieved." — **B.R. Ambedkar.**

"You can tell the condition of a nation by looking at the status of its women." — **Jawaharlal Nehru.**

"There is no chance for the welfare of the world unless the condition of women is improved." — **Swami Vivekananda.**

"One is not born, but rather becomes a woman." — **Simone de Beauvoir**

"There is no tool for development more effective than the empowerment of women." — **Kofi Annan**

"Woman is the companion of man, gifted with equal mental capacities." — **Mahatma Gandhi**

Core distinction (directly tested in 2024)

Gender equality: sameness of rights, opportunities and treatment for all genders — the destination of equal outcomes.

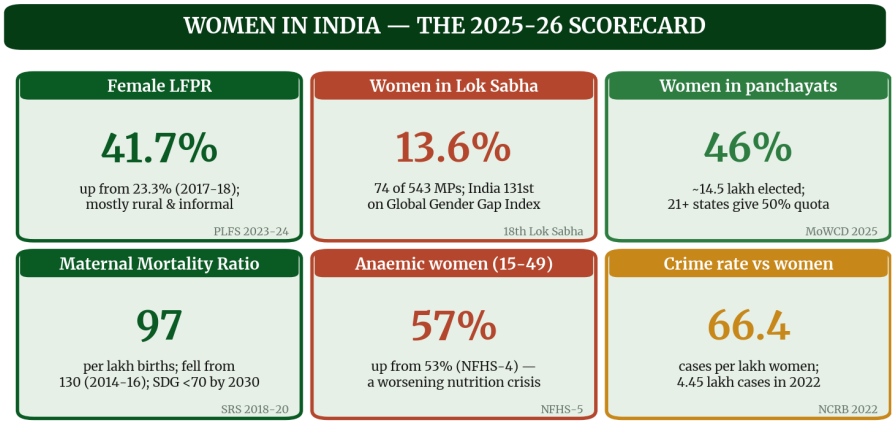
Gender equity: fairness of process — giving differentiated support based on different needs so that unequal starting points reach equal outcomes. Equity is the road; equality is the destination.

Women's empowerment: expanding women's agency — the ability to make strategic life choices where this was previously denied (Naila Kabeer). It is 'power within, power to, and power with'.

- **Why gender concerns matter in programme design** : Gender-blind policy reproduces inequality; gender-responsive design corrects it. *Eg. gender budgeting, women-only coaches, crèches at worksites.*
- **Substantive vs formal equality** : Legal equality (Article 14) is hollow without enabling conditions — Article 15(3) allows protective discrimination.

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2. Key Data Points — The 2025-26 Scorecard



Politics & participation	
Women in the 18th Lok Sabha	74 of 543 MPs (13.6%); 39 in Rajya Sabha
Women in State Assemblies	~9% MLAs (2025)
Women in panchayats	~46% (~14.5 lakh); 50% quota in 21+ states
Global Gender Gap Index 2025	131st of 148 (parity score 64.1%)

Economy, crime, health & education	
Female LFPR (PLFS 2023-24)	41.7% (up from 23.3% in 2017-18)
Women in informal work	over 90% of employed women
Crimes against women (NCRB)	4.45 lakh (2022); rate 66.4 per lakh women
Spousal violence (NFHS-5)	~29.3% of ever-married women aged 18-49
Maternal Mortality Ratio	97 per lakh (SRS 2018-20); SDG <70 by 2030
Anaemia in women 15-49 (NFHS-5)	57% (worsened from 53% in NFHS-4)
Female literacy gap	~14.4 percentage points below men (7+)
Sex ratio at birth (NFHS-5)	929 girls per 1,000 boys

Patriarchy

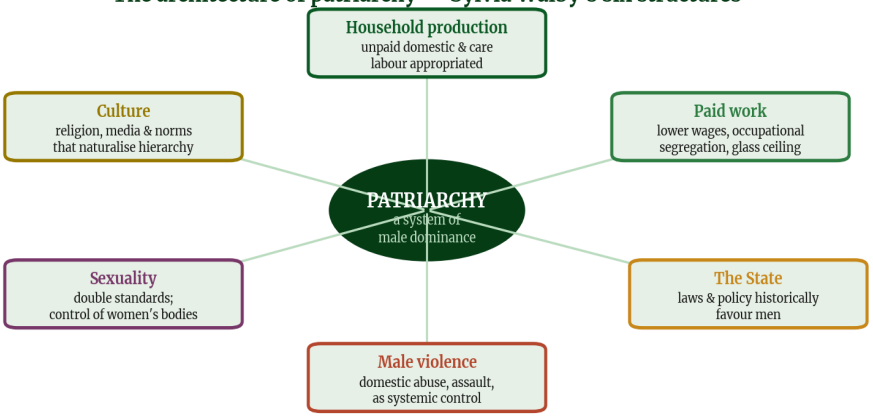
Definition

Patriarchy is a social system in which men hold primary power and predominate in political leadership, moral authority, social privilege, and control of property. Sociologist Sylvia Walby defines it as 'a system of social structures and practices in which men dominate, oppress and exploit women'.

Scholars to cite: Kate Millett (patriarchy as a political institution, 'Sexual Politics'); Gerda Lerner ('The Creation of Patriarchy'); Friedrich Engels (patriarchy rooted in private property); Uma Chakravarti ('Brahmanical patriarchy' linking caste, class and gender in India).

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The architecture of patriarchy — Sylvia Walby's six structures



Walby argues patriarchy persists by shifting from 'private' (household) to 'public' (workplace, state) forms.

Sources of Patriarchy

- **Control of property & production** : Land, inheritance and capital historically vested in men. Eg. low female land ownership despite the Hindu Succession (Amendment) Act 2005.
- **Religion & custom** : Scriptural and customary norms sanctify male authority. Eg. restrictions on temple entry; Sabarimala debate.
- **Sexual division of labour** : Women assigned reproductive/care roles, men productive ones.
- **Control over women's sexuality** : Honour, chastity and reproduction policed to preserve lineage and caste purity. Eg. Honour killings, Khap panchayats.
- **Socialisation & culture** : Media, family and education naturalise hierarchy from childhood. Eg. gendered toys, 'good girl' conditioning.
- **Capture of the State & law** : Historically male-made laws. Eg. marital rape is still not a standalone offence under BNS.

Impact on Women

- **Son preference & 'missing women'** : Amartya Sen estimated tens of millions of 'missing women' from sex-selective neglect. Eg. skewed sex ratio at birth (929).
- **Economic dependence** : Unpaid care work worth 3.1% of GDP keeps women out of paid work. Eg. Time Use Survey 2024.
- **Violence** : Domestic abuse as systemic control. Eg. ~29.3% of ever-married women report spousal violence (NFHS-5).
- **Restricted mobility & autonomy** : Purdah, safety fears and 'permission' norms shrink the public sphere.
- **Health & nutrition penalty** : Women eat last and least. Eg. 57% anemia among women aged 15-49.
- **Educational drop-out** : Domestic duties and early marriage truncate schooling. Eg. The mean age at marriage is still ~22-24.
- **Political exclusion** : Few women in decision-making. Eg. 13.6% of Lok Sabha; weakest WEF dimension.
- **Psychological toll** : Internalised inferiority and the 'second shift' raise stress and distress.

Major Revolts by Women — India

- **Social reform era** : Raised against sati, child marriage, and for widow remarriage. Eg. Savitribai Phule's girls' schools (1848); Pandita Ramabai.
- **Nationalist participation** : Mass mobilisation in the freedom struggle. Eg. Sarojini Naidu; women in the Salt Satyagraha.
- **Telangana & Tebhaga** : Peasant-women in armed agrarian struggles (1940s).
- **Chipko & anti-arrack** : Women-led ecology and prohibition movements. Eg. Gaura Devi (Chipko, 1973); Andhra anti-arrack agitation (1992).

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- **Anti-rape movement** : The Mathura case (1979-80) sparked rape-law reform; Nirbhaya (2012) led to the Criminal Law Amendment 2013.
- **Recent assertions** – #MeToo India (2018); Shaheen Bagh (2019-20); wrestlers' protest (2023).

Major Revolts by Women — World

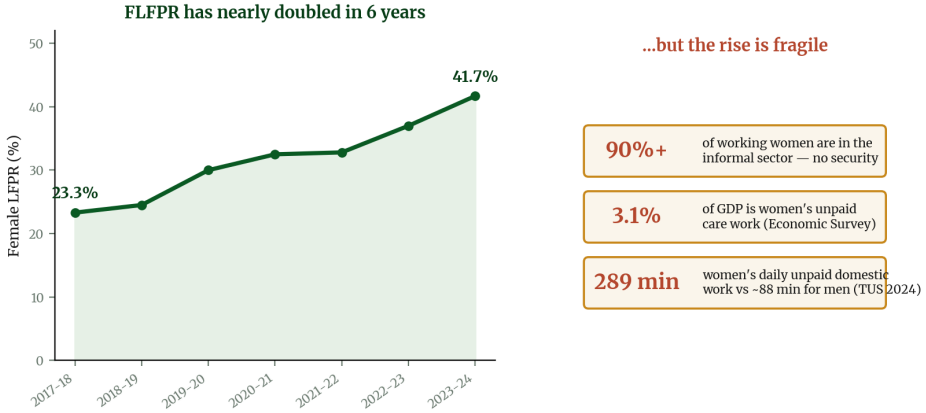
- **Suffrage movement** : Won the vote. Eg. Seneca Falls (1848); UK Suffragettes; Emmeline Pankhurst.
- **Second-wave feminism** challenged the 'personal is political'. Eg. Betty Friedan ('The Feminine Mystique'); Simone de Beauvoir.
- **Reproductive rights** : Bodily autonomy struggles. Eg. Roe v. Wade; global pro-choice movements.
- **Recent global waves** – #MeToo (2017); Iran's 'Woman, Life, Freedom' (2022); Argentina's Ni Una Menos.

Way Forward

- **Transform socialisation** : Gender-sensitive curricula and male engagement to dismantle norms early.
- **Economic empowerment** : Asset ownership, equal pay and recognising care work (the '3 Rs' — recognise, reduce, redistribute).
- **Legal teeth** : Criminalise marital rape; enforce inheritance and anti-violence laws.
- **Political voice** : Operationalise the Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam quickly.
- **Engage men & boys** : Patriarchy harms men too; allyship is essential.

Mains angle: *Patriarchy is structural, not individual — Walby's shift from 'private' to 'public' patriarchy explains why workplace and state reform now matter as much as household change.*

4. Women in the Economy



Data

- **Rising participation** : FLFPR up from 23.3% (2017-18) to 41.7% (2023-24), led by rural women.
- **Quality deficit** : Over 90% in informal work; much is unpaid family labour or self-employment.
- **Unpaid care** : Women's unpaid work = 3.1% of GDP; 289 min/day vs ~88 min for men (TUS 2024).
- **Entrepreneurship** : Female-headed proprietary establishments rose to 26.2% (2023-24); 58.4% in manufacturing.
- **Financial inclusion** – 28+ crore women hold Jan Dhan accounts; ₹12 lakh crore lent to women SHGs.

Major Challenges

- **The care penalty** : Absence of crèches and rigid hours pushes women out post-childbirth.
- **Gender pay gap** : Women earn far less; earned-income parity is only ~30% (WEF 2025).
- **Occupational segregation** : Women concentrated in low-paid agriculture, domestic work, and garments.
- **Mobility & safety** : Unsafe transport and workplaces limit job choice.

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- **Asset & credit gap** : Low land/collateral ownership restricts entrepreneurship.
- **Skilling mismatch** : Only 2.9% of employed women aged 25+ hold advanced degrees in jobs.
- **Digital exclusion** : Lower phone/internet access blocks gig and e-commerce work.
- **Glass ceiling** : Few women in leadership. *Eg. low share of women CEOs and board directors.*

Achievements

- **Maternity Benefit (Amendment) Act 2017** – 26 weeks' paid leave — among the world's most generous.
- **SHG revolution** – 10 crore women in SHGs; incomes tripled FY19-FY24 (SBI study).
- **Drone Didi & Lakhpati Didi** : New-economy livelihoods; 3 crore Lakhpati Didi target.
- **Code on Wages 2019** mandates equal pay for equal work across sectors.

Way Forward

- **Recognise & redistribute care** : Expand Anganwadis, crèches and the care economy as formal jobs.
- **Skilling for new sectors** : STEM, green jobs and digital skills for women.
- **Safe mobility & housing** : Working-women hostels. *Eg. Sakhi Niwas; Tamil Nadu's Thozhi Hostels.*
- **Close the credit gap** : Collateral-free loans and women-focused finance. *Eg. Stand-Up India, Mudra.*
- **Enforce equal pay & ESG** : Wage audits and gender-diversity disclosure norms.
- **Leverage U-curve** : As incomes rise, enable women's re-entry into quality jobs.

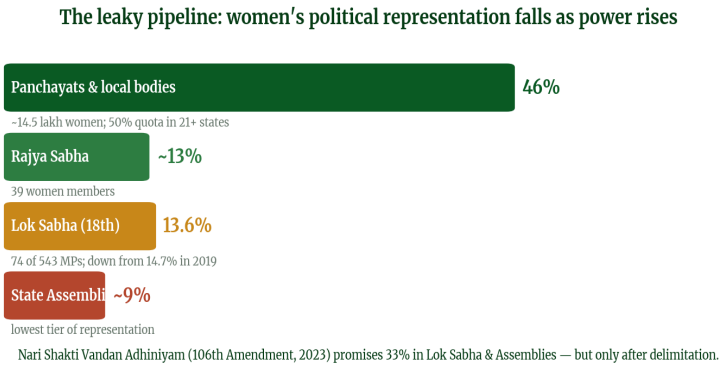
Scholars & theories: Esther Boserup's 'Women's Role in Economic Development'; the Feminisation U-hypothesis; Diane Elson's '3 Rs' of care; Amartya Sen's 'cooperative conflict' within households.

Mains angle: *2018 PYQ link: economic gains are uneven — Dalit, Adivasi and Muslim women face compounded disadvantage, an intersectional gap mainstream programmes often miss.*

5. Women in Politics

Data

- **National legislatures** – 13.6% of Lok Sabha (74 MPs); ~9% of State Assemblies.
- **Local self-government** – ~46% of panchayat seats; 21+ states reserve 50%.
- **Global standing** : India 131st on WEF Gender Gap 2025; political empowerment its weakest pillar.
- **Landmark law** : Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam (106th Amendment, 2023) - 33% reservation, post-delimitation.



Major Challenges

- **Patriarchal gatekeeping** : Parties give few 'winnable' tickets to women.
- **'Sarpanch Pati' syndrome** : Male relatives exercise power behind elected women.
- **Money & muscle** : High campaign costs and electoral violence deter women.
- **Implementation delay** : The women's quota is tied to a delayed census and delimitation.
- **Dual burden** : Domestic responsibilities limit the time for politics.
- **Intersectional exclusion** : Dalit, Adivasi and minority women are doubly under-represented.
- **Tokenism & abuse** : Women leaders face online trolling and credibility attacks.

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- **No Rajya Sabha/Council quota** : The new law excludes the Upper House and Legislative Councils.

Achievements

- **73rd/74th Amendments (1992)** – 33-50% reservation created ~14.5 lakh women leaders.
- **Substantive impact** : Women pradhans invest more in water, sanitation, and child welfare (Beaman, Duflo, Pande, Topalova).
- **Role models** : Droupadi Murmu as President; women Chief Ministers and Speakers.
- **Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam** : The most significant gender-political reform in 27 years.

Way Forward

- **Operationalise the quota** : Fast-track census/delimitation; consider interim measures.
- **Build a pipeline** : Capacity-building and Mahila Gram Sabhas for women leaders.
- **Intra-party reform** : Voluntary party quotas for women candidates.
- **Curb the proxy problem** : Training, mentoring and accountability for elected women.
- **Consider OBC sub-quota** : Debate inclusion of OBC women within the reservation.
- **Safe digital & physical space** : Protect women in public life from violence and trolling.

Theory: Critical mass theory holds that ~30% representation is the threshold at which women shift legislative agendas — the rationale for one-third reservation.

Mains angle: *Local-body evidence is India's strongest argument: reservation demonstrably changed spending priorities, validating the case for legislative quotas.*

6. Women and Technology

Technology is double-edged for women — a powerful equaliser of access and voice, yet also a new frontier of exclusion and abuse.

Positive / Enabling Technology as a liberating force

- **Financial inclusion** : DBT, UPI and Jan Dhan put money directly in women's hands. *Eg. 28+ crore women Jan Dhan accounts.*
- **Livelihoods & markets** : E-commerce and ONDC open national markets to home-based women. *Eg. SEWA and SHG sellers on ONDC.*
- **EdTech & telehealth** : Remote learning and telemedicine reach women in remote areas. *Eg. e-Sanjeevani consultations.*
- **Safety tech** : Panic buttons, SOS apps and CCTV aid personal security. *Eg. 112 India app; Himmat (Delhi Police).*
- **Voice & mobilisation** : Social media amplifies women's movements. *Eg. #MeToo India (2018).*
- **New-economy jobs** : Drone, gig and platform work create avenues. *Eg. Namo Drone Didi — 15,000 SHGs.*

Negative / Disruptive Technology as a driver of exploitation & exclusion

- **Digital gender divide** : Women own and use phones/internet far less, deepening exclusion.
- **Deepfakes & image abuse** : AI-generated non-consensual content targets women. Eg. the 2023 deepfake of an actor sparked IT-rule action.
- **Cyber harassment & stalking** : Trolling, doxxing and revenge porn silence women online.
- **Algorithmic bias** : AI hiring and credit tools can encode gender bias.
- **Surveillance & control** : Families and partners monitor women's phones and movement.
- **Gig precarity** : Platform work offers flexibility but no security or maternity cover.

Way Forward

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- **Close the divide** : Subsidised devices, data and digital-literacy drives for women. Eg. Digital Didi, PMGDISHA.
- **Strong legal shield** : Swift action on deepfakes and online abuse under the IT/DPDP regime.
- **Safety by design** : Platforms must build reporting, privacy and consent tools.
- **Women in tech** : Scholarships and STEM pipelines. Eg. Vigyan Jyoti, WEST scheme.
- **Gender-audited AI** : Bias testing for AI used in hiring, credit and welfare.
- **Social protection for gig women** : Portable benefits and maternity cover. Eg. e-Shram registration.

Mains angle: *Frame technology as 'neither inherently liberating nor oppressive' — outcomes depend on access, literacy and regulation. The DPDP Act 2023 and IT Rules are the live policy levers.*

7. Women and the Environment

Data & Reports

- **Disproportionate climate burden** : UN estimates ~80% of those displaced by climate change are women.
- **Resource labour** : Women do most water and fuel collection; scarcity multiplies their workload.
- **Agriculture's feminisation** : With male out-migration, women run farms but rarely own the land.
- **Disaster vulnerability** : Women and girls die at higher rates in disasters (gendered mobility, caregiving).
- **Key frameworks** : IPCC AR6, UNEP and the UNFCCC Gender Action Plan flag women as both vulnerable and as agents of change.

Impact of Climate Change on Women

- **Livelihood loss** : Crop failure and erratic monsoons hit women-dependent farming and forest produce.
- **Health risks** : Heat, pollution, and water-borne disease raise maternal and reproductive risks.
- **Time poverty** : Longer walks for water and fuel cut time for work and education.
- **Distress migration** : Men migrate, leaving women with farm, care and survival burdens.
- **Child marriage & trafficking** : Post-disaster distress increases early marriage and exploitation.
- **Energy poverty** : Reliance on biomass causes indoor-air-pollution deaths among women. Eg. addressed partly by Ujjwala LPG.

Way Forward

- **Gender-just climate policy** : Mainstream gender in NAPCC, State Action Plans and finance.
- **Women as agents** : Fund women-led conservation and renewable enterprises. Eg. solar 'Didis', forest committees.
- **Secure land & resource rights** : Joint titles and Forest Rights Act recognition for women.
- **Clean energy access** : Scale LPG, solar cookers and clean cooking. Eg. PM Ujjwala Yojana.
- **Disaster preparedness** : Gender-sensitive early warning, shelters and relief.
- **Climate-resilient livelihoods** : Drought-tolerant crops and skilling for green jobs.

Ecofeminism: Vandana Shiva links women's subordination with ecological exploitation (the Chipko legacy); Bina Agarwal's 'environmental feminism' shows women's participation in forest governance improves both equity and conservation.

8. Women and Education

Key Data Points

- **Literacy gap** : Female literacy lags behind that of men by ~14.4 percentage points (7+ years).
- **School parity achieved** : India reached gender parity at all school levels (UDISE+).

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- **Higher education surge** : Female enrolment rose ~50% in a decade; women's GER is now near/above men's (AISHE).
- **STEM skew** : Women are well-represented in science, but fewer choose engineering/IT careers.
- **Education's strongest WEF score** – 97.1% parity on educational attainment (Gender Gap 2025).

Major Challenges Faced

- **Drop-out at secondary level** : Domestic work, distance, safety and menstruation drive girls out.
- **Early marriage** : Interrupts schooling. *Eg.* child marriage prevalence is still significant in some states.
- **Digital divide in EdTech** : Fewer devices for girls widened pandemic learning loss.
- **Learning-to-earning gap** : High enrolment does not convert into jobs (low FLFPR among graduates).
- **Safety & sanitation** : Lack of toilets and safe transport deters attendance.
- **Gender stereotyping** : Curricula and counselling steer girls from STEM and leadership.
- **Skewed field choice** : Social norms channel women into 'caring' rather than technical fields.
- **Adult illiteracy** : Older female cohorts remain disproportionately illiterate.

Way Forward

- **Retention focus** : Scholarships, cycles, toilets and menstrual hygiene to keep girls in school.
- **NEP 2020 levers** : Gender Inclusion Fund and Kasturba Gandhi schools for disadvantaged girls.
- **Bridge education to employment** : Vocational and digital skills tied to local jobs.
- **STEM push** : Role models and labs for girls. Eg. Vigyan Jyoti.
- **Adult literacy** : Target older women through ULLAS/New India Literacy.

Best Practices — State & Global

- **Bihar Cycle Yojana** : Free bicycles sharply raised girls' secondary enrolment.
- **KGBV & Beti Bachao Beti Padhao** : Residential schools and awareness for the girl child.
- **Global: Bangladesh stipends** : Female secondary stipends boosted enrolment and delayed marriage.
- **Global: Malala Fund / Africa** : Conditional support models for girls' schooling.

> **Mains angle:** *Education is India's brightest gender metric — but the 'learning-to-earning' gap means the next frontier is converting schooling into jobs and agency.*

9. Women and Health

Key Data Points

- **Maternal mortality** : MMR fell to 97 (SRS 2018-20) from 130 (2014-16); 8 states meet SDG <70.
- **Anaemia crisis** : 57% of women aged 15-49 are anaemic (NFHS-5) — worse than NFHS-4.
- **Fertility below replacement** : TFR 2.0 (NFHS-5); demographic transition largely achieved.
- **Life expectancy edge** : Female life expectancy 70.7 vs male 68.2 (SRS).
- **Screening gap** : Only 1.7% of women are ever screened for cervical cancer (NFHS-5).
- **Rising female suicide** : India accounts for a large share of global female suicides (Lancet); a 2023 UPSC concern.

Major Challenges Faced

- **Nutrition deficit** : The 'eat last, least' norm fuels anaemia and undernutrition.
- **Reproductive health gaps** : Unmet contraception need; unsafe abortions in remote areas.
- **Mental health & suicide** : Young women face academic, marital and dowry pressure. *Eg.* 2023 PYQ theme.
- **Access barriers** : Distance, cost, and 'permission' delay women's care-seeking.
- **Adolescent health** : Menstrual taboos, early pregnancy and school drop-out.

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- **Non-communicable diseases** : Low screening for breast and cervical cancer.
- **Tribal & rural disparity** : High MMR and anemia clusters in poorer states.
- **Provider shortage** : Too few female health workers in many regions.

Why young women's suicide is rising (2023 PYQ)

- **Marital & dowry stress** : Harassment and early-marriage pressures.
- **Academic & career anxiety** : Intense competition and unemployment.
- **Restricted autonomy** : Control over choices, mobility and relationships.
- **Agrarian distress** : Farm women face debt and crop failure.
- **Easy means & weak support** : Limited mental-health services and stigma.

Way Forward

- **Anchor on Anaemia Mukt Bharat & POSHAN 2.0** : Scale supplementation and dietary diversity.
- **Strengthen maternal care** : JSY/JSSK, Surakshit Matritva and HWCs.
- **Mental-health integration** : Tele-MANAS and school counsellors for young women.
- **Universal screening** : HPV vaccination and cancer screening at Health & Wellness Centres.
- **Adolescent focus** : RKSK and menstrual-hygiene schemes.
- **Female health workforce** : More ASHAs, ANMs and women doctors.

Best Practices — State & Global

- **Tamil Nadu & Kerala** : Strong public health and low MMR through robust primary care.
- **PM Matru Vandana & Mission Shakti** : Cash incentives for safe motherhood and nutrition.
- **Global: Rwanda/Bangladesh** : Community health workers cut maternal deaths sharply.
- **Global: HPV vaccination drives** : National cervical-cancer prevention models.

Mains angle: *For the 2023 PYQ, structure the answer around social (marriage, autonomy), economic (distress, unemployment) and systemic (weak mental-health care) drivers — and end with Tele-MANAS and means-restriction.*

10. Rural vs Urban Women

Dimension	Rural women	Urban women
Livelihood	Farm & allied work; unpaid family labour; feminisation of agriculture	Domestic work, garments, services, gig economy; informal & insecure
Key violence	Domestic violence, dowry, witch-hunting, honour crimes	Sexual harassment, workplace abuse, cybercrime, stalking
Mobility	Distance, lack of transport, and social policing	Unsafe public transport & streets despite better connectivity
Health	High MMR/anaemia; poor access; early marriage	Lifestyle disease, stress, delayed marriage, and fertility decline
Education	Drop-out from distance, safety, and domestic duty	Higher enrolment but 'learning-to-earning' gap
Assets & credit	Low land ownership; SHG-led microcredit	Housing & childcare costs; better formal credit access
Care burden	Water/fuel collection adds hours of unpaid work	Nuclear families + few crèches strain dual-earner women

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Dimension	Rural women	Urban women
Agency	Caste/khap control; SHGs as emerging voice	Anonymity offers freedom; RWAs, activism, online voice

11. Constitutional, Legal & Policy Measures

Constitutional safeguards

- **Article 14, 15(1)** : Equality before the law and prohibition of sex discrimination.
- **Article 15(3)** enables special provisions for women — the basis of protective laws.
- **Article 16, 39(a)(d), 42** : Equal opportunity, equal pay, just and humane work and maternity relief.
- **Article 51A(e), 243D, 243T** : Duty to renounce derogatory practices; reservation in panchayats and municipalities.

Type	Key laws & policies
Violence	Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act 2005; Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (POSH) Act 2013; Dowry Prohibition Act 1961; provisions in the BNS 2023.
Marriage & family	Prohibition of Child Marriage Act 2006; Hindu Succession (Amendment) Act 2005 (equal coparcenary rights); Muslim Women (Protection of Rights on Marriage) Act 2019.
Work & economy	Maternity Benefit (Amendment) Act 2017 (26 weeks); Equal Remuneration via Code on Wages 2019; Factories Act provisions.
Political	73rd & 74th Amendments (1992); Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam / 106th Amendment 2023.
Health & welfare	MTP (Amendment) Act 2021; PM Matru Vandana Yojana; POSHAN Abhiyaan; Mission Shakti (Sambal + Samarthya).
Reproductive/identity	Surrogacy (Regulation) Act 2021; Transgender Persons Act 2019.

12. Major Success Stories — State Policies & SHGs

India's women-led SHG movement — the quiet revolution (DAY-NRLM)

10 cr	₹12 L cr	3 cr	3×
women in SHGs across ~90 lakh groups	**loans disbursed** to women SHGs (Jan 2026)	**Lakhpati Didi target** ₹1 lakh+ annual income	**SHG incomes rose** FY19–FY24 (4.6× urban)

From microcredit to micro-enterprise: SHGs build financial autonomy, leadership & collective bargaining power.

Kudumbashree (Kerala, ~46 lakh women) and SEWA (~29 lakh members) show how collectivisation converts economic participation into social and political voice — the strongest Indian evidence for women-led development.

Self-Help Group movement

- **Scale** : 10 crore women in SHGs; ₹12 lakh crore disbursed (DAY-NRLM, Jan 2026).
- **Income impact** : SHG member incomes tripled FY19-FY24 (4.6× for urban members; SBI study).
- **Lakhpati Didi**: 3 crore women targeted to earn ₹1 lakh+/year via diversified livelihoods.
- **New frontiers** : Namo Drone Didi (15,000 SHGs); Bank Sakhis and Digital Didis drive financialisation.

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State policies that worked

- **Kerala — Kudumbashree** : ~46 lakh women; poverty eradication, local governance and enterprise.
- **Bihar — Jeevika & Cycle Yojana** : Women's collectives and bicycles transformed mobility and schooling.
- **Andhra/Telangana — DWCRA/Streenidhi** : Early SHG-bank linkage and women's micro-finance.
- **Tamil Nadu — Thozhi Hostels & Pudhumai Penn** : Working-women housing and girls' higher-education incentives.
- **Odisha — Mission Shakti** : 70 lakh+ women in SHGs integrated with markets and welfare.
- **Rajasthan — Nari Adalat / women's courts** : Community dispute-resolution for gender justice (Mission Shakti).

Main angle: *SHGs are India's strongest domestic evidence for 'women-led development' — converting microcredit into agency, leadership and political voice.*

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Women's Organisations

Evolution of Role

- **Reformist phase (19th c.)** : Male-led social reform against sati, child marriage; women as beneficiaries. Eg. Brahmo Samaj, Phule schools.
- **Organisational phase (1910s-40s)** : First autonomous women's bodies and nationalist participation. Eg. WIA 1917, AIWC 1927.
- **Welfare phase (post-1947)** : State-linked welfare and development focus.
- **Autonomous feminist phase (1970s-80s)** : Issue-based activism on rape, dowry and work. Eg. post-Mathura, anti-dowry groups.
- **NGO-isation & rights phase (1990s-2010s)** : Professionalised, funded advocacy on law and rights.
- **Digital & intersectional phase (2010s-now)** : Online mobilisation and caste-class-gender lens. Eg. #MeToo, Pinjra Tod.

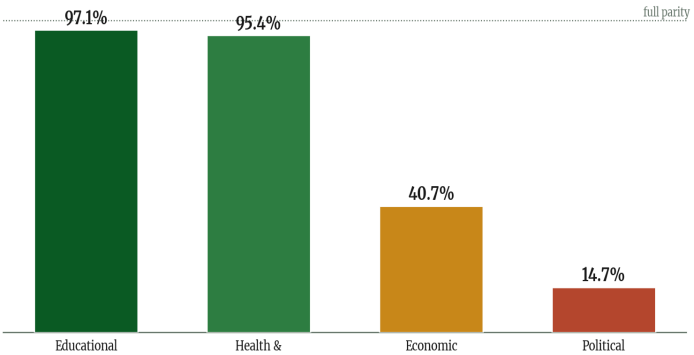
Impact

- **Law reform** : Drove the Domestic Violence Act, POSH, anti-dowry and rape-law changes.
- **Livelihoods & unionising** : Organised informal women workers. Eg. SEWA's 2.9 million members.
- **Political voice** : Pushed for the women's reservation and gender budgeting.
- **Service delivery** : Shelters, legal aid, health and micro-finance at the grassroots.

Challenges Faced

- **Class/caste blind spots** : Elite leadership long neglected Dalit and rural women (2018 PYQ).
- **Funding & FCRA constraints** : Dependence on grants; regulatory tightening.
- **Co-option & fragmentation** : State/party capture and internal divisions.
- **Backlash** : Trolling, criminalisation and 'anti-culture' framing.

India on the Global Gender Gap Index 2025 (rank 131/148, 64.1% parity)



Near-parity in education & health, but India is among the world's bottom five in economic and political participation.

Way Forward

- **Centre the marginalised** : Dalit, Adivasi, Muslim and queer women's leadership.
- **Sustainable, transparent funding** : Diversify resources and strengthen accountability.
- **Coalition-building** : Link unions, SHGs and digital movements.
- **Engage the State as a partner** : Co-design Nari Adalats, One Stop Centres and gender budgeting.
- **Use technology wisely** : Online mobilisation with safety and digital literacy.

Major Case Studies

- **SEWA (1972, Ela Bhatt)** : Ahmedabad-based trade union of ~2.9 million informal women workers; banking, childcare and unionising.
- **AIWC (1927, Margaret Cousins)** : Pioneer national body; pushed female education, suffrage and the Hindu Code reforms.
- **Kudumbashree (1998, Kerala)**: ~46 lakh women; poverty eradication through SHGs, local enterprise and governance.
- **Gulabi Gang (2006, Sampat Pal Devi)** : Bundelkhand women's collective against domestic violence and corruption.
- **Mahila Samakhya (1989)** : Government programme building rural women's collectives ('sanghas') for education and empowerment.

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Chapter 7

Urbanisation in India

PYQs

[2026] Is caste disappearing in urban India? Illustrate your answer with examples. 15

[2023] Does urbanisation lead to more segregation and/or marginalisation of the poor in Indian metropolises? 15

[2022] How is the growth of Tier-2 cities related to the rise of a new middle class with an emphasis on the culture of consumption? 10

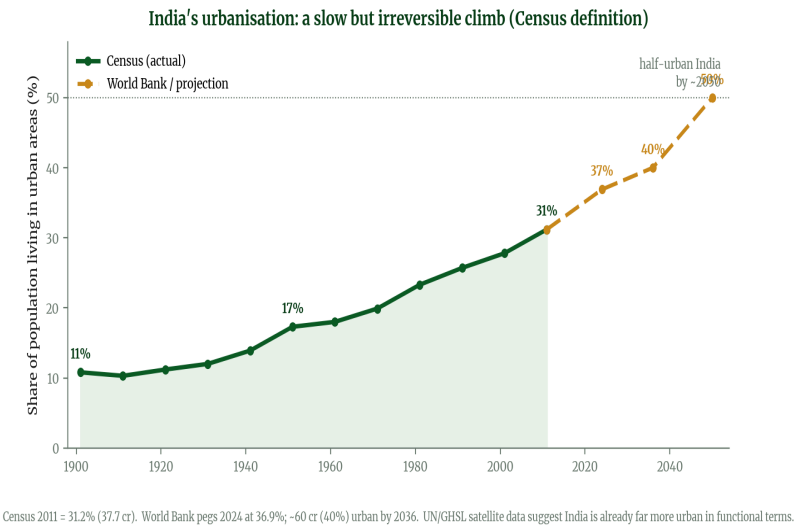
[2019] How is efficient and affordable urban mass transport key to the rapid economic development in India? 10

[2021] What are the main socio-economic implications arising out of the development of IT industries in major cities of India? 10

1. Introduction — Cities as India's Growth Engines

Urbanisation is the rising share of people living in towns and cities, accompanied by changes in their economy, society, and culture. For India, it is now an irreversible determinant of national growth and poverty reduction. The Economic Survey 2025-26 reframes cities not as habitats or welfare burdens but as critical economic infrastructure — yet calls India's urban story one of 'unfinished promise'.

- **Engines of growth** : Cities house about 37% of people but generate close to 70% of India's GDP.
- **Agglomeration economies** : Density makes firms and workers more productive; doubling a city's size lifts productivity ~12% in India. Eg. Grover-Lall-Timmis, World Bank.
- **Demographic momentum** : Urban India is set to reach ~60 crore (40%) by 2036 and ~95 crore by 2050. World Bank, 2025.
- **Top-heavy concentration** : The top-10 cities hold ~9% of people but produce nearly 28% of GDP — a ~3× ratio.



Census 2011 = 31.2% (37.7 cr). World Bank pegs 2024 at 36.9%; ~60 cr (40%) urban by 2036. UN/GHSL satellite data suggest India is already far more urban in functional terms.

- **Economic infrastructure** : Economic Survey 2025-26 argues investment, finance and governance must treat cities as assets.
- **Unfinished promise** : Scale has not translated into liveability, productivity or global competitiveness.

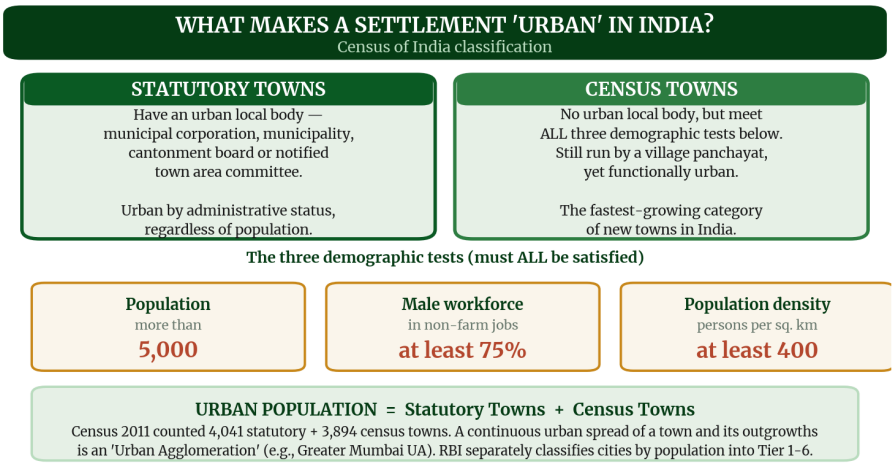
Urbanisation at a glance (2025-26)	
Urban share — Census 2011	31.2% (37.7 crore people)
Urban share — World Bank 2024	36.9% (~53.5 crore)

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Projected 2036	~40% (~60 crore); urban GDP share ~70%
Projected 2050	~95 crore urban (World Bank, 2025)
Functional urbanisation (GHSL/DEGURBA, 2015)	~63% — far above the census figure
Top-10 cities	~9% of population, ~28% of GDP

Main angle: *Frame cities as 'economic infrastructure' (Economic Survey 2025-26). The gap between economic centrality and political/fiscal peripherality of cities is the single most powerful argument in any urbanisation answer.*

2. Defining 'Urban' in India



- **Two-fold classification** : Urban India = Statutory Towns + Census Towns.
- **Statutory towns** have an urban local body — municipal corporation, municipality, cantonment board or notified town area committee.
- **Census towns** : No ULB but meet all three demographic tests; the fastest-growing category of new towns.
- **Three demographic tests** : Population >5,000; at least 75% of male workers in non-farm work; density of at least 400 persons/sq km.
- **Urban Agglomeration (UA)** : A town plus its contiguous outgrowths counted as one unit. Eg. Greater Mumbai UA, Delhi UA.
- **RBI tier system** : Classifies cities by population from Tier-1 (1 lakh and above) down to Tier-6 (below 5,000).

RBI / Census tier	Population size
Tier 1	1,00,000 and above
Tier 2	50,000 – 99,999
Tier 3	20,000 – 49,999
Tier 4	10,000 – 19,999
Tier 5	5,000 – 9,999
Tier 6	Below 5,000

4. Urbanisation and the Family System

Cities have shifted the Indian family from large, multi-generational joint households towards smaller nuclear units. This reorganisation brings both autonomy and atomisation — a classic GS-1 'changing family' theme.

POSITIVE / ENABLING **How urban life reshapes the family**

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- **Rise of nuclear families** : 61.3% of urban households are nuclear (NFHS-5), aiding labour mobility and individual choice.
- **Companionate marriage** : The couple, not the lineage, becomes central; greater spousal partnership and consent.
- **Escape from oppressive hierarchy** : Physical distance loosens patriarchal and elder control over the young.
- **Smaller, planned families** : Lower fertility and better per-child investment; many cities are below the replacement level.
- **New support networks** : Friends, RWAs and paid services partly substitute for kin support.

NEGATIVE / DISRUPTIVE **Strains on family life**

- **Elderly isolation** : Joint-family care erodes; rising old-age homes and lonely senior citizens.
- **Atomisation & loneliness** : Long commutes, nuclear units and screen-life weaken bonds and socialisation.
- **Care deficit** : Absent extended kin plus few crèches strain dual-earner couples — the 'care penalty'.
- **Fragile safety net** : Illness, job loss, or death hits nuclear units harder without kin buffers.
- **Weakening kinship & ritual** : Joint property, festivals and inter-generational transmission are diluted.

5. Urbanisation and Women

Cities open doors for women through education, jobs and anonymity — but also expose them to new vulnerabilities of safety, precarious work and a double burden.

POSITIVE / ENABLING **Opportunities for women**

- **Education & employment** : Cities offer schooling, services and IT/BPO jobs that widen women's choices.
- **Financial autonomy** : Own incomes raise bargaining power and delay marriage; SHGs and gig work help.
- **Anonymity = freedom** : Urban impersonality loosens caste and community policing of women.
- **Exposure to rights** : Easier access to courts, NGOs, helplines and reproductive health services.
- **Public visibility** : Women in transport, policing and civic life. Eg. Namo Bharat RRTS — 35%+ women operators.

NEGATIVE / DISRUPTIVE **New vulnerabilities**

- **Low urban participation** : Urban female LFPR is just 25.8% against 75.6% for men (PLFS 2024).
- **Safety & harassment** : Unsafe streets, transport and workplaces curb mobility and work. Eg. Nirbhaya case, 2012.
- **Double burden** : Paid work plus almost all domestic and care work — the 'second shift'.
- **Precarious informal work** : Domestic help, vending and construction — low pay, no security.
- **Commodification & distress** : Consumerist culture, objectification and rising urban mental-health strain.

6. Urbanisation and Caste

Sociologist M.N. Srinivas described the 'secularisation of caste' — in cities, caste loses ritual content but survives as identity and network. Urban anonymity weakens caste in the public sphere even as it persists in marriage and housing.

POSITIVE / ENABLING **How cities dilute caste**

- **Anonymity in public** : Buses, offices and markets force largely caste-blind interaction.
- **Occupational mobility** : Urban jobs break the birth-occupation (jajmani) link.
- **Inter-dining & inter-marriage** : Proximity and education raise inter-caste contact and unions.

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- **Secularisation of caste** : Caste sheds ritual meaning, surviving as identity and association. Eg. M.N. Srinivas.
- **Space for assertion** : Cities incubate Dalit movements, literature and leadership. Eg. Ambedkarite politics, Dalit publishing.

NEGATIVE / DISRUPTIVE **How caste persists**

- **Caste in the private sphere** : Marriage and home life remain strongly caste-bound.
- **Residential ghettoisation** : Caste/religion-based clustering; rental housing denied to Dalits and Muslims.
- **Caste networks in jobs** : Informal hiring and credit still flow along caste lines.
- **New political forms** : Caste associations and urban vote-banks reorganise caste. Eg. Rudolph & Rudolph's 'caste associations'.
- **Stigmatised work persists** : Sanitation and manual scavenging remain caste-coded despite legal bans.

7. Urbanisation and the Middle Class

Liberalisation and the services boom produced a large urban 'new middle class', defined more by aspiration and consumption than by occupation. It drives growth and civic activism but also new forms of exclusion.

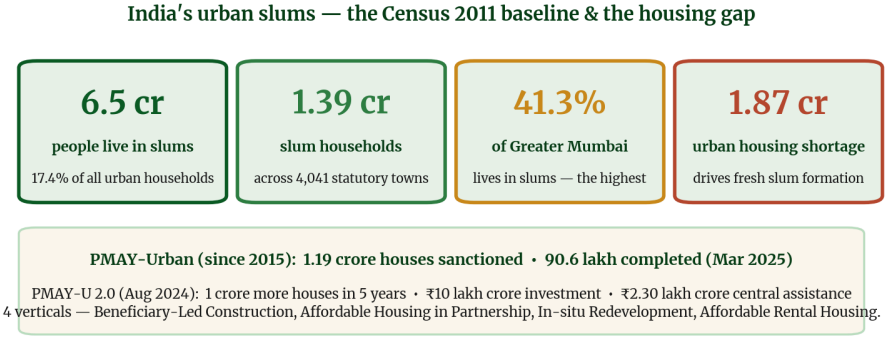
POSITIVE / ENABLING **The aspirational middle class**

- **New / neo-middle class** : Services growth and Tier-2/3 expansion enlarge a vast consuming class.
- **Consumption-led growth** : Housing, autos, education and digital demand power the economy.
- **Civil society & accountability** : RWAs, RTI activism, PILs and citizen audits. Eg. Bengaluru and Delhi civic groups.
- **Meritocratic mobility** : Education enables inter-generational class mobility.
- **Global integration** : Exposure to ideas, skills and a worldwide labour market.

NEGATIVE / DISRUPTIVE **Its discontents**

- **Bourgeois urbanism** : Middle-class aesthetics drive slum eviction and city 'beautification' drives.
- **Gated exclusion** : Gated colonies and private services segregate the middle class from the poor.
- **Civic disengagement** : Exit to private water, power and schools erodes pressure to fix public services.
- **Consumerist debt & stress** : EMIs, status spending and rising mental-health strain.
- **Precarious 'neo-middle class'** : One shock from slipping back; gig and informal insecurity.

Urban Slums



Causes

- **Distress migration** : Rural unemployment and agrarian stress push migrants to city peripheries.
- **Affordable-housing deficit** : Formal housing is too costly; a ~1.87 crore unit shortage forces informal shelter.

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- **Low land supply** : Restrictive FSI, unclear titles and 'dead capital' choke formal housing.
- **Informal livelihoods** : Casual workers need cheap, centrally-located shelter near work.
- **Weak planning** : Only ~30% of urban land is properly planned (MoHUA).

Major Issues Faced

- **Tenure insecurity** : Fear of eviction; no legal title blocks credit and self-upgrading.
- **Service deprivation** : Poor water, sanitation and drainage; under 27% of urban homes are on sewer lines.
- **Health burden** : Congestion fuels TB, vector-borne and waterborne diseases.
- **Disaster vulnerability** : Flooding, fire, heat, and demolition hit slums first.
- **Social exclusion** : Stigma, over-policing and exclusion from civic services.

Steps by the Centre

- **PMAY-Urban (2015)** : Pucca houses via BLC, AHP, ISSR and CLSS; 90.6 lakh built by March 2025.
- **PMAY-U 2.0 (2024)** : 1 crore homes, ₹10 lakh cr; in-situ slum redevelopment made flexible for states.
- **DAY-NULM** : Skilling, SHGs and shelters for the urban poor in all statutory towns.
- **PM SVANidhi** : Collateral-free working capital for street vendors; revamped in Budget 2025-26.
- **Earlier missions** : Rajiv Awas Yojana ('Slum-free India') and BSUP under JNNURM.

Steps by States (good practices)

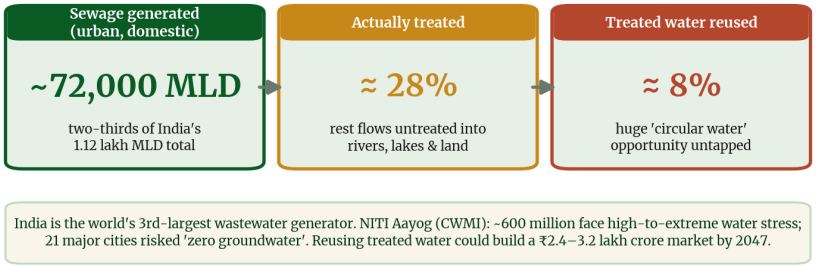
- **Odisha JAGA Mission** : Land titles to slum dwellers — among the world's largest slum land-titling drives.
- **Maharashtra SRA** : Slum Rehabilitation Authority funds in-situ redevelopment via cross-subsidy. *Eg. Dharavi Redevelopment.*
- **Telangana 2BHK** : Free double-bedroom homes for the urban poor.
- **Tamil Nadu & Andhra** : Tenement and reconstruction-board models for slum housing.

Way Forward & Global Best Practices

- **Tenure first** : Secure titles (à la Odisha JAGA) unlock self-upgrading and bank credit.
- **Upgrade, don't evict** : In-situ, participatory redevelopment keeps livelihoods intact.
- **Rental & incremental housing** : Affordable rental stock suits circular migrants.
- **Medellín, Colombia** : 'social urbanism' — metrocables, libraries and public space in poor barrios.
- **Favela-Bairro & Baan Mankong** : Brazil's and Thailand's community-led in-situ upgrading models.

Urban Water Crisis

India's urban water paradox: generated, but barely treated or reused



Water stress — key facts	
Freshwater share	India: 18% of the world's people, only 4% of the freshwater.
High-to-extreme stress	~600 million Indians (NITI Aayog CWMI).

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'Zero-groundwater' risk	21 major cities flagged — Delhi, Bengaluru, Chennai, Hyderabad.
Per-capita availability	~1,100 m^3 — below the 1,700 m^3 stress line.
Urban sewage	only ~28% treated; only ~8% reused.
Demand vs supply	demand to be 2× supply by 2030; ~6% GDP loss by 2050.

Major Causes

- **Over-extraction** : Groundwater supplies ~40% of water and is pumped unsustainably.
- **Demand-supply gap** : Booming population and lifestyles outrun supply augmentation.
- **Pollution** : ~70% of water is contaminated by untreated sewage and effluent.
- **Lost water bodies** : Encroached lakes/wetlands and concretisation cut natural recharge. Eg. Bengaluru's vanishing lakes.
- **Leakage & flat tariffs** : 40%+ non-revenue water; under-priced supply discourages saving.

Impact

- **'Day-Zero' scares** : Chennai (2019) and Bengaluru (2024) came close to running dry.
- **Health & equity** : The poor pay most (tankers); waterborne disease rises.
- **Economic drag** : Industry, IT and construction disrupted; up to 6% GDP loss by 2050.
- **Water conflict** : Inter-state and urban-rural disputes intensify. *Eg. Cauvery dispute.*

Steps Taken

- **AMRUT 2.0 (2021)** : Universal tap & sewerage; City Water Balance Plans; ₹2.99 lakh cr outlay.
- **Jal Hi Amrit** incentivises efficient sewage treatment for reuse — 860 STPs enrolled.
- **Circular water economy** : Treated-water reuse could build a ₹2.4-3.2 lakh cr market by 2047.
- **Jal Shakti Abhiyan: Catch the Rain** : Rainwater harvesting and water-body revival.
- **Atal Bhujal Yojana** : Community-led groundwater management in stressed blocks.

Way Forward & Global Best Practices

- **Reuse, don't dispose** : Scale treated-water reuse; mandate dual plumbing in new buildings.
- **Demand management** : Volumetric tariffs, leak repair and smart metering.
- **Recharge & restore** : Protect lakes/wetlands; sponge-city design and permeable surfaces.
- **Singapore NEWater** : Recycled water meets ~40% of demand under the 'Four Taps' strategy.
- **Israel & Cape Town** : Desalination plus 85%+ wastewater reuse; Cape Town's 'Day Zero' demand cuts.

Major Urbanisation Schemes

Scheme (launch)	Focus / Target	Status / Outlay
Smart Cities Mission (2015)	100 cities; area-based + pan-city tech, ICCCs	Closed Mar 2025; ₹48,000 cr released
AMRUT 2.0 (2021)	100% water & sewerage; 4,700+ ULBs	₹2.99 lakh cr (FY22-26)
PMAY-Urban 2.0 (2024)	1 cr houses for urban poor & middle class	₹10 lakh cr; ₹2.3 lakh cr central
SBM-Urban 2.0 (2021)	Garbage-free, ODF++ cities	98% door-to-door collection (2025-26)
DAY-NULM (2013)	Urban livelihoods, SHGs, shelters	All statutory towns
PM SVANidhi (2020)	Micro-credit for street vendors	Revamped Budget 2025-26

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Scheme (launch)	Focus / Target	Status / Outlay
PM e-Bus Sewa (2023)	10,000 city e-buses on PPP	₹20,000 cr; 7,293 approved
Urban Challenge Fund (2025)	Growth hubs, redevelopment, water	₹1 lakh cr; ₹10,000 cr (yr-1)

- **Smart Cities Mission** : Tech-led area + pan-city projects; Integrated Command & Control Centres now anchor city operations.
- **AMRUT 2.0** : Shifts focus from access to outcomes : circular water and universal coverage.
- **PMAY-U 2.0** : Four verticals; interest subsidy up to ₹25 lakh; provision for working-women hostels.
- **Urban Challenge Fund** : Funds 25% of bankable projects, leveraging bonds, bank loans, and PPP.

11. Cross-Cutting Urban Challenges

Governance & financing deficit

- **Fragmented authority** : Functions split across ULBs, development authorities and parastatals.
- **Weak finances** : Cities raise under 0.6% of GDP in their own revenue; property tax is just 0.15%.
- **74th CAA gaps** : Many states have not fully devolved the 18 listed functions or empowered mayors.
- **Thin capacity** : Staff and data shortfalls; few directly elected, empowered mayors.

Mobility & congestion

- **Private-vehicle dependence** : Roads store cars; bus fleets are far below the 40-60-per-lakh norm.
- **Congestion cost** : Bengaluru, Mumbai and Delhi commuters lose 117, 103 and 76 hours a year (TomTom 2024).
- **Transit push** : ~1,036 km of Metro/RRTS in ~24 cities; Namo Bharat RRTS; PM e-Bus Sewa.

Solid waste & sanitation

- **Scale** : Urban India generates ~1.6 lakh tonnes of waste a day; ~80% is processed (vs 16% in 2014-15).
- **Segregation gap** : Collection is near-universal, but source segregation lags. *Eg. Indore — No.1 since 2017.*

Urban flooding, heat & climate

- **Recurring deluges** : Chennai, Mumbai, Bengaluru (2025), Hyderabad and Delhi.
- **Urban heat islands** : Heat deaths could double to 3 lakh+/year by 2050 (World Bank).
- **DM Amendment Act 2025** : Provides for Urban Disaster Management Authorities in large cities.

12. Global Best Practices

City / Country	Practice	Lesson for India
Singapore	HDB public housing; NEWater; ERP road pricing	Integrate housing, water & mobility
Curitiba (Brazil)	Bus Rapid Transit + transit-oriented zoning	Cheap, high-capacity transit
Medellín (Colombia)	'Social urbanism' — metrocables, libraries	Invest in the poorest neighbourhoods
London (UK)	Congestion charge with ring-fenced transit funds	Demand management + reinvestment
Seoul (S. Korea)	Cheonggyecheon stream restoration	Reclaim ecology for liveability
Tokyo / New York	High FSI/FAR paired with mass transit	Build dense, not sprawling

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Way Forward

Committee & official recommendations

- **HPEC (Isher Judge Ahluwalia, 2011)** : Estimated ₹39.2 lakh cr for urban infrastructure over 2012-31; empower and fund ULBs.
- **Economic Survey 2025-26** : Treat cities as economic infrastructure; align electoral, fiscal and planning authority.
- **Finance Commissions** : 14th/15th FC tied grants to property-tax reform and audited municipal accounts.
- **2nd ARC** : Recommended an empowered metropolitan body and 'activity mapping' for the 74th CAA.

Priority reforms

- **Empower city governments** : Directly-elected mayors, fiscal autonomy and unified metropolitan planning.
- **Fix municipal finance** : Modernise property tax, municipal bonds, value capture and user charges.
- **Plan for density** : Higher FSI matched with infrastructure; transit-oriented, compact growth.
- **Climate-resilient cities** : Sponge cities, heat action plans and blue-green infrastructure.
- **People-centric mobility** : Buses to 40-60 per lakh, last-mile feeders and congestion pricing.
- **Housing & inclusion** : Secure tenure, rental and incremental housing, no eviction-led 'beautification'.
- **Data & capacity** : Census 2027, GIS/DEGURBA monitoring and professional municipal cadres.

Economic Survey 2025-26 — dedicated Urbanisation chapter

- **Cities as economic infrastructure** : Flagship framing; top-10 cities = ~9% of people but ~28% of GDP.
- **Binding constraints** : Land as 'dead capital', low FSI, weak municipal finance and fragmented governance.

World Bank — 'Towards Resilient and Prosperous Cities in India' (Jul 2025)

- **$2.4 trillion by 2050** : Needed for climate-resilient urban infrastructure; 951 mn urban Indians by 2050.
- **Climate risk** : Annual flood losses up to $30 bn by 2070; heat deaths could top 3 lakh/year by 2050.

World Cities Report 2026 — UN-Habitat

- **Global housing crisis** : ~40% of humanity faces a severe housing crisis; theme 'Pathways to Action'.

Mobility milestones

- **Namo Bharat RRTS** : Delhi-Meerut (82 km) — India's first statutory Transit-Oriented Development corridor.
- **PM e-Bus Sewa** : 10,000 e-buses; 7,293 approved across 14 states and 4 UTs.

Climate, cities & budgets

- **Bengaluru floods (2025)** : ~130 mm of rain in 12 hours paralysed the city — urban flooding as governance failure.
- **COP30, Belém (2025)** : Placed city and regional governments at the centre of climate implementation.

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